WWW.ECONOMICTIMES.COM

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | ESTD. 1838

VOL. 54 NO. 251 | NEW DELHI / GURGAON | 18 + 4 PAGES OF ET INDUSTRY CHANGEMAKERS 2026
+ 4 PAGES OF ET INDO GLOBAL LEADER + 4 PAGES OF BRAND EQUITY | ₹4.50 OR *₹9.50 WITH THE TIMES OF INDIA

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026

States are taking different approaches to attract investments in the data centre sector amid concerns over power & water usage ▶ P 1

▶ Rubio, Jaishankar Talk Energy, Def Cooperation ▶ Navratri Cheer Brings Back Shopping Spree ▶ India Plans Global Roadshows for Airport Investors: P 1

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA.
INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre.
For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON(1): FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail:
mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "**Risk Factors**" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

Witkoff, Finnish President Jonas Gahr, Zelenskyy in Oslo AP

KUSHNER JOINS ONLINE

Zelenskyy Meets Witkoff After Relations Sour

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskiy was meeting US special envoy Steve Witkoff on Tuesday in a bid to rescue relations that have sunk to new lows as Donald Trump has courted Moscow and Kyiv has complained about Washington withholding vital defences.

Zelenskiy and Witkoff clasped one another in a hug as they went into the talks hosted by the leaders of Norway and Finland in Oslo. Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner was attending remotely.

Zelenskiy held talks with Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Stoere and Finnish President Alexander Stubb ahead of his meeting with the US delegation.

'REPLACE ZELENSKYY'

Washington denies deliberately hindering Ukraine's war effort, but Trump has asked Zelenskyy to be replaced

Kyiv says Washington has lately failed to provide early warning of Russian missile launches, throttled SpaceX's Starshield satellite links that guide Ukrainian drones, and failed to deliver air defences paid for by European allies.

Washington denies deliberately hindering Ukraine's war effort. In the latest comments expressing warmth towards Moscow and coldness towards Kyiv, asking Zelenskyy to be replaced. **Reuters**

Russia Satellite Nears Europe Spacecraft

A Russian satellite moved within just 100 metres of a European commercial spacecraft that supports Ukraine's military at the weekend, orbital tracking data showed, raising concerns about Moscow's activities in space. Russia launched the Cosmos-2612 military satellite into low Earth orbit in April.
It began changing course late September and eventually moved into the same orbit as ICEYE-X36, a satellite operated by Finland's ICEYE under contract with the United States. **AFP.**

TEHRAN PREPARING FOR ATTACKS, NOT TALKS

Planned Deadlock 'Iran is Dragging Talks to Influence US Midterms'

Foreign Minister Araghchi claims Moscow & Tehran have never worked so closely before

Iran has deliberately prolonged talks with the US to try to weaken Donald Trump politically ahead of November's US midterm elections, senior officials say, while fears of renewed military action and deep distrust of Washington have reinforced Tehran's reluctance to strike a quick deal to end the war.

Three senior Iranian officials and an Iranian insider, speaking on condition of anonymity, said Tehran was convinced the US president was ready to resort to renewed attacks to try to break the stalemate in the eight-month-old war.

"Iran is preparing for renewed Israeli and US attacks, not for a deal with America to end the war," one of the officials said. "The clerical establishment is determined not to give Trump a political victory."

Tehran analyst Saeed Leylaz said that, by prolonging the talks, "Iran is influencing the US election without taking any unlawful action". Trump has repeatedly said he expects oil prices to drop after the elections, but has not offered a detailed plan to end the war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, a vital global energy shipping route effectively closed by Iran since the war began.

EXPLOITING TRUMP'S PROBLEMS

The war, which began in February when the US and its ally Israel launched strikes on Iran, has helped drive Trump's approval rating to a record low as polls suggest that Americans worried about high gasoline prices will punish his Republican Party in the November 3 congressional elections.

ARAGCHI, LAVROV MEET

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Tuesday that Russia and Iran have "never" worked so closely, after hosting his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov first visit since the outbreak of the conflict as Moscow seeks to play a mediating role in the West Asian war.

"Never in our history have Iran & Russia worked as closely as now," Araghchi wrote on X. **Reuters**

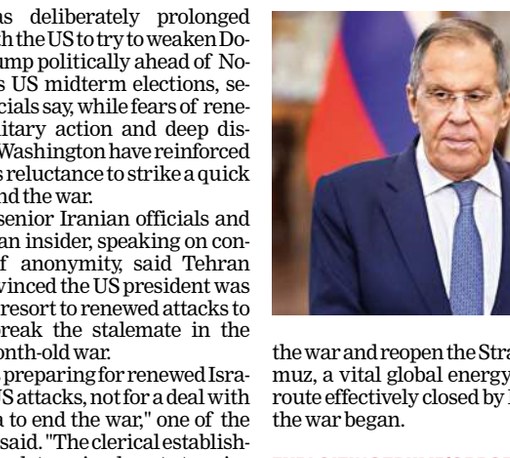
'Hormuz Could be Redundant in 5 yrs'

Investment in alternative logistics routes in the Gulf to mitigate the impact of the Iran war could make the Strait of Hormuz "redundant" in the next five years, HSBC Group Chief Executive Georges Elhedery said on Tuesday. The conflict has highlighted the world's heavy reliance on the strategic West Asian waterway, through which a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas trade previously passed. **Reuters**

Hegseth Makes Impromptu Visit to Israel, Discusses Iran with Bibi

US Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth discussed Iran with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu during an unannounced visit to Israel on Monday, three Israeli officials said, as tensions flare between the US and Iran.

Doron Spielman, a spokesperson for the prime minister, later confirmed to Reuters that Netanyahu had met with Hegseth at the Uvda air force base in Israel's southern Negev desert region.



Netanyahu and Hegseth discussed "the threats in the region" and the US-Israel partnership in dealing both offensively and defensively with those threats, he said in a brief phone call.

Hegseth also thanked Israel for hosting US forces, which Spielman said numbered in the thousands, and discussed President Donald Trump's support for the prime minister.

"There's a deep personal relationship here that was at the core of this discussion," Spielman said.

On Sunday, Trump endorsed Netanyahu in next week's parliamentary election in Israel, the country's first ballot since the October 7, 2023, Hamas attack on southern Israel.

The Pentagon has not publicly commented on Hegseth's visit.

Hegseth earlier posted on X that he had visited US service members in the Central Command area of responsibility, which covers the Middle East, northeast Africa and parts of Asia.

He did not specify where he had met with the forces.

Hegseth's visit comes as tensions flare between the US and Iran over the Strait of Hormuz and as Yemen's Iran-allied Houthis intensify their attacks on Saudi Arabia.

US and Israeli forces launched joint strikes against Iran in late February, setting off the wider Middle East war. Netanyahu told Israeli media this month that he's not seeking to attack Iran before the October 27 Israeli election. Trump has said he will not attack Iran before US midterm elections in November. **Reuters**

Defending Saudi UK to Carry Air Missions

Britain will fly Royal Air Force Typhoon fighter jets on defensive missions to help protect Saudi cities and critical national infrastructure from Houthi aerial attacks, the Ministry of Defence said on Tuesday. The ministry said the aircraft would operate only in a defensive role and would not conduct offensive strikes against the Iran-aligned Houthi Rebels, whose continuous attacks Britain says threaten regional stability and risk disrupting energy supplies as well as trade routes. **Reuters**

RACE TO RAISE

OpenAI Fundraising in Top Gear Before Anthropic Mkt Debut

As both rivals are tapping similar base, OpenAI aims to build on recent revenue gains

OpenAI is racing to secure investor commitments before rival Anthropic's expected public market debut in mid-November, in an unusually fast fundraising that could value the ChatGPT maker at over $1.4 trillion, according to two people familiar with the matter.

The rapid timetable reflects, in part, a desire to get ahead of Anthropic as the two frontier labs are increasingly tapping in to a similar investor base, the people said, adding that OpenAI wants to capitalize on its recent revenue growth after launching new models. SoftBank Group, Abu Dhabi-based MGX and other existing backers of OpenAI are in talks to join the round of about $30 billion, one of the people said.

The acceleration underscores how closely the two AI developers are competing for capital as both pursue trillion-dollar price tags, amid growing concern about rising interest rates, significant volatility in technology stocks and rising scrutiny of AI valuations.

OpenAI held meetings with long-only funds and sovereign wealth funds last week while Anthropic was hosting its own investor day

OpenAI held meetings with long-only funds and sovereign wealth funds last week while Anthropic was hosting its own investor day. OpenAI's funding round is expected to move faster than is typical for an offering of its size, the people said.

Investors familiar with the company say OpenAI also needs capital to fund its substantial infrastructure commitments and bolster its balance sheet if a deterioration in the IPO markets further delays its planned 2027 listing.

Though there is high demand for the shares of both companies, investors face the challenge of evaluating and allocating capital to two complex, competing offerings within days or weeks of each other. Some investors view OpenAI's financing push as an effort to lock in capital from funds that might otherwise devote more of their resources to Anthropic's IPO, the people said. **Reuters**

Eric Schmidt's Net May Soar by Third on Anthropic Stake

Former Google Chief Executive Officer Eric Schmidt owns around 1% of Anthropic thanks to his early investment in the startup, according to people familiar with the matter, setting him up for one of the largest individual windfalls from the company's imminent public market debut.
Schmidt invested tens of millions of dollars in Anthropic's Series A fundraising round, according to the people, who asked not to be identified. When Schmidt, 71, made his first bet on Anthropic in 2021, it was valued at $461 million, according to data company Pitchbook. Investors indicated last week that a fair valuation for the company is in the $1.8 trillion to $2 trillion ballpark; the high end of that range would value Anthropic at more than 4,300 times its Series A funding round.
At that value, the stake would boost Schmidt's net worth by about one-third to nearly $80 billions. **BB**

China Tracks US Warship Near Disputed Shoal

China's military said on Tuesday it had sent forces to watch a US warship that "illegally" entered waters around a disputed shoal in the South China Sea, while further north in the waterway, Taiwan reported a standoff with a Chinese vessel.

China views almost all of the South China Sea as its own territory, despite overlapping claims by Brunei, Malaysia, the Philippines, Taiwan and Vietnam, with recent tension most pronounced between Beijing and Manila.

The Chinese military's Southern Theatre Command said the USS Charleston "illegally intruded" into waters. **Reuters**

All Lull on French Front Govt Expects Weekend Protests

French bond yields near 24-year high as new protests loom

France's cities were calm overnight under curfews imposed after last weekend's scenes of chaos, as protest groups announced a new round of demonstrations next Saturday.

Reeling from a weekend of extraordinary violence, the government is scrambling to reassure people it has learned its lesson from security shortcomings that left the centres of cities such as Paris, Marseille and Lyon largely unprotected from post-demonstration rioters and looters.

High-school pupil strikes and demonstrations against falling standards and growing dilapidation have spiralled into a national outpouring of anger at rising prices and the sense that health, housing, welfare needs are also no longer being met.

Paris after a quiet night under curfew

BOND YIELDS

France's government bond yields climbed further on Tuesday after their biggest daily rise in nearly a month, with investors remaining cautious as protest groups announced a new round of demonstrations planned for Saturday.

CURFEWS

Fresh curfews were being imposed across the city centers of Paris and Lyon on Tuesday after the first quiet night since France's most destructive rioting in years, as Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said a "massive" security operation was planned for new protests Saturday.

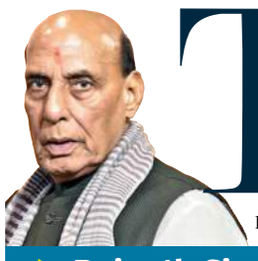
France will reinforce police with troops and mount a huge security operation for more protests planned on Saturday, the government said on Tuesday.

"The deployment next Saturday will be massive," Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu said. **Reuters**

Alberta Votes to Stay with Canada

Voters in oil-rich Alberta province overwhelmingly backed remaining in Canada, with referendum results Tuesday delivering a boost to Prime Minister Mark Carney's push for national unity as US President Donald Trump's trade war and annexation threats rally Canadians around their country.

With more than 1.8 million votes counted so far in 81% of areas and locations, 75% of voters supported remaining in Canada, while 25% backed beginning a process toward separation, according to unofficial results from Elections Alberta. **AP**



WWW.ECONOMICTIMES.COM

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | ESTD. 1838

VOL. 54 NO. 251 | NEW DELHI / GURGAON | 18 + 4 PAGES OF ET INDUSTRY CHANGEMAKERS 2026
+ 4 PAGES OF ET INDO GLOBAL LEADER + 4 PAGES OF BRAND EQUITY | ₹4.50 OR *₹9.50 WITH THE TIMES OF INDIA

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026

External affairs minister Jaishakar, in talks with UAE's deputy CM Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, said the West Asia crisis was a matter of "deep concern" ▶ Page 2

▶ Rajnath Singh at SCO: No Place for Supporters and Financiers of Terrorism ▶ Home Minister Shah Vows to End Punjab Drug Trade by 2029: P 2

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF EQUITY SHARES ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED ("**BSE**") AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("**NSE**", AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "**STOCK EXCHANGES**") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("**SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS**").

PARAS HEALTH
Partners In Health

PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

(Please scan the QR Code to view the RHP and the Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was incorporated as 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited', a private limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated December 21, 1987, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi. Our Company became a deemed public company as per Section 43A(1)(a) of the Companies Act, 1956 with effect from July 1, 1993, consequent to which its name was changed to "Arbian Frozen Foods Limited", by deletion of the word 'Private'. Consequent to the amendment in Section 43A(2)(a) of the Companies Act, 1956 by the Companies (Amendment) Act, 2000, our Company was re-converted from a deemed public company to a private limited company and the name of our Company was changed to 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited' and the certificate of incorporation consequent to the change in name of our Company was endorsed by the Registrar of Companies, NCT of Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi on June 16, 2003. Subsequently, pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board on June 19, 2003 and by our Shareholders on July 9, 2003, the name of our Company was changed from 'Arbian Frozen Foods Private Limited' to 'Paras Healthcare Private Limited' to reflect the change in its business activity from frozen foods to healthcare services and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent to the change in name of our Company was issued by the Registrar of Companies, NCT of Delhi & Haryana, at New Delhi on July 21, 2003. Our Company was subsequently converted from a private company to a public company, pursuant to resolutions passed by our Board on June 3, 2024 and by our Shareholders dated June 4, 2024, consequent to which its name was changed to "Paras Healthcare Limited.", and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon conversion to public limited company was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on July 18, 2024. Subsequently, pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board and Shareholders on July 31, 2025 and September 5, 2025, respectively, the name of our Company was changed from "Paras Healthcare Limited." to "Paras Healthcare Limited", and a fresh certificate of incorporation was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on September 29, 2025. For details of changes in our name and registered office, see "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 318 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 ("Red Herring Prospectus" or "RHP").

Corporate Identity Number: U85110HR1987PLC035823
Registered and Corporate Office: 1st Floor, Tower B, Paras Twin Towers, Golf Course Road, Sector 54, Gurugram – 122 002, Haryana, India
Contact Person: Rahul Kumar, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, **Telephone:** +91 124 430 2163, **Email:** cs@parashospitals.com, **Website:** www.parashospitals.com

OUR PROMOTER: DR. DHARMINDER KUMAR NAGAR

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OF PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED (THE "COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹14,500.00 MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,000.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹9,500.00 MILLION, COMPRISING UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹3,000.00 MILLION BY DR. DHARMINDER KUMAR NAGAR (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER") AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹6,500.00 MILLION BY COMMELINA LTD (THE "INVESTOR SELLING SHAREHOLDER", AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS") (SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION

NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OFFERED / AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹3,000.00 million	2.35
Commelina Ltd	Investor Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹6,500.00 million	114.15

*****As certified by Suri & Sudhir, Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026.*

PRICE BAND: ₹660 TO ₹693 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 660 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 693 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 21 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 21 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS (1.14)%.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 159.68 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 152.07 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO OF 67.81 TIMES.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹660 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹693 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	7,575,757	5,000.00	7,215,007	5,000.00
Offer for Sale	14,393,938	9,500.00	13,708,513	9,500.00
Total Offer Size	**21,969,695**	**14,500.00**	**20,923,520**	**14,500.00**
Post Offer Market Cap	**108,561,944**	**71,650.88**	**108,201,194**	**74,983.43**

BID/OFFER PERIOD

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY
BID/OFFER CLOSES ON: FRIDAY, 23 OCTOBER, 2026#

#UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

We are a clinical specialty-led hospital platform providing tertiary and quaternary healthcare services through a network of eight hospitals with an aggregate bed capacity of 2,211 beds as of June 30, 2026 across North India, Bihar and Jharkhand. We operate under the "Paras Health" brand, with a presence in five states and one union territory - Gurugram and Panchkula in Haryana; Patna and Darbhanga in Bihar; Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh; Udaipur in Rajasthan; Ranchi in Jharkhand; and Srinagar in the union territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(2) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS. | THE EQUITY SHARES WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 75% OF THE OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL BIDDERS PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 15% OF THE OFFER | RETAIL INDIVIDUAL BIDDERS PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 10% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THE RESOLUTION DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/KPIS DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* SECTION ON PAGE 140 OF THE RHP VIS-A-VIS THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S) AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* ON PAGE 140 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For further details please see "Risk Factors" beginning on page 21 of the RHP.

1. **Losses in the recent past:** Our Company has incurred losses during the three months period ended June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2025 and 2024 of ₹(10.24) million, ₹(579.83) million and ₹(153.31) million, respectively, on a consolidated basis. While we were profitable in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, we cannot assure you that we will continue to remain profitable in the future. Further, in each of the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2025 and 2024, our Company had the lowest RoCE and RoE and the highest debt to equity ratio in comparison to our peers listed in India.
2. **Losses incurred by our Subsidiaries:** Our Subsidiaries, Paras Healthcare (Ranchi) Private Limited and Plus Medicare Hospitals Private Limited have collectively incurred a loss of ₹(203.82) million, ₹(520.89) million, ₹(822.38) million and ₹(872.69) million during the three months period ended June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. We cannot assure you that these Subsidiaries will turn profitable in the future.
3. **High dependence on employees**: We are highly dependent on doctors, nurses, other healthcare professionals and housekeeping and support staff for our operations. As of June 30, 2026, we had a team of 5,315 medical professionals and support staff, comprising 1,084 doctors (of which 940 doctors are resident medical officers and consultants and 144 doctors are visiting doctors), 1,937 nurses and 2,294 other personnel (including other healthcare professionals and housekeeping and support staff). We have experienced high attrition rates of 12.01%, 16.09%, 60.38%, 66.74% and 65.27% in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. If we are unable to reduce or manage the attrition rates of these professionals, our business, results of operations and financial condition may be adversely affected.
4. **Concentration in North India:** Five of our eight hospitals are located in North India, which include our hospitals in Gurugram and Panchkula in Haryana, Udaipur in Rajasthan, Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir, and Kanpur in Uttar Pradesh. Any disruption, loss of business or adverse developments affecting one or more of our hospitals located in North India, or the regions in which they are located, could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations and financial condition. The table below sets forth details of the revenue from operations generated from each of our hospitals in North India for the periods / years indicated:

Hospitals	Revenue from operations									
	Three months period ended June 30, 2026		Three months period ended June 30, 2025		Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%	(₹ million)	%
Our hospitals in North India (A)	3,200.95	68.07%	2,464.02	66.89%	10,609.74	66.07%	8,851.95	68.40%	7,601.32	67.33%
Our hospitals outside North India (B)	1,501.83	31.93%	1,219.85	33.11%	5,449.78	33.93%	4,088.68	31.60%	3,689.07	32.67%
Total (A+B)	**4,702.78**	**100.00%**	**3,683.87**	**100.00%**	**16,059.52**	**100.00%**	**12,940.63**	**100.00%**	**11,290.39**	**100.00%**

5. **Wilful Defaulter**: The name of one of the members of our Promoter Group, Harbaksh Singh Khangura appears in the CIBIL wilful defaulter database in relation to defaults reported in 2014 against a company where he served as a director until November 30, 2013. While our Promoter Group member has confirmed that he has not been associated with the affairs of such company since November 30, 2013, had no involvement in its affairs thereafter, has not received any communication declaring him a defaulter or a wilful defaulter and has formally written to CIBIL Transunion and the lenders requesting removal of his name from the defaulter database, we cannot assure you that his name will be removed from the CIBIL defaulter database or that he will not be subject to any adverse proceedings or rulings in the future.
6. **Dependence on cardiac sciences, oncology sciences, neuro sciences, gastro sciences, orthopedics and sports injury and renal sciences (collectively, "CONGOR") specialties:** We generate a significant portion of our revenue from the provision of CONGOR specialties at our hospitals, which contributed 74.35%, 75.30%, 74.70%, 71.92% and 72.34% of our revenue from operations in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any adverse developments in the demand for such services could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition.
7. **High Costs**: The provision of healthcare services involves high costs such as employee benefit expenses, retainers and consultants fee and purchases of stock-in-trade, which together accounted for 66.13%, 64.40%, 65.08%, 63.69% and 66.95% of our total expenses in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. In the past, we have been unable to pass on the increase in our costs to our patients, which has impacted our revenue from operations and profitability. If our costs increase in the future and we are unable to pass them on to our patients, or if we are unable to grow our revenue in line with our costs, our business, results of operations and financial condition may be adversely affected.
8. **6 out of our 8 hospitals are located on leased premises**: We operate 6 of our 8 hospitals on leased premises and these six hospitals collectively contributed to 61.32%, 58.41%, 60.53%, 55.75% and 55.11% of our revenue from operations in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025, and in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. In addition, except for our Registered and Corporate Office, our Gurugram Hospital and our Udaipur Hospital (which is owned by our wholly-owned Subsidiary, PMHPL and leased to our Company), all of our hospitals are located on land that we have leased from third parties. Accordingly, our ability to continue to operate a substantial portion of our hospital network is dependent on the continuation and renewal of our arrangements with lessors and other counterparties.
9. **High contingent liabilities:** The table below summarises our contingent liabilities, along with as a percentage of our net worth, as at the dates indicated:

Particulars	Contingent Liabilities									
	As at June 30, 2026		As at June 30, 2025		As at March 31, 2026		As at March 31, 2025		As at March 31, 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth	Amount (₹ million)	% of Net Worth
Total Contingent Liabilities	3,984.42	89.55%	3,403.15	97.60%	3,905.01	98.88%	3,795.90	135.33%	2,886.23	85.26%

A significant portion of contingent liabilities (₹2,986.17 million as of June 30, 2026), as set out above, pertained to the corporate guarantee issued by our Subsidiary, PMHPL, which is in the nature of secondary collateral security in respect of certain credit facilities availed by our Company from HDFC Bank Limited, comprising term loan and cash credit facilities. The corporate guarantee is available to the lender only as an additional secondary security and is enforceable only after the lender has recourse to the primary security package created in respect of the relevant credit facilities. Subsequent to June 30, 2026 and pursuant to the revised sanction letters issued by HDFC Bank Limited dated July 25, 2026 and August 7, 2026 in respect of PMHPL and our Company, respectively, the corporate guarantees provided by our Company on behalf of PMHPL aggregating to ₹319.37 million, and the guarantee issued by PMHPL on behalf of our Company aggregating to ₹2,986.17 million as on June 30, 2026, have been waived by HDFC Bank Limited in accordance with the revised sanction terms.

10. **Outstanding litigations**: There are certain outstanding legal proceedings involving us that are pending at different levels of adjudication before various courts, tribunals and other authorities. Such proceedings could divert our management's time and attention and consume financial resources in their defence or prosecution. Any unfavourable decision in connection with such proceedings, individually or in the aggregate, could adversely affect our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. **The details of Price/Earnings, Earnings per share, Return on Net Worth, Net Asset Value Per Equity Share, Enterprise Value (EV)/ EBITDA Ratio for our Company and peer group for Fiscal 2026 are as below:**

Name of the company	Revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	Face value per equity share (₹)	P/E ratio (on Cap Price)	Enterprise Value (EV)/ EBITDA Ratio (At Cap Price)	EPS (Basic) (₹ per share)	EPS (Diluted) (₹ per share)	Net Worth	Return on Net Worth (%)	Net Asset Value per Equity Share (₹)
Our Company (Paras Healthcare Limited)	16,059.52	1	159.68	24.11	4.34	4.34	3,949.41	12.98%	39.11
Listed Peers									
Aster DM Quality Care Limited	46,432.20	10	91.89	40.73	7.53	7.52	45,758.60	9.70%	88.32
Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Limited ("**AHEL**")	252,285.00	5	59.36	32.59	135.04	134.94	94,801.00	21.95%	657.58
Fortis Healthcare Limited ("**FHL**")	91,278.40	10	55.43	28.88	13.80	13.80	98,955.50	11.08%	131.07
Global Health Limited ("**GHL**")	44,103.00	2	64.46	34.03	20.71	20.66	39,615.70	15.15%	147.06
Jupiter Lifeline Hospitals Limited ("**JLHL**")	14,997.87	2	42.92	25.79	5.92	5.92	15,440.84	13.41%	47.10
Krishna Institute of Medical Sciences Limited ("**KIMS**")	39,046.00	2	116.41	40.64	6.03	6.03	22,474.00	11.01%	56.17
Manipal Health Enterprises Limited	109,356.00	2	87.00	36.89	7.71	7.67	84,261.30	12.37%	63.26
Max Healthcare Institute Limited	100,650.00	10	62.10	35.69	14.83	14.76	107,466.30	14.33%	109.53
Narayana Hrudayalaya Limited	78,960.35	10	43.41	22.67	39.67	39.67	45,372.58	19.74%	222.02
Yatharth Hospital and Trauma Care Services Limited	12,071.72	10	55.16	33.12	18.20	18.20	17,805.62	10.36%	184.79
Average of Listed Peers			**67.81**	**33.10**					

12. **Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is negative and is (1.14%) on restated and consolidated basis**
13. **Average Cost of Acquisition for our Promoter (who is also a Selling Shareholder) and the Investor Selling Shareholder:**

S. No.	Name of the Selling Shareholder	Number of Equity Shares held	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)
1.	Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar (Promoter Selling Shareholder)	73,519,238	2.35
2.	Commelina Ltd (Investor Selling Shareholder)	16,604,375	114.15

14. **Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares:** The weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in last one year and the three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is set out below:

Period	Weighted average cost of acquisition (WACA) *(in ₹)*	Upper end of the Price Band is 'X' times the WACA	Range of acquisition price: Lowest price – Highest price *(in ₹)*
Last one year	Not Applicable#	Not Applicable#	Not Applicable#
Last three years	43.15	16.06	Nil - ₹237.00

 # There were no transactions in the last one year.

15. **Weighted average cost of acquisition, Floor Price and Cap Price**

The Floor Price is 2.78 times and the Cap Price is 2.92 times the weighted average cost of acquisition based on the last five primary and secondary transactions as disclosed below:

Types of transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition (₹ per Equity Share)#	No. of times at Floor price (i.e. ₹ 660)	No. of times at Cap price (i.e. ₹ 693)
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Primary Issuances	NA	NA	NA
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Secondary Transactions	NA	NA	NA
Since there were no primary or secondary transactions of securities during the 18 months prior to the date of the RHP to report under 1 or 2 above, the information for price per share of the Company based on the last five primary or secondary transactions where the Promoter/members of the Promoter Group, Selling Shareholders or Shareholder(s) having the right to nominate director(s) on the Board of the Company, are a party to the transaction, during the three years prior to the date of the RHP irrespective of the size of the transaction, has been disclosed below.			
(a) Based on primary issuances	237.00	2.78	2.92
(b) Based on secondary transactions	237.00	2.78	2.92

 # As certified by Suri & Sudhir, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026.

16. **Performance of BRLMs' Past Issues**: The 3 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 83 public issues in the past three years, out of which 25 issues closed below the IPO price on listing date:

Name of BRLM	Total Issues	Issues closed below IPO price on listing date
JM Financial Limited	44	14
BofA Securities India Limited	4	0
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited	19	7
Common issues of above BRLMs*	16	4
Total	**83**	**25**

** Issues handled where there are common BRLMs.*

....continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. Pre-IPO Placement - In the Draft Red Herring Prospectus, our Company had provided for a further issue of specified securities as may be permitted in accordance with applicable law to any person(s), for an amount aggregating up to ₹1,000.00 million prior to filing of the Red Herring Prospectus. However, our Company has not undertaken and does not propose to undertake a Pre-IPO Placement.
2. There have been no other transactions of shares aggregating to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company by our Promoter and Promoter Group from the DRHP filing date.
3. The aggregate pre-Offer and post-Offer shareholding, of each of our Promoter, members of our Promoter Group, and additional top 10 Shareholders (apart from Promoter and Promoter Group), is set forth below:

S. No.	Name	Pre-Offer shareholding as at the date of the Price Band Advertisement		Post-Offer shareholding as at the date of Allotment[1]			
				At the lower end of the Price Band (₹660 per Equity Share)		At the upper end of the Price Band (₹693 per Equity Share)	
		No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total pre-Offer paid up Equity Share capital (%)	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total post-Offer paid up Equity Share capital	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held	Percentage of total post-Offer paid up Equity Share capital
Promoter Selling Shareholder							
1	Dr. Dharminder Kumar Nagar	73,519,238	72.80%	68,973,784	63.53%	69,190,234	63.95%
Sub-total (A)		**73,519,238**	**72.80%**	**68,973,784**	**63.53%**	**69,190,234**	**63.95%**
Promoter Group (other than our Promoter)							
1.	Gurdeep Kaur Nagar	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
2.	Ranya Nagar	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
Sub-total (B)		**2**	**Negligible**	**2**	**Negligible**	**2**	**Negligible**
Public Shareholders (top 10 Shareholders) (other than our Promoter and Promoter Group)							
1.	Commelina Ltd	16,604,375	16.44%	6,755,891	6.22%	7,224,866	6.68%
2.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 12	5,147,679	5.10%	5,147,679	4.74%	5,147,679	4.76%
3.	Axis New Opportunities AIF - Series II	3,668,439	3.63%	3,668,439	3.38%	3,668,439	3.39%
4.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 13	1,286,920	1.27%	1,286,920	1.19%	1,286,920	1.19%
5.	360 ONE Special Opportunities Fund - Series 11	421,941	0.42%	421,941	0.39%	421,941	0.39%
6.	360 One Equity Opportunity Fund - Series 4	210,970	0.21%	210,970	0.19%	210,970	0.19%
7.	360 One Private Equity Fund - Series 2	126,583	0.13%	126,583	0.12%	126,583	0.12%
8.	Kapil Garg	20	Negligible	20	Negligible	20	Negligible
9.	Vikas Kumar Kansal	19	Negligible	19	Negligible	19	Negligible
10.	Jalaja Divakaran Sunil	1	Negligible	1	Negligible	1	Negligible
Sub-total (C)		**27,466,947**	**27.20%**	**17,618,463**	**16.23%**	**18,087,438**	**16.72%**
Other Public Shareholders							
Sub-total (D)		**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**	**NIL**
Total (A+B+C+D)		**100,986,187**	**100.00%**	**86,592,249**	**79.76%**	**87,277,674**	**80.66%**

[1] Assuming full subscription in the Offer. The post-Offer shareholding details as at Allotment will be based on the actual subscription and the Offer Price and updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the Basis of Allotment.
Also, the above table assumes there is no transfer of shares by these shareholders between the date of the advertisement and allotment (if any such transfers occur prior to the date of Prospectus, it will be updated in the shareholding pattern in the Prospectus).

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of JM Financial Limited

*The **"Basis for Offer Price"** section on page 140 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com for the **"Basis for Offer Price"** updated with the above price band.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids	
Bid/ Offer Programme	
EVENT	**INDICATIVE DATE**
ANCHOR INVESTOR BID/OFFER PERIOD OPENED AND CLOSED ON	Monday, 19 October, 2026
BID/OFFER OPENS ON	Wednesday, 21 October, 2026
BID/OFFER CLOSES ON	Friday, 23 October, 2026[1]
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	Monday, 26 October, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA*	Tuesday, 27 October, 2026
Allotment of Equity Shares/ Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	Tuesday, 27 October, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	Wednesday, 28 October, 2026

Note:

[1] UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Offer BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, as partially modified by the T+3 notification and SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation in accordance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular and any subsequent circulars or notifications issued by SEBI in this regard.*

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. Indian Standard Time (**"IST"**)
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs other than QIBs and NIIs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 05:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their Bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their Bids.

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

#ASBA (defined above) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT Notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes &intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll-free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid / Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks, as applicable.

This is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in compliance with Regulation 6(2) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein at least 75% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**" and such portion, the "**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis, in accordance with SEBI ICDR Regulations (the "**Anchor Investor Portion**"), out of which 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as follows: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% shall be available for allocation to Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds and Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors ("**Anchor Investor Allocation Price**"), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations and any under-subscription of 6.67% of the Anchor Investor Portion reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the remaining QIB Portion (the "**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. If at least 75% of the Offer cannot be Allotted to QIBs, then the entire application money will be refunded forthwith. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not more than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders ("**NIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations of which (a) one-third portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹200,000 and up to ₹1,000,000; and (b) two-thirds portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹1,000,000, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price and not more than 10% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (defined hereinafter) in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism, in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or by the Sponsor Banks, as applicable under the UPI Mechanism, to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN , UPI ID and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, investors are requested to see "***History and Certain Corporate Matters***" on page 318 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see "***Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection***" on page 633 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorized share capital of our Company is ₹125,000,000 comprising of 125,000,000 Equity Shares of face value ₹1 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of our Company is ₹100,986,187 comprising 100,986,187 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. For details of the capital structure of our Company, see "***Capital Structure***" on page 101 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: 10 Equity Shares each to Sunil Kapur, Ashok Narang, Veena Chandok, G. K. Sahni and Shailendra Chandok. For details of the share capital history and capital structure of our Company see "***Capital Structure***" on page 101 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares to be Allotted through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 20, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* beginning on page 633 of the RHP. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been, and a signed copy of the Prospectus shall be, delivered to the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013, respectively.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft offer document and this does not constitute approval of either the issue or the specified securities stated in the Offer document. The investors are advised to refer to page 512 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of the SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of the NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 515 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of the BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by the BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 515 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the Risk Factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 21 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS			REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
JM Financial Limited 7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@jmfl.com **Investor Grievance ID:** grievance.ibd@jmfl.com **Website:** www.jmfl.com **Contact person:** Prachee Dhuri **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000010361	**BofA Securities India Limited** Ground Floor, A Wing, One BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 8000 **E-mail:** dg.parashealth_ipo@bofa.com **Investor Grievance ID:** dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com **Website:** https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india **Contact person:** Sayantan Bhattacharyya **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011625	**Nuvama Wealth Management Limited** 801-804, Wing A, Building No. 3, Inspire BKC, G Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai – 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@nuvama.com **Investor Grievance ID:** customerservice.mb@nuvama.com **Website:** www.nuvama.com **Contact person**: Pari Vaya **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000013004	**MUFG Intime India Private Limited** ***(Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited)*** C-101, Embassy 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West) Mumbai 400 083, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 810 811 4949 **E-mail:** parashealthcare.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Investor Grievance ID:** parashealthcare.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com **Contact person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan **SEBI Registration No.:** INR000004058	**Rahul Kumar** 1st Floor, Tower B, Paras Twin Towers, Golf Course Road, Sector 54, Gurugram – 122 002, Haryana, India, **Tel:** +91 124 430 2163 **E-mail:** cs@parashospitals.com Bidders may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any Pre-Offer or Post-Offer related problems, such as non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF RHP: Investors should note that Investment in Equity Shares involves a high degree of risk and investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the Risk Factors contained herein, before applying in the Offer. Full copy of the RHP is available at the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, the website of our Company at www.parashospitals.com and the website of BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus is available on the website of our Company at www.parashospitals.com, the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Application forms can be obtained from the Registered Office of **Paras Healthcare Limited, Tel**: +91 124 430 2163 and the **BRLMs – JM Financial Limited**, **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030, **BofA Securities India Limited, Tel:** +91 22 6630 8000 and **Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 and **Syndicate Members: JM Financial Services Limited**, **Telephone:** + 91 22 6136 3400, **Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to "***Offer Procedure***" on page 539 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and the websites of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid Cum Application form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DP's. The SCSB's will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund.

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: Almondz Global Securities Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, India Infoline Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, Religare Securities Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Axis Capital Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Limited, IIFL Wealth Management Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, YES Securities (India) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Sharekhan Limited, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, 360 ONE WAM Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Keynote Capital Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta, Equiras Securities Pvt Ltd, Finwizard Technology Pvt. Ltd, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Pvt Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Ltd, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd.

BANKERS TO THE OFFER:

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: ICICI Bank Limited

Public Offer Account Bank: HDFC Bank Limited

Sponsor Banks: ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Rahul Kumar
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Gurugram
Date: October 19, 2026

PARAS HEALTHCARE LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an Initial Public Offer of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with the RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of the Company at www.parashospitals.com, on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the websites of JM Financial Limited, BofA Securities India Limited and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.jmfl.com, https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india and www.nuvama.com, respectively. The potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk. For details, potential investors should refer to the section titled "***Risk Factors***" on page 21 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "**U.S. Securities Act**") or any other applicable law of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (a) in the United States only to persons reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) pursuant to the private placement exemption set out in Section 4(a) of the U.S. Securities Act, and (b) outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales are made.

Adfactors

WWW.ECONOMICTIMES.COM

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

BENNETT, COLEMAN & CO. LTD. | ESTD. 1838

VOL. 54 NO. 251 | NEW DELHI / GURGAON | 18 + 4 PAGES OF ET INDUSTRY CHANGEMAKERS 2026
+ 4 PAGES OF ET INDO GLOBAL LEADER + 4 PAGES OF BRAND EQUITY | ₹4.50 OR *₹9.50 WITH THE TIMES OF INDIA

WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026

Jio Pricing Leaves Enough for Investors to Gain: Akash Ambani

Unlisted Share Market Loses Zip after NSE IPO

MARKETS: BEATING VOLATILITY ▸▸ 9

High Airfares Fail to Put Brakes on Hotel Bookings

BRANDS & COMPANIES ▸▸ 12

*Applicable only on monthly purchase (in Delhi/NCR)

To order your favourite newspaper, call 1800 1200 004 toll free or visit subscribe.timesofindia.com. To advertise with us, call 1800 120 5474

Brent Slips after Hitting 5-mth High

Oil prices slipped after touching a 5-month high on Tuesday as traders weighed a meeting between the Iranian president and Pak army chief against Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure. Brent crude futures fell 83 cents, or 0.76%, to $108.72. ▸▸ 8

PUREPOLITICS

Will Finish off Drug Trade in Punjab by 2029: Amit Shah

Union home minister Amit Shah on Tuesday said he had "never felt this sad" after meeting families of three people linked to Punjab's drug menace. He promised to eradicate the drug trade from the state by 2029. ▸▸ 2

Bhagwat: Protests Alone will Rarely Resolve Problems

RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat said protests alone rarely solved problems and warned that global forces aiming to destabilise India could exploit local issues. Changing a regime would not change the situation on ground, he said. **Krishna Kumar** reports. ▸▸ 3

Tiger Shroff Attack: Suspects to be Taken to Mumbai for Probe

Mumbai Crime Branch teams left for Kota on Tuesday and are expected to bring the three alleged shooters to Mumbai on Wednesday. They will be produced before a court, where the police will seek their custody for further interrogation. ▸▸ 3

Inside story

Brands Raise Advertising Spends in September Qtr to Drive Growth

Multiple packaged goods makers increased advertising spends during July-September and said they will sustain the momentum through the next two quarters, despite input cost pressures, to drive volume growth, while food companies also seek to retain consumer trust amid regulatory crackdowns. ▸▸ 12

Upgrad's FY26 Net Loss Halves to ₹131 crore on Lower Expenses

Edtech platform UpGrad's consolidated net loss for fiscal 2026 narrowed to less than half at ₹131 crore, helped by lower expenses. Revenue from operations rose 7.5% to ₹1,687 crore from ₹1,569 crore a year earlier. ▸▸ 4

IT Majors Likely to See 2-3% Deflation in Annual Revenue

Indian IT majors TCS, Wipro, TechMahindra and LTM expect AI-led deflation to be on its way out with the firms now focusing on new growth segments. But, experts say AI-led deflation will continue to compress 2-3% in legacy IT revenues annually until the next 1-2 years. ▸▸ 4

TALKS HELD ON OTHER CRUDE SOURCES FOR INDIA

Rubio, Jaishankar Engage on Energy Security, Defence

US secretary of state Marco Rubio with external affairs minister S Jaishankar

AP

Wrapping up discussions on small issues, hope to seal trade deal shortly, says US secy of state

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: External affairs minister S Jaishankar and US secretary of state Marco Rubio met in Mumbai on Tuesday, with energy ties headlining the agenda of broad-ranging talks that also included subjects such as the bilateral trade deal, technology cooperation and defence partnership. Rubio would later hold talks with Mukesh Ambani-owned Reliance Industries about stepping up 'energy cooperation,' the state department said.

"Pleased to meet Marco Rubio in Mumbai today. We shared views on further advancement of our ties, focusing on trade, energy, technology, defence and people-to-people ties. Also exchanged views on regional developments," Jaishankar stated on X after the meeting.

Rubio's visit is taking place in the backdrop of a waiver granted by the US President to India under Russia Sanctions Act.

During a brief media interaction ahead of the meeting, Rubio, in response to a question on the trade pact, said that "a small number of items are left to be wrapped up" and hoped it will be sealed "shortly".

The two leaders also exchanged views on the West Asia situation amid a hardening in crude oil prices.

Deepening Strategic Ties ▸▸ 5

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS MINISTER BACKS DIALOGUE & DIPLOMACY

'W Asia Situation Matter of Concern'

External affairs minister S Jaishankar said West Asia crisis remained a matter of "deep concern" during talks with his UAE counterpart Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan. **Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury** reports. ▸▸ 2

AMID CONCERNS OVER ELECTRICITY, WATER CONSUMPTION

It's Unity in Diversity to Draw Data Centres

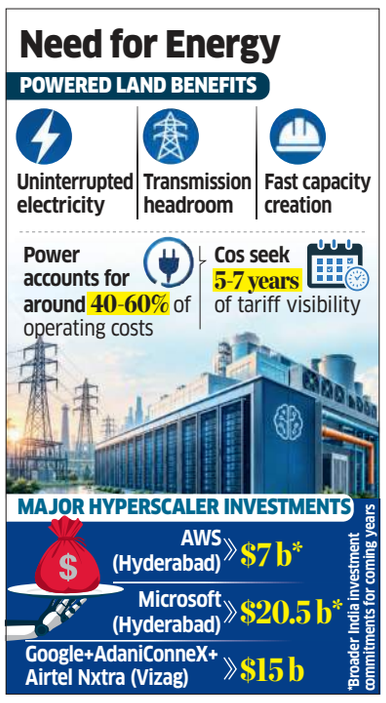
States play on their unique strengths with RE-related incentives, powered sites & easier energy procurement

Suraksha P, Subhayan Chakraborty & Dia Rekhi

Bengaluru | New Delhi | Chennai | Lucknow: As concerns over power and water consumption by data centres rise, states such as Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana, Odisha, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu are taking different approaches to attract investments in the burgeoning sector. These include renewable energy incentives, powered land at large industrial sites, independent electricity procurement and tighter scrutiny of water use, officials told **ET**.

Uttar Pradesh has decided to identify non-metro locations in the Bundelkhand and eastern regions as potential sites for data centres.

Various State Policies ▸▸ 7



AI INFRA CO EYES $300-400M VALUATION

Simplismart in Talks to Raise $40-50m

AI infrastructure startup Simplismart is in talks to raise $40-50 million at a valuation of $300-400 million, potentially more than tripling its valuation in a matter of months. **Pranav Mukul** reports. ▸▸ 4

Shelf Life Order Leaves Sweet Sellers Bitter

Mithai makers say mandate on mfg, expiry labels to disrupt biz in busy festive season

Shambhavi Anand

New Delhi: How long will a peda stay fresh? For India's mithai makers, the question is becoming a business concern ahead of Diwali as tighter food safety rules in several states require the display of manufacturing and use-by dates even on loose sweets.

Watchdog agencies in states such as Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand are among those that have made this mandatory. The directive aims to help consumers assess freshness as inspections have revealed that buyers were not always given clear information about when sweets were made or how long they remained suitable for consumption, the agencies said.

However, small and medium-sized manufacturers and sellers said that the frequent inspections and notices have made it difficult for them to operate during the festive season, when sales are at their highest. "Determining shelf life for different varieties could mean hiring external agencies, adding to costs and workload during the industry's busiest season," said Firoz H Naqvi, president of the Federation of Sweets and Namkeen Manufacturers.

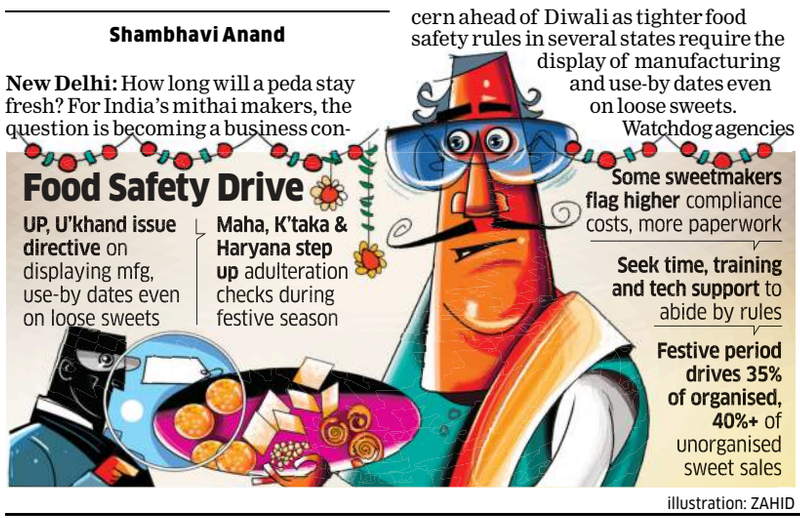


illustration: ZAHID

Eye on Adulteration ▸▸ 7

APPAREL, APPLIANCE DEMAND RISES 20%

Navratri Cheer Brings Back Shopping Spree

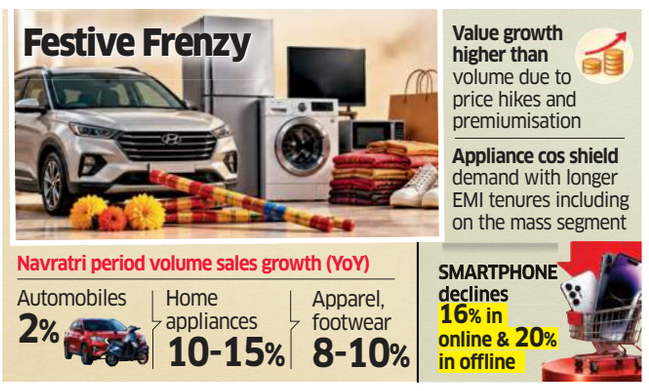
Retail car sales up 2% despite high base from post-tax cut surge last yr

Writankar Mukherjee & Sharmistha Mukherjee

Kolkata | New Delhi: Sales of apparel, footwear, refrigerators, air conditioners and washing machines increased more than 20% year-on-year during the Navratri-Dussehra festive period, alongside a modest uptick in volume or units sold, according to industry estimates. Executives attributed the growth to accessible financing options.

Car retail sales increased 2% despite a high base created by last year's post-goods and services tax (GST) rate-cut buying rush. Around 1.03 million vehicles were sold during Navratri this year, between October 11-19, compared to last year's 1.01 million units, according to dealer estimates.

Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations president Sai Giridhar said that the low growth in vehicle retail sales was not a like-for-like comparison, as last year saw huge pent-up demand following the GST rate cut.



Extended EMI Tenures ▸▸ 7

Global Roadshows to Take Off to Woo Airport Investors

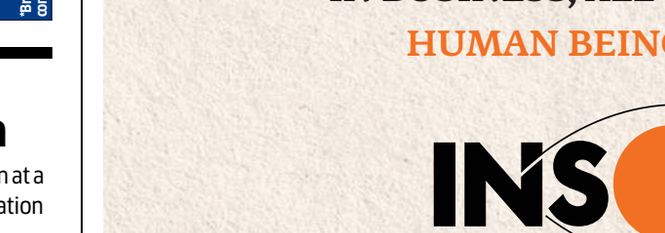
Bidding for 11 airports, bundled into five groups, set to begin by Dec

Arindam Majumder

New Delhi: The government will hold promotional roadshows in major international financial hubs to attract global investors for its upcoming airport privatisation round, according to people familiar with the matter.

Bidding for 11 airports is set to begin by December, with the goal of finalising deals by the end of FY27. For the first time, the Airports Authority of India will bundle the airports into five groups, pairing smaller facilities with larger ones under 50-year lease agreements.

"Since this is the first time airports are being offered as a bundle rather than an individual asset, roadshows will be held across the world to explain the modality to prospective bidders and get their feedback, said one of the persons, who did not wish to be identified.



Eyeing Strong Participation ▸▸ 5

PSBs Tailor New Products for Youth

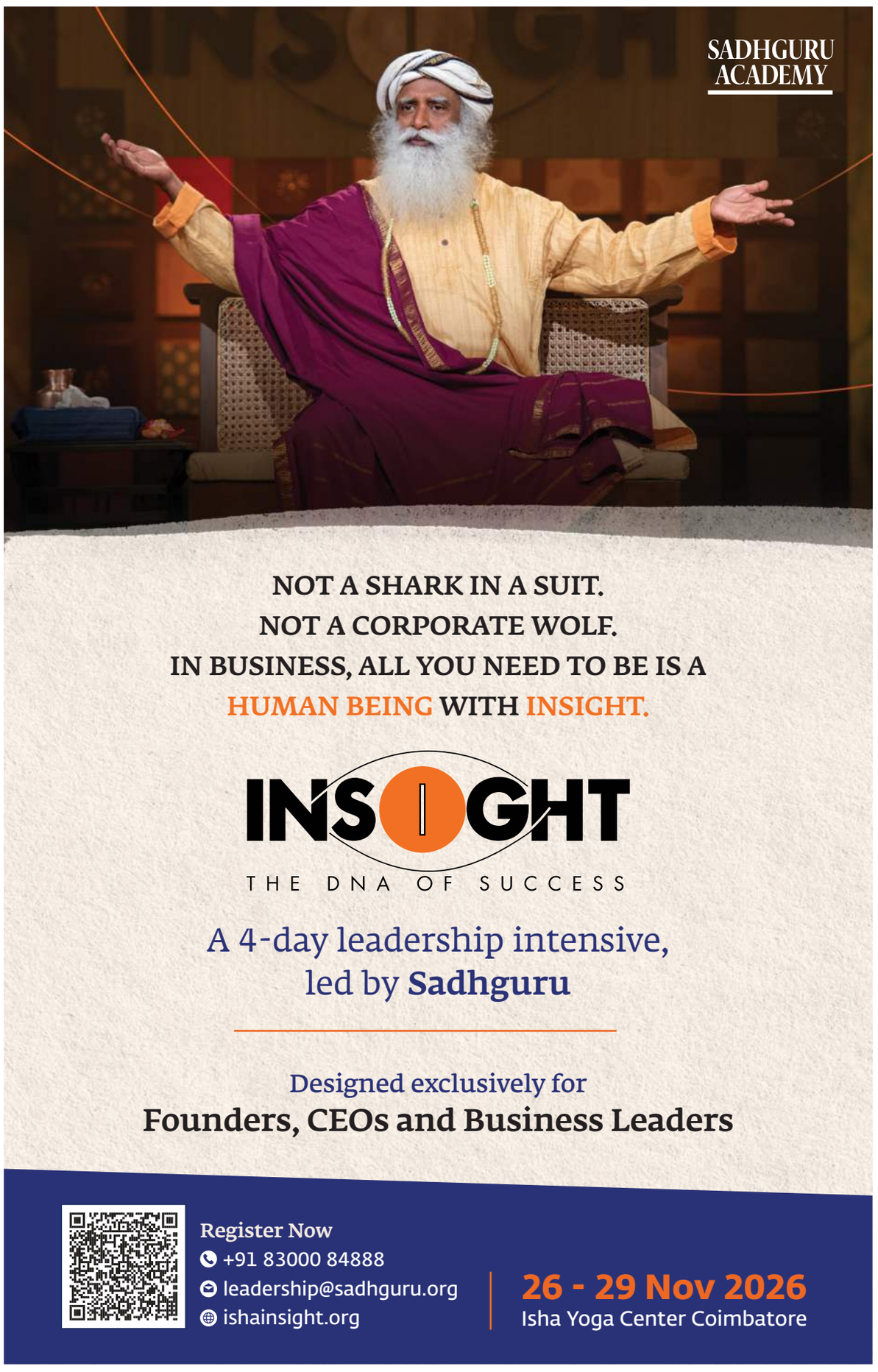
State-run banks plan to launch three products targeting youth ahead of Diwali, covering savings, investments, insurance and loans. This follows FM Nirmala Sitharaman's directive to banks to boost engagement with youth entering the formal financial system. **Dheeraj Tiwari** reports. ▸▸ 11

Oyo IPO Size may be Cut by 50% to ₹3.3kcr

Oyo parent PRISM plans to halve the size of the fresh issue in its proposed initial public offering to ₹3,350 crore. Earlier, about ₹6,650 crore was earmarked to be garnered from the fresh issue in the IPO. **Anumeha Chaturvedi** reports. ▸▸ 4

Star Highway Builders to Pay Lower Security

The Centre has linked national highway contractors' performance security to their ratings so that high performers have to furnish lower deposits, thus creating a quality-driven incentive plan for India's massive motorway network development. **Yogima Sharma** reports. ▸▸ 11



'INDIA COMMITTED TO EFFORTS TO PROMOTE PEACE'

Gulf Situation A Matter of Deep Concern: EAM in Talks With UAE Peer

ISSUES DISCUSSED

Fears of fresh US attack on Iran & Tehran's retaliation; Saudi situation amid Houthi attack; navigation through Hormuz and attacks on vessels carrying Indians

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: During talks with his UAE counterpart, Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, external affairs minister S Jaishankar on Tuesday said that the situation in West Asia remained a matter of "deep concern" and reaffirmed India's support for efforts to promote peace through dialogue and diplomacy.

This was Jaishankar's second meeting with the UAE leader in less than seven days, reflecting deep ties between New Delhi and Abu Dhabi.

UAE ports outside Hormuz have been able to trade with India and the rest of Asia

They also held in depth discussions on the West Asian situation amid fears of fresh US attack on Iran and Tehran's retaliation, situation in Saudi Arabia amid Houthi attack, and navigation through Hormuz Strait and attacks on vessels carrying Indian seafarers. UAE ports outside Hormuz Strait have been able to trade with India and the rest of Asia.

"The situation in the Gulf remains a matter of deep concern. We will continue to work together and support all efforts to promote dialogue and diplomacy. We continue to support free, safe and unimpeded flow of trade, energy and fertiliser. I would also like to thank you today and, through you, the UAE leadership for ensuring the well-being of the Indian community in the UAE," Jaishankar said in his opening remarks at the meeting.

Jaishankar also made references to the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the UAE, which has enhanced bilateral trade and economic ties.

ANI

India, UAE & US Discuss Energy, Connectivity Ties

NEW DELHI: S Jaishankar, UAE foreign minister and US secretary of state Marco Rubio held a trilateral meeting in Mumbai, exchanging views on energy and connectivity issues. Jaishankar posted on X: "...A useful exchange of perspectives on energy, connectivity and contemporary developments." Rubio stated on X: "It was great to meet with Indian external affairs minister...and UAE foreign minister...to discuss regional energy security and advance our shared economic priorities." A UAE readout said the meeting explored ways to strengthen cooperation and partnership. – OPB

Despite global headwinds and regional challenges, our economic partnership continues to set new benchmarks... Cooperation in defence, energy, tech is acquiring a strategic character

S JAISHANKAR
External Affairs Minister on UAE Ties

"Despite global headwinds and regional challenges, our economic partnership continues to set new benchmarks. Bilateral trade has crossed the $100 billion mark since the signing of CEPA, and two-way investments continue to grow," he said, adding, "Cooperation in defence, energy, technology is acquiring a strategic character."

AFTER MEETING AFFECTED FAMILIES IN GURDASPUR, SANGRUR AND MANSA

Never Felt This Sad: Shah

Vows to end Punjab drug trade by 2029; says ground reality is worse than reports in New Delhi

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: After meeting families of three people linked to Punjab's drug menace on Tuesday, Union home minister Amit Shah said he had "never felt this sad", stating that the ground reality was "far more disturbing" than reports he had read in New Delhi.

He vowed to eradicate the drug trade from Punjab by December 31, 2029. Shah began his Punjab visit in Gurdaspur, where he met the family of 40-year-old Bikramjit Singh, whose death was allegedly linked to the drug menace. He then travelled to Sangrur to meet the family of Gulzar Singh before visiting Mansa, where he met the family of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota, who was killed last week.

Shah said people affected by the 'chitta' trade had also gathered at their homes and shared their experiences. "For 30 years, I have been elected to the assembly and Lok Sabha. As Union home minister, I have met families affected by several tragic incidents and offered them condolences and support. But today, I want to tell the people of the country, especially Punjab, that I have never felt this sad," he said in Ludhiana.

"The situation in Punjab, as described by them, was far more disturbing than what I had read in reports in Delhi," Shah said. He also mounted a sharp attack on the ruling AAP, accusing the Bhagwant Mann government of failing to deliver on its promise to eradicate drugs within three months of coming to power.

Shah with Bikramjit Singh's family members in Gurdaspur on Tuesday – ANI

For 30 years, I have been elected to the assembly and Lok Sabha. As Union home minister, I have met families affected by several tragic incidents and offered them condolences and support. But today, I want to tell the people of the country, especially Punjab, that I have never felt this sad

AMIT SHAH *Union Home Minister*

THREE MEETINGS

Shah began his Punjab visit in Gurdaspur, where he met Bikramjit's family; then he travelled to Sangrur to meet Gulzar's family before visiting Mansa, where he met Parvinder Singh Jhota's family

Stop Treating Drug Crisis as Political Opportunity: AAP

CHANDIGARH: As Amit Shah called out the AAP government in Punjab, state finance minister Harpal Singh Cheema said Shah must explain what the Centre has done to dismantle drug supply chains operating beyond Punjab's borders. He said the Centre must stop treating Punjab's drug crisis as a "political opportunity". – PTI

Shutdown Cripples Manipur Valley Dists

PROTEST AGAINST KILLING OF 3 VILLAGERS 'No untoward incident in shutdown-affected areas'

Bikash Singh

Guwahati: Normal life was disrupted across Manipur's valley on Tuesday as a 48-hour shutdown called by a civil society organisation over the killing of three Meitei villagers led to closure of shops, markets, educational institutions, business establishments and government and private offices.

Public transport remained off the roads while members of Native People Committee Manipur, which called the shutdown, blocked roads and staged protests in parts of Imphal East and Imphal West. Three people were killed and three others injured when suspected militants opened fire on a group of villagers who had gone to collect firewood in Kangpokpi district on Monday, police said.

Police said no untoward incident had been reported in the shutdown-affected areas on Tuesday, despite protests along several national and state highways besides other locations.

Sources said three suspects involved in the shooting incident were arrested. A cache of arms and ammunition were recovered.

Protesters burn effigies of political leaders in Imphal East on Tuesday – PTI

Manipur CM Meets INDIA Bloc Leaders

IMPHAL: Manipur CM Y Khemchand Singh on Tuesday held a meeting with INDIA bloc leaders, including state Congress chief Okram Ibobi Singh and CLP leader K Meghachandra Singh in the wake of the killing of three people. **The meeting, held at the CM Secretariat here, was also attended by Lok Sabha MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam** and leaders of various political parties belonging to the Opposition bloc. – PTI

No Place for those Who Finance, Support Terrorists: Singh at SCO

Urges member states to make concerted efforts to dismantle terror ecosystem

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: Calling upon Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) member states to make concerted efforts to dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorism, defence minister Rajnath Singh said that there should be no place for those who provide safe havens to terrorists.

Addressing the 25th meeting of the Council of Heads of Government of the SCO in Dushanbe on Tuesday, he said that terrorist activities not only result in the loss of innocent lives but also disrupt investments and commerce.

"There can be no justification for terrorism, no double standards in addressing it, and no place for those who finance, support or provide safe havens to terrorists," Singh said, adding that the entire ecosystem of terrorism must be firmly eliminated.

On SCO, Singh said there is a need to build consensus and translate it into concrete action to address the uncertain global economic environment marked by geopolitical tensions, disruptions to trade and supply chains, concerns over energy and food security, and emerging technological divides. "There is a need to strengthen resilient supply chains, facilitate trade and investment, and leverage technology to drive development," he said.

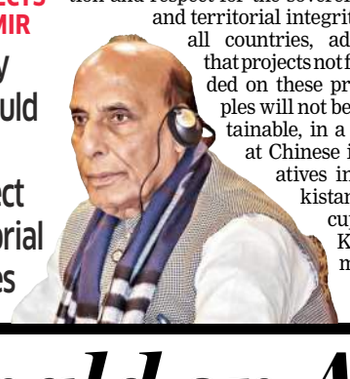
The minister said India supports the adoption of an Action Plan for the Multilateral Trade and Economic Cooperation Programme for 2026-2030. India's belief, he said, is that SCO should remain steadfast in its adherence to the principles of sovereign equality, consensus and mutual respect. He also welcomed the decision to establish the Universal Centre in Tashkent and the Anti-Drug Centre in Dushanbe as permanent bodies of SCO.

The minister also reaffirmed India's support for initiatives that link markets, facilitate trade and create new avenues for development. In particular, he mentioned that initiatives such as the International North-South Transport Corridor and the Chabahar Port can contribute significantly to connecting Central Asia with broader markets.

Singh further said that connectivity projects should be based on consultation and respect for the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all countries, adding that projects not founded on these principles will not be sustainable, in a hint at Chinese initiatives in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.

SINGH ON CHINESE PROJECTS IN PAK-OCCUPIED KASHMIR

Connectivity projects should be based on consultation and respect for sovereignty, territorial integrity of all countries



AMID REPORTS OF MOVE TO CONVENE EXTENDED SITTING OF MONSOON SESSION

Does Govt have a New Proposal for Delimitation, asks Congress

Silent on Rijiju's claim that Congress brass didn't give date for talks with government

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Congress on Tuesday responded to parliamentary affairs minister Kiran Rijiju's reply to party chief Mallikarjun Kharge by asking whether the Centre had a new proposal for delimitation or whether it intended to again push the same Constitution (Amendment) Bill that was defeated during the last budget session.

"Does the Modi government have a firm new proposal for delimitation that it has discussed with any party? Is it the Modi government's intention to bring back the defeated bill and make another attempt to get it passed with a super-tainted two-thirds majority, that will no doubt fail again?" asked Congress spokesman Jairam Ramesh.

However, the Congress response skirted Rijiju's statement that the Opposition party's leadership did not communicate any date to the government side for consultation on the delimitation bill, despite the government asking for it. This makes political circles wonder whether Congress now asking about any new delimitation proposal is its way of trying to open a dialogue with the government, more so when many other parties, including SP, DMK, Shiv Sena, NCP-SP, YSRCP and BJD have already held discussions with government representatives on the delimitation plan amid reports of a move to convene an extended sitting of the monsoon session.

This time Congress refrained from criticising the government on the monsoon session still not being prorogued after Rijiju listed past instances of long gaps before proroguing sessions, including an 87-day phase during the UPA government. Ramesh, however, questioned why the government had been refusing to call an all-party meeting on the delimitation bill.

List of Legal, Constitutional Violations Growing; CEC Gyanesh Kumar Must Resign: Congress

NEW DELHI: Congress has alleged it is now well-established how CEC Gyanesh Kumar put in place ECINET portal to centralise all "manipulations" of the poll process. Congress claimed that the list of legal and constitutional violations is growing and Kumar must resign. Party spokesman Jairam Ramesh shared on X a screenshot of a media report which claimed that **ECINET portal carries a feature that can bar electoral registration officers and assistant EROs only in West Bengal.** – PTI

OTHER NEWS OF THE DAY

PTI

Panel Headed by Retd Judge be Appointed to Probe Chorbagan Stampede: Cal HC

'Sitting judge cannot be appointed to head an inquiry'

Press Trust Of India

Kolkata: Calcutta High Court on Tuesday directed that the West Bengal government set up a commission of inquiry headed by a retired judge of the court to inquire into the stampede at Chorbagan Durga puja pandal on October 17 that claimed 19 lives.

A bench presided by chief justice Ravindra Ghuge said that a sitting judge of the high court cannot be appointed to head an inquiry **in accordance with a Supreme Court directive, as was prayed for by the Adhikari government.**

Chief minister Suvendu Adhikari had said that a sitting judge of HC would head a special investigation team to be formed to probe the incident.

FILE PHOTO

State-Sponsored Terror: Mamata Over Extension of Custody of 2 CJP Leaders

Press Trust Of India

Kolkata | New Delhi: A day after two CJP leaders were remanded to judicial custody for two more days, former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee on Tuesday accused the central authorities of perpetrating "state-sponsored terrorism" and "police-sponsored atrocities" and demanded their immediate release.

CJP's Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka move Delhi HC against judicial custody

She also alleged that CJP co-convenors Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were being subjected to torture.

Meanwhile, Das and Ranka have approached Delhi High Court, seeking an urgent hearing against the extension of their judicial custody. They have sought a night hearing in the high court, which is shut this week due to Dussehra vacation.

European Donald on A Mission to Mould Ties With India

Historic goodwill is real; the test is whether both governments can convert it into enduring investments, contracts, cooperation

ANIL WADHWA

Poland's Prime Minister Donald Tusk arrives in India on October 21 with the aim of recasting the strategic partnership announced in 2024 into meaningful action in trade, technology and security.

His three-day visit, which will include talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi on October 22, and business programmes in New Delhi and Bengaluru, comes at a time when Europe is reassessing its security and economic partnerships, and India looks to widen its room for manoeuvre in an unsettled world.

For Warsaw, India is a large market and too consequential to remain peripheral. Poland has become the largest economy in central and eastern Europe and a central player in European security. Its position on NATO's eastern flank, support for Ukraine and defence investment have raised its profile in Brussels. It also wants to diversify markets, secure industrial supply chains and find new outlets for competitive manufacturers. India offers scale, a growing industrial base and an independent voice in international affairs.

For New Delhi, Poland provides a way to deepen engagement with Europe beyond its traditional western centres and cultivate a partner with weight inside the European Union. The two governments need not agree on every geopolitical question, but frank discussion on Ukraine, Russia and Indo-Pacific would clarify expectations.

During the Second World War, India's princely states gave refuge to Polish civilians displaced by the conflict. Maharaja Digvijaysinhji of Nawanagar welcomed Polish children at Balachadi in Gujarat; Kolhapur also sheltered refugees. The "Good Maharaja" remains a cherished figure in Poland, giving bilateral ties a human connection rare in diplomacy. Formal relations were established in 1954.

Bilateral trade between India and Poland reached $6.36 billion in 2025, according to Indian official figures. India's main exports to Poland include pharmaceuticals, textiles, chemicals, engineering goods, vehicles and electrical machinery, while Poland's exports to India include industrial equipment, chemicals, metals and specialised manufactures. Yet, trade remains modest relative to both economies. Warsaw will want more Polish products and investment to reach Indian customers. New Delhi will press for partnerships that go beyond finished-goods exports to create local production, technology transfer and skilled employment.

Polish investment in India is estimated at roughly $600 million. It includes tangible, job-creating ventures: Can-Pack manufactures metal packaging at Aurangabad; TZMO makes hygiene products and operates in Dindigul, Bengaluru and Mumbai; Maflow supplies automotive components.

Polish firms have also pursued opportunities in mining equipment, clean technologies and transport. Solaris, the Polish electric-bus maker, has entered the Indian market through cooperation with JBM Auto. These investments remain modest, but provide the relationship with an important industrial base. India will look to use the visit to attract more Polish capital into electric mobility, rail, waste management, advanced manufacturing and clean energy.

The investment story also runs in the other direction. Indian investment in Poland exceeds $3 billion, with Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys, HCL Technologies and Wipro among the prominent employers. Indian firms have built technology operations and manufacturing links, employing thousands of Polish professionals.

Bengaluru should be more than a second stop for the strong business delegation accompanying Donald Tusk. The India-Poland Business Forum scheduled there on October 23, alongside meetings with technology and space-sector stakeholders, offers a chance to give the partnership an innovation focus. The city's software ecosystem, start-ups, aerospace capabilities and research institutions can connect with Polish strengths in digital services, industrial engineering, cybersecurity and space applications.

Useful outcomes would include company agreements, university links, and joint proposals in satellite applications, green energy, mining equipment, food processing, artificial intelligence, cyber resilience and advanced manufacturing. For example, Poland's largest space company, ICI, is expected to ink agreements in space surveillance capabilities utilising synthetic aperture radar (SAR) satellites.

AGH University of Krakow and International Institute of Information Technology Bengaluru will ink an MoU on skilling, training, start-up linkages and education focusing on artificial intelligence and quantum technologies.

New Delhi's political talks should set the direction; Bengaluru should test whether businesses can deliver.

The visit should produce commitments with deadlines: A trade-and-investment roadmap towards the stated $10 billion trade ambition; a mechanism to address market-access barriers; an investment pipeline in manufacturing and clean technology; and, under the working group on defence industry, advancing joint defence manufacturing, technology development, resilient supply chains, maintenance and specialised systems.

Accompanying Minister for Finance and Economy Andrej Domanski has highlighted increasing Polish defence exports to India, which includes potential drone supplies for the Indian army. Both sides should identify two or three joint technology projects and set dates to review progress.

The 30,000-strong Indian community in Poland can help sustain that momentum. Poland wants a stronger economic foothold in India; India seeks more diverse European partners and access to Polish industrial and technological capabilities.

The historic goodwill is real. The test is whether both governments can convert it into enduring investments, contracts and cooperation.

FOCUSING ON STRENGTHS

REUTERS

The writer is ex-secretary (east), MEA, who also served as ambassador to Poland

This newspaper is published by Rajeev Yadav at Times House, 7, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi -110002, Phone: 011-23302000 on behalf of Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd., edited by Chaitali Chakravarty (Responsible for selection of news under PRB Act) and printed by Manish Sinha at the Times of India Press, 13/1 & 2 , Site IV Industrial Area, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad (UP). REGD. OFFICE: Dr Dadabhai Naoroji Road, Mumbai-400 001. © Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission of the publisher is prohibited. All rights reserved. **RNI NO.** 26749/74 | MADE IN New Delhi | AIR CHARGE Leh & via Leh & via ₹2.00

Bhagwat in Nagpur on Tuesday –IANS

RSS CHIEF WARNS OF 'STORM FROM WEST'

Protests Alone Rarely Resolve Issues: Bhagwat

'Regime change will not change the situation on ground, India ultimate target'

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat said protests alone rarely solved problems and cautioned that international forces seeking to destabilise the country could exploit local issues to pursue their efforts.

In his Vijayadashami speech in Nagpur on Tuesday, two months after he acknowledged the concerns raised by students who were protesting for the removal of then education minister Dharmendra Pradhan, Bhagwat said changing a regime would not change the situation on the ground. He referred to the demonstrations and riots in France and elsewhere in Europe as a "storm", which seeks to destroy "every kind of system, every form of civility, every standard and every cultural and human value".

"Look at what is happening in France, what has happened in Bangladesh and what happened in Nepal. There is talk that these are carefully orchestrated by some forces," the sarsanghchalak said.

India is the "ultimate target" of those making regime change operations around the world, he said.

Bhagwat acknowledged that there were problems since the country had not yet become fully developed.

"In a democracy, protests are bound to take place but what should be the purpose of a protest? It should be to find a solution," he said. "If the objective of a movement is to resolve a problem, then the group organising it, the government and administration acting to maintain peace and order, and political leaders must all ensure that their actions do not create discord, mutual hostility, bitterness, or division within our united society."

MUST REMAIN UNITED

The forces that work against the country use social issues to create a sense of injustice and victimhood, and seek to isolate people and turn them into separate groups. They seek to undermine people's faith in the institutions, provoke conflict and create an atmosphere of disorder and anarchy, he said. Irrespective of the caste, creed and religion, the country has to remain united, Bhagwat said.

'One-sided development has led to environmental instability throughout Himalayas'

RESTRICTING INFORMATION

The RSS chief suggested that the government explore whether India could follow western countries in restricting information, particularly through OTT platforms, to the youth.

Bhagwat termed substance abuse as a national problem.

He also spoke about the recent Nepal tragedy and said the one-sided approach to development being pursued across the region contributed to environmental instability throughout the Himalayas.

UNITE AGAINST FORCES SEEKING TO DIVIDE SOCIETY: PM

Modi Invokes Ram Rajya, Calls For Equality And Justice For All

Rakesh Mohan Chaturvedi

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi invoked Lord Ram at the Dussehra celebrations on Tuesday evening, emphasising that Ram-rajya is an ideal where there is no discrimination. With the Uttar Pradesh assembly elections just months away, he recalled how Lord Ram embraced the Nishad king and honoured Mata Shabari, both from backward castes, and accepted his exile and coronation with equal detachment.

Reciting a Sanskrit couplet at the Vijayadashami celebrations, the prime minister said, "Neither was there any happiness on Lord Ram's face when he was crowned, nor did he feel any sadness when he went into exile. He followed the path of dharma even while dealing with a crisis and upheld righteousness."

In his speech, the prime minister recalled the pledge taken at the consecration of the Ram temple at Ayodhya of taking the nation from "Ram to Rashtra (nation)" and "Dev to desh (from God to country)" and expressed confidence that this will be realised.

Modi's remarks on Lord Ram and the Ayodhya temple come months ahead of the Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, due in March-April.

"Ram-rajya is an administration where there is no discrimination against anybody, where everyone gets justice and equal opportunity. The aim of those in government is not to rule but the welfare of the people... We have to move with the mantra of 'citizen is God'," the prime minister said, adding that the welfare of the poor and the weak must remain a top priority for the government.

He said that no matter how big the crisis or difficulty, the country should not depend on others to bail it out.

PM Modi at a Dussehra festival in Delhi – PTI

MEETING EVERY CHALLENGE OURSELVES

No matter how big the crisis or difficulty, the country should not depend on others to bail it out, says Modi

FILE PHOTO

Mirwaiz Flags 6-day Eviction Notice to Race Course Mosque

Owaisi seeks Rijiju's intervention amid reports of likely demolition

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: Hurriyat leader Mirwaiz Umar Farooq expressed concern over the six-day eviction notice given to the Race Course mosque in Delhi, a gazetted Waqf property since 1977 and a listed heritage site.

"Deeply disturbing that Delhi's historic Race Course Mosque, a gazetted Waqf property since 1977 and a listed heritage site, faces eviction within six days. Equally alarming is the reported failure of the Waqf authorities to defend it. Is this becoming the new normal for Muslim places of worship?" the Mirwaiz said on Tuesday.

Owaisi highlights there is no Delhi Waqf Board at present

He said this was precisely why he strongly opposed the Waqf amendments and increased government control through appointed nominees over Muslim religious endowments.

'GAZETTED WAQF PROPERTY'

Meanwhile, All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen chief Asaduddin Owaisi on Tuesday urged Union Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju to intervene immediately amid reports that the Race Course Mosque in New Delhi is facing demolition. In a post on X, Owaisi listed three concerns, stating that the Mosque is a gazetted waqf property but the waqf board has not intervened. He also highlighted there is no Delhi Waqf Board at present.—PTI

SENA CHIEF SLAMS POLICE ACTION AGAINST CJP

We Are Here For Regime Change, Says Uddhav

Uddhav at Shivaji Park – PTI

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: Shiv Sena leader Uddhav Thackeray on Tuesday said the BJP government at the centre had failed on all fronts and that his party was for 'a regime change.' Thackeray took on the government for its 'atrocities' on the Cockroach Janta Party cadres and warned that a fierce fight to bring down the government is soon going to ensue.

"If people are not getting any justice from the police, courts, bureaucracy, and if they come on to the roads, you are calling them naxals and goons. Your police fell on them, mistreated women, tearing their clothes and beating them up. It is their right to protest for the youths as it was their votes that were stolen. If you steal everyone's vote, what else does one seek other than regime change? Yes, we are here for regime change," said Uddhav Thackeray addressing his annual Dussehra rally at Mumbai's Shivaji Park.

Maharashtra minister Ashish Selar with Tiger Shroff on Tuesday –PTI

Tiger Shroff Firing: Police to Bring Shooters to Mumbai Today

Our Political Bureau

Mumbai: Mumbai Crime Branch teams reached Kota on Tuesday and are expected to bring the three shooters in the firing incident involving Tiger Shroff to Mumbai on Wednesday. They will be produced before a court, where the police will seek their custody for further interrogation.

Investigators want to establish who masterminded the conspiracy, when and where the plot was hatched, what the exact plan was and what motive lay behind the firing. "The probe will also focus on whether the attack was linked to an extortion demand or intended as a threat, why Tiger Shroff was specifically chosen as the target, and whether he was the intended target from the outset," a senior police official said on condition of anonymity.

On Sunday, at around 7 pm, when Shroff was leaving a Juhu ground after his football practice, the three accused — Phool Singh, Hrithik Kumar alias Roshan and Rehan Ansari — were allegedly waiting outside the premises. Singh and Ansari allegedly opened fire, discharging five rounds. One of the pistols jammed during the shooting, preventing them from firing further. Kumar, who was waiting on a motorcycle, allegedly started the vehicle after the firing and fled with the other two.

The Bishnoi gang has allegedly claimed responsibility for the firing through a social media post and an audio recording circulated online.

VISIT INDIA'S LEADING SHOW OF

INTERNATIONAL REAL ESTATE & IMMIGRATION PROGRAMS

IREX INTERNATIONAL REALESTATE EXPO 2026 | IREX RESIDENCY & CITIZENSHIP CONCLAVE 2026

NEW DELHI

EXHIBITION & CONFERENCE

23-24 OCTOBER

11AM-7PM

FREE ENTRY

LE MERIDIEN HOTEL, NEW DELHI

EXPLORE US EB-5 INVESTOR VISA PROGRAM

DISCOVER EUROPE'S TOP GOLDEN VISA OPTIONS

FIND REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES IN GEORGIA, DUBAI, SHARJAH, GREECE, PORTUGAL & MORE

PARTICIPATION BY 20+ INTERNATIONAL REAL ESTATE & IMMIGRATION COMPANIES FROM 10+ COUNTRIES

IREX is the must-attend show for Investors, Wealth Advisors and Property Consultants seeking to explore the best global residency, citizenship, and property investment options.

Lead Partners: ALLIANCE GROUP, AZIZI

Platinum Partners: AL RASIKHOON REAL ESTATE, CMB REGIONAL CENTERS, NK

Conference Partners: LUX&EASY, VAKON, GOUDER & Associates

Media Partner: NDTV Profit

Knowledge Partner: Knight Frank

For any queries contact:
Soni: +91 99993 57578
Sakshi: +91 96678 62760

www.IrexIndia.com

SCAN TO PRE-REGISTER
Or Visit IREXindia.com/visitor for Free Registration

Global Indian International School | ONE WORLD INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Study in Singapore.
Prepare for the world.

GIIS AND OWIS IN SINGAPORE.
GATEWAY TO THE WORLD'S TOP UNIVERSITIES
HARVARD, OXFORD, CAMBRIDGE, NUS, NTU, IMPERIAL, NYU AND MANY MORE.

NOW OFFERING BOARDING

CHOICE OF CURRICULUM
IB | CAMBRIDGE | CBSE
Globally recognised pathways to match your child's aspirations.

A TRULY GLOBAL COMMUNITY
70+ NATIONALITIES
Building lifelong friendships and a global mindset.

WINNER OF THE DEMING PRIZE JAPAN, 2025

ADMISSIONS OPEN FOR GRADE 9 AND 11

MEET US IN YOUR CITY

CITY	DATE
PUNE - Ritz Carlton, Yerawada	24th Oct, 2026
MUMBAI - Trident, BKC	25th Oct, 2026
NEW DELHI & GURUGRAM Pullman New Delhi Aerocity	25th Oct, 2026
BENGALURU The Leela Palace, Garden City	31st Oct, 2026
HYDERABAD The Leela Hyderabad, Banjara Hills	31st Oct, 2026
KOLKATA - Hindusthan International	1st Nov, 2026
CHENNAI - Taj Connemara	1st Nov, 2026

REGISTER NOW

+91 92400 18918 | +65 8198 1609

Global Schools Group | Global Network | 64 Campuses | 11 Countries | 45,000 Students

ET tech
For comprehensive and insightful stories about all things startups and technology, log on to **www.ettech.com**

Tweet OF THE DAY

ALEX HORMOZI
@ALEXHORMOZI

The courage to try, the humility to learn, the will to never give up.

FROM THE PRISM: RESIDUAL DEBT REPAYMENT IN 2-3 YEARS

Oyo IPO Size Could be Cut by 50% to ₹3,350 crore

Sources say holding co PRISM requires fewer external funds due to better performance

Anumeha Chaturvedi

New Delhi: Oyo parent PRISM plans to halve the size of the fresh issue in its proposed initial public offering (IPO) to ₹3,350 crore, sources familiar with the matter said, pointing to the need for less external funds due to better company performance.

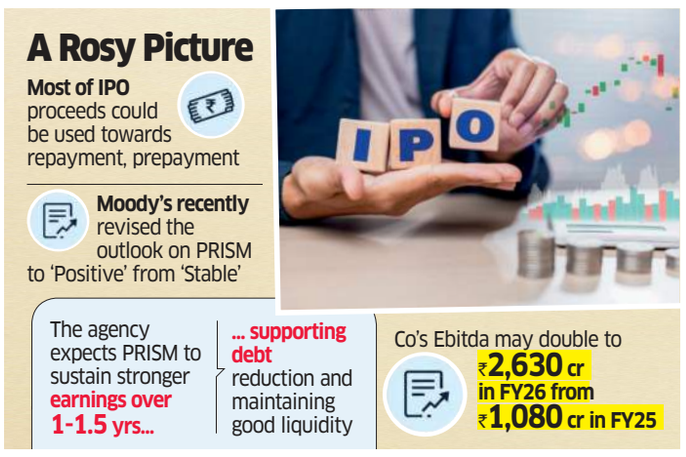
Earlier, about ₹6,650 crore was earmarked to be garnered from the fresh issue, sources told **ET**.

The reduction in the issue size follows a stronger balance-sheet position, which has lowered the amount of capital the company needs to raise compared with what was planned previously, said the people cited above.

The company did not respond to requests for comment.

A source said funding requirements have come down, and the company is reducing the amount of primary capital it was planning to raise.

"The company intends to repay the residual debt over the next two to three years through cash flows generated by the business," another person said.



Under the revised structure, most of the issue proceeds are proposed to be used towards repayment or prepayment, in part or full, of certain borrowings.

The revised issue comes as PRISM moves towards the next stage of its proposed IPO following its earlier filing of the UDRHP-I.

Global ratings agency Moody's recently revised the outlook on PRISM to Positive from Stable, while affirming the company's B2 corporate family rating.

Moody's expects that PRISM will sustain stronger earnings and free cash flow generation over the next 12–18 months, supporting further debt reduction and maintaining very good liquidity.

The revised issue comes as PRISM moves towards the next stage of its proposed IPO following its earlier filing of the UDRHP-I

Moody's also expects PRISM's earnings before interest, tax depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) to grow to approximately ₹3,000 crore over the next 12–18 months, supported by continued expansion of its global hospitality network and the addition of new storefronts to its platform.

The agency highlighted the company's improving profitability, with (EBITDA) more than doubling to ₹2,630 crore in FY26 from ₹1,080 crore in FY25.

'Performance-based'

Qualcomm to Cut Jobs Worldwide

Qualcomm will cut jobs globally in a "performance-focused reduction" following its annual employee reviews, CEO Cristiano Amon told staff in a memo late on Monday, with notifications set to begin in November. The cuts are part of an effort to build "a stronger performance culture" and address situations where the company "has consistently fallen short of expectations," Amon said. Qualcomm did not immediately respond to a request for comment. It had about 52,000 employees globally as of September last year, most of them full-time. Its financial year typically ends in late September. One of the world's biggest smartphone chipmakers, Qualcomm has been hit this year by a slump in consumer electronics sales as soaring memory prices weigh on demand in key markets.

-Reuters

$320m

AI meeting-transcription co Otter.ai closed a $320 m deal in growth financing from General Catalyst's Customer Value Fund to expand ops

Banks Affected

Google Cloud Down in UK, Re-instated

A disruption at Google's cloud operations in London on Tuesday affected the websites and mobile apps of several banks, financial firms and public service providers in the region, highlighting how businesses and services have become critically dependent on digital infrastructure. Later on, Alphabet's said that full service has been restored in its London-based cloud region after a "power event" disrupted multiple cloud services. British digital bank Revolut also suffered a service outage related to the disruption in. a source said. Revolut's status page showed most of its services were unavailable or partially available, including card payments and ATM withdrawals. "We are currently experiencing a service disruption affecting multiple services. We can confirm that all our customers' money and data are safe," it said on X.

-Reuters

Numberswatch

It's results season, anyone perspiring?

UpGrad's FY26 Net Loss Halves to ₹ 131 cr

Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: The Ronnie Screwvala-led higher education and upskilling platform UpGrad's consolidated net loss for fiscal 2026 narrowed to less than half at ₹131 crore, helped by lower expenses.

Revenue from operations rose 7.5% to ₹1,687 crore from ₹1,569 crore a year earlier, according to the company's audited consolidated financial statements filed with the Registrar of Companies. In FY25, UpGrad reported a net loss of ₹274 crore.

Fiscal 2026 was the last full year before UpGrad's results start to reflect the financials of Unacademy, the SoftBank-backed online test-preparation platform it acquired in September. The acquisition expanded UpGrad's presence into online test preparation alongside its existing higher education, enterprise training and study-abroad businesses.

Revenue from operations rose 7.5% to ₹1,687 crore from ₹1,569 crore a year earlier

COSTS COME DOWN

UpGrad's expenses fell 4.3% to ₹1,860 crore from ₹1,943 crore in FY25, largely due to lower depreciation and amortisation, advertising and technology-related costs. Depreciation and amortisation expenses fell 31% to Rs 124 crore, while advertising and promotional spending dropped 4% to ₹292 crore. Information technology expenses nearly halved to ₹21 crore. Employee benefit expenses rose 5% to ₹738 crore.

The consumer-facing business, which includes higher education programmes, university partnerships and study-abroad services, reported a 13% increase in revenue to ₹1,337 crore.

The segment posted a profit of ₹151 crore before depreciation, finance costs and taxes, compared with a loss of ₹13 crore a year earlier. The enterprise business, which provides training, placement and upskilling services to companies, saw revenue decline 9% to ₹350 crore.

Innovist's Revenue Nearly Triples to ₹686 cr

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: Beauty and personal care company Innovist posted operating revenue of ₹686 crore for fiscal 2026 — nearly three times higher compared with ₹247 crore the previous year — ahead of its acquisition by French cosmetics product giant L'Oreal. This makes Innovist one of the fastest-growing new-age brands in the space.

L'Oreal announced in June that it would acquire a majority stake in Gurugram-based Innovist, the parent of brands such as Bare Anatomy, Chemist at Play and SunScoop, at a valuation of around ₹4,100 crore. The transaction closed this month.

People familiar with the matter said Innovist's monthly revenue grew 50% between June and September.

The numbers give a boost to Innovist ahead of its acquisition by French cosmetics product giant L'Oreal

Documents sourced from the Registrar of Companies showed that Innovist's net profit rose to ₹21.5 crore in FY26, from ₹11.5 crore in FY25 when a tax credit had boosted its bottom line. Its earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) surged to ₹36.1 crore from ₹1.5 crore, indicating a sharp improvement in operating profitability.

Advertising and business promotion was the company's largest expense at ₹262 crore in FY26, accounting for nearly 40% of its total expenses. Despite the improvement in operating earnings, a higher tax outgo weighed on its net profit.

At around ₹4,100 crore, the L'Oreal transaction surpassed Hindustan Unilever's acquisition of Peak XV Partners-backed skincare brand Minimalist at a valuation of ₹2,955 crore in January 2025, making it the largest acquisition of an Indian direct-to-consumer brand.

Founded in 2018 by Rohit Chawla, Vimal Bhola and Sifat Khurana, Innovist's acquisition also marks Chawla's second major exit in the personal care sector. He previously cofounded

The Man Company, which was fully acquired by Kolkata-based FMCG maker Emami in 2024. Emami had first bought a strategic stake in the business in 2017.

Prior to the L'Oreal acquisition, Innovist was backed by the likes of consumer venture capital firm Sauce, ICICI Venture and Amazon.

DESPITE AN UPTICK IN AI-RELATED EARNINGS....

...IT Majors Likely to See 2-3% Deflation in Annual Revenue

50-60% slump period in $300 b industry already over, say technology co heads

Beena Parmar

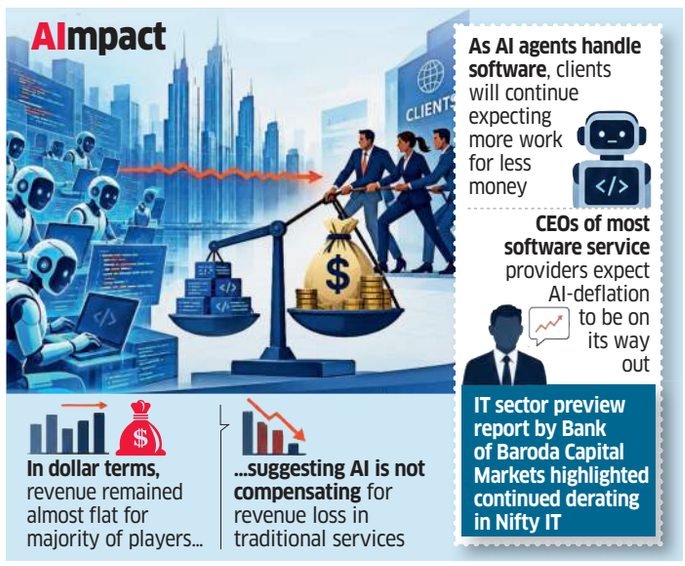
Bengaluru: Artificial Intelligence (AI)-led deflation is likely to continue compressing 2-3% annually in legacy IT revenues over next 1-2 years for the $300 billion industry, even as some of the company chiefs see productivity headwinds behind them, experts say.

Of India's top tier software services exporters which reported earnings for the second quarter (Q2) of ongoing fiscal year Q2FY27 earnings so far, most of them including Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Tech Mahindra and LTM (formerly LTIMindtree) reported uptick in AI revenues. Nonetheless, there is divergence in the overall growth. In dollar terms, revenue remained almost flat for majority of the players, suggesting that the deflation is not propelling incremental revenue and AI is not compensating for the revenue loss in traditional services.

AI-driven revenue deflation has been happening across the software services industry where AI and automation is making routine coding and software-related tasks and services faster and cheaper to produce for clients which in turn is reducing the total billing or revenue for IT majors eating into their core business, even as the amount of actual work or output increases. "I don't believe AI-led deflation is anywhere near finished," said Phil Fersht, founder and chief analyst of HFS group, a US-based technology consultancy firm.

The first wave of productivity benefits, according to Fersht, has already been reflected in many contract renewals, but as AI agents become increasingly capable of handling software engineering, application maintenance and business operations, clients will continue expecting more work for less money.

"Some market estimates suggest an annual revenue drag of 2-3% in traditional services, Fersht said adding although this is directional rather than a reliably measured industry figure.



The derating is driven by advanced AI models, which are capable of disrupting IT services in a bigger way than expected

Meanwhile, the chief executives of most of the software service providers expect the AI-deflation to be on its way out with the teams now focusing on new growth segments in the traditional services.

"I would say around 50% of the deflation is what would have happened, and another 50% is something that will happen, maybe over the next 18 months or so," TCS chief executive K Krithivasan told **ET** in an interview after the earnings were declared on October 9. The TCS head predicts the AI revenue - which crossed 10% of the total in the September quarter at $3.1 billion—should compensate for deflation in traditional services in the medium term.

Bengaluru-based rival Wipro's chief financial officer Aparna Iyer said a lot of the contracts that we've had have been refreshed and renewed. "We should be at that inflection curve in a few quarters."

A day prior to the TCS earnings announcement, an IT sector preview report by Bank of Baroda Capital Markets highlighted there is continued derating in Nifty IT (after a 23-percentage points underperformance in 2025).

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
www.economictimes.com

RIDING ON THE AI-WAY

Simplismart in Talks to Raise $40-50 m, Tripling its Valuation

AI startup to benefit as investors step up bets on limited pool of new-age tech biz in India

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: AI infrastructure startup Simplismart is in talks to raise $40-50 million at a valuation of $300-400 million, potentially more than tripling its valuation in a matter of months, as investors step up bets on a limited pool of artificial intelligence businesses in India, according to people aware of the development.

Peak XV Partners and Damac Digital, the data centre arm of Dubai-based real estate group Damac, are in discussions to invest in Simplismart, the people said.

The company earlier this year closed a $20-25 million financing round with participation from chipmaker Nvidia at a valuation of $100-120 million. **ET** first reported on this round on May 18.

Founded in 2022 by former Oracle and Google engineers Amritanshu Jain and Devansh Ghatak, Simplismart helps enterprises simplify the deployment of AI models.

"The opportunity in AI deployment is becoming quite significant because companies are moving beyond experimenting with models to actually deploying them in production. That creates demand for platforms that can make inference more efficient, reduce costs and help enterprises scale without building everything in-house," a VC investor backing AI firms said.

"We are looking for businesses with a clear technology advantage and strong enterprise use cases, and that is where companies like Simplismart stand out," the investor added.

Simplismart, which has offices in Bengaluru and San Francisco, is backed by Accel, Titan Capital, Dallas Venture Capital, LetsVenture and several angel investors. Its customers include Swiggy, Yubi, Invideo, PhysicsWallah and Tata 1mg.

"There are very few investable AI opportunities in India right now," said another venture capital investor who had evaluated Simplismart. "Everyone is talking about AI, but when you look at companies that have built real technology and can scale into meaningful businesses, the pool becomes quite small. So, when you find a company operating in a space where enterprises are beginning to spend, investors are willing to move quickly and pay up for it."

Email queries sent to Jain did not elicit a response until press time on Tuesday. Peak XV Partners declined to comment, while Damac Digital did not respond to ET's queries.

Beyond Simplismart, ET reported in July that AI integration startup UnifyApps was in discussions with private equity firm EQT to raise $100-120 million in a fresh funding round.

Wipro GE HealthCare Mulls Fifth India Plant

Doubling of exports also on the wishlist

Puran Choudhary

Bengaluru: Wipro GE HealthCare is considering expanding its manufacturing footprint in India with an additional plant as it looks to increase domestic sales and double exports from the country, Chaitanya Sarawate, MD and president of South Asia, told **ET**.

The company, which operates four manufacturing plants in Bengaluru, is evaluating multiple states for a potential additional facility, weighing logistics costs, proximity to its engineering operations, and incentives offered by state governments, Sarawate said.

"Our first focus right now is to expand and reduce the bottlenecks in our existing manufacturing facilities. That work is under way. But we do anticipate that we will need an additional plant, and that is something under evaluation right now," Sarawate noted.

"There are benefits to having co-located plants but also benefits to having plants in different locations. We are looking at multiple states to see what would make the most sense. For instance, with heavy capital equipment, one of the things that's important is port taxes. We will look at all options to figure out what sets us up for success for the next 30 years," he added.

Mapping India's AI Deal Flow

Company	Last round	Last valuation	Latest round*	Latest valuation*	Key investors**
Sarvam	$300 m	$1.5 b	$300 m	$3 b	HCL Tech, Bessemer, Peak XV, Khosla Ventures
Ema	$77 m	$800 m	NA	NA	Creaegis, Accel, Prosus
UnifyApps	$50 m	$200 m	$100-120 m	$700-750 m	EQT, WestBridge, Elevation Capital
Simplismart	$20-25 m	$100-120 m	$40-50 m	$300-400 m	Peak XV, DAMAC Digital, Dallas VC

* In conversations, round not closed yet; ** Includes investors, which are still negotiating for next round

Source: ET Research

Tech Trotter

Dispatches from Deal & Job Street

Nscale, Anthropic in Discussion for $45 billion Computing Deal

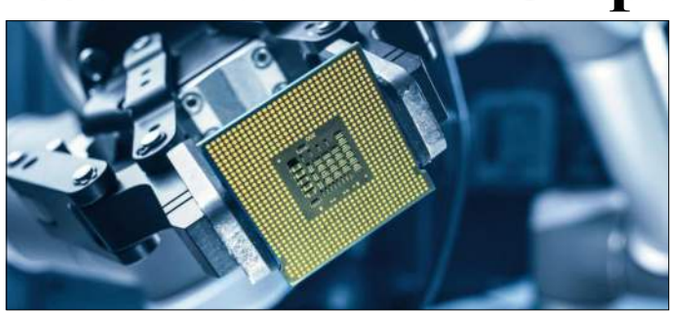
Nscale, the AI cloud computing firm, is in talks to sell computing power to Anthropic PBC in a deal that could be worth about $45 billion, according to sources. The Nvidia -backed data centre developer is seeking a second major deal with the firm. —Reuters

300,000 Jobs Amazon in Hiring Overdrive for Holiday Season

Amazon said on Tuesday it plans to hire more than 300,000 workers for the US holiday season, marking the first increase for the period in three years. The online retailer had employed 250,000 workers during the season for the past three years. —Reuters

DEMAND FROM CHINESE COS FAR EXCEEDS PLANNED PRODUCTION: TECH GIANT

ByteDance, Alibaba and Tencent Order $35 b Worth of Nvidia Chips



ByteDance, Alibaba and Tencent have ordered more than 3 million of Nvidia's new RTX PRO 5500 graphics cards with a collective sticker price of over $35 billion, two people familiar with the matter said, in a rush for a less powerful but export-compliant chip amid US restrictions on trade with China.

US-based chipmaker Nvidia has told customers and partners it cannot guarantee that it can fill the orders because demand from Chinese technology companies far exceeds planned production, the two sources and a third person familiar with the matter said. They requested anonymity because they are not authorised to speak to the media.

The RTX PRO 5500 is a workstation chip, designed for powerful professional computers rather than the large data-centre clusters that use Nvidia's most advanced AI processors. But it is among the most powerful Nvidia chips that are still available to Chinese buyers.

Nvidia's Blackwell-based B300 data-centre chip is not allowed to be sold to Chinese buyers under US export controls, while exports of its Hopper-based H200 are reviewed on a case-by-case basis and are subject to licensing conditions.

One source said Nvidia told partners they might receive only 5% to 10% of the quantities requested. Another said the company had indicated it could produce no more than 3 million RTX PRO 5500 cards globally in 2027. Total orders from customers in China have exceeded 6 million, two of the sources said.

The three Chinese tech giants' orders are for cards priced at about $11,400 each, two of the sources said, giving them a potential combined value of more than $35 billion.

The scale of the orders, which have not been previously reported, underscores the ongoing appetite among Chinese companies for Nvidia hardware despite the US curbs.

Nvidia's B300 data-centre chip is not allowed to be sold to Chinese buyers under US export controls

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang has said the restrictions reduced Nvidia's share of China's AI data-centre chip market from a near monopoly to effectively nothing. But demand for the RTX PRO 5500 suggests Nvidia retains a sizeable potential market in China through less powerful products that may still be available.

The surge in demand also highlights how US restrictions have tightened computing-power supplies in the world's second-largest economy as Chinese companies race to develop cutting-edge AI models and propel Beijing's effort to deploy the technology across its industries.

Washington's curbs have pushed Chinese firms toward domestic suppliers, while Beijing has encouraged the use of homegrown chips.

Huawei, in particular, has gained market share, though Chinese chipmakers have generally struggled to match leading American products, partly because separate restrictions have limited access to the foreign equipment that is used to make the most advanced semiconductors. —Reuters

Sports World Play

VITALS

3RD WT20I

Harman Shines as India Sweep Zimbabwe 3-0

RAIPUR: Former captain Harmanpreet Kaur struggled to keep her emotions in check after a sizzling 91 not out off 41 balls, setting up India's 92-run win over Zimbabwe in the third and final T20I on Tuesday. Shafali Verma made an entertaining 69 off 37 balls before Harmanpreet returned to her destructive best to power India 216 for 7. Zimbabwe could not get anywhere near the target and and ended at 124 for 7, with India taking the series 3-0. The two teams will now head to Vadodara for a three-match ODI series starting on October 23. **PTI**

BRIEF SCORE **India** 216/7 (Harmanpreet 91* off 41, Shafali 69 off 37; Biza 3/50) beat **Zimbabwe** 124/7 (Mayers 60 off 49, Biza 44 off 50; Nandini 3/18) by 92 runs

Ronaldo Let Manchester United Down: Ten Hag

Former Manchester United manager Erik ten Hag has blamed Cristiano Ronaldo's lack of fitness and preparation for the forward's struggles during his second stint at the club, saying the Portugal international "let the team down." "Many times I say, 'Ronnie, everyone wants to work for you to bring you in the right position, but if you can't bring yourself in the box, you can't score.' He was not capable to do this," Ten Hag told The Athletic. "He ran neither in possession nor out of possession. The reason was because he didn't prepare himself," said Ten Hag, who was sacked by United in 2024. **Reuters**

KANE THEY HANDLE GUNNERS?

Bayern face early test of title credentials against Arsenal with in-form Olise sidelined

Champions League hopefuls Bayern Munich are set for an early test of their title credentials when they host English champions Arsenal on Wednesday without in-form winger Michael Olise.

The London-born Olise, who started in Arsenal's junior system, is suspended after picking up two yellow cards inside a minute in Bayern's 3-3 draw with Viking last week.

After seeing a first yellow for a foul, a clearly frustrated Olise responded to some verbal provocation from Viking captain Zlatko Tripic by throwing the ball at his head to be sent off for the first time in his career.

After being thrust into Ballon d'Or contention due to last season's stellar showing, the former Crystal Palace winger has continued his excellent form this campaign.

Olise has nine goals and five assists from 10 games in all competitions for Bayern.

With Jamal Musiala struggling with injury and illness and both Serge Gnabry and Lennart Karl well off their best form, Olise and the ever-reliable Harry Kane have shouldered Bayern's attacking burden so far this season.

The England captain has nine goals and six assists in 10 games. With Bayern 2-0 down away at Viking last week, Kane almost single-handedly engineered a comeback, scoring twice and setting up another.

Speaking after Bayern's ruthless 6-1 victory over RB Leipzig on Saturday, Kane said Bayern would miss Olise but called on the rest of their star-studded squad to step up.

Harry Kane has nine goals and six assists in 10 games this season AP

"Missing one of your biggest players, you're going to feel it for sure, but that's where other people have to step up and show they can take their opportunity," Kane said. "We talk about the squad a lot, we talk about being ready for your moment and whoever plays will have to be ready."

Arsenal have yet to concede a goal in the Champions League and are tied for the best defensive record in the Premier League with 5 goals conceded in 7 games

One of the many positives to come out of Saturday's thumping win over Leipzig was the performance of Luis Diaz.

The 29-year-old had cut a frustrated figure after a poor start to the season but scored three goals and set up another in one of his best performances since moving from Liverpool in 2025.

'ONE OF THE BEST'

Despite swapping north London for the Bavarian capital back in 2023, former Tottenham captain Kane has seen plenty of Arsenal since joining Bayern.

Bayern faced the Gunners in two quarter-final legs in 2023-24, progressing by just a goal, but were outclassed in a 3-1 defeat in the league phase of last year's competition.

With domestic and international matches coming thick and fast, Kane has not had time to exchange pleasantries with any of his Gunners rivals. "I spoke to them a bit in the international break previously, but I think we're all too busy right now to text each other, with a game every three days," he explained.

Saturday's thrashing of Leipzig once again showed the perennial German champions are a cut above their domestic rivals and Kane said Bayern were relishing a chance to take on Mikel Arteta's side.

Still smarting from last year's painful loss on penalties to Paris Saint-Germain, Arsenal have started strongly, winning 10 of 11 games in all competitions.

"It's a big game and we're playing against one of the best teams in Europe, you have to always enjoy these occasions," Kane said. "We're testing ourselves against one of the best, we're here at home, the energy, the fans, it's going to be a special night." **AFP**

WATCHOUT! Tonight

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE **Como** v **Man United** 10:15pm; **Aston Villa** v **Viking FK** 12:30am; **Bayern** v **Arsenal** 12:30am; **Inter Milan** v **Shakhtar Donetsk** 12:30am; **Real Madrid** v **Leipzig** 12:30am (Sony Ten)

Athletics Leads India's Gold Rush, Medal Tally Climbs to 35

Nagoya: Seasoned campaigners Nishad Kumar and Deepthi Jeevanji led India's charge as athletics accounted for all five gold medals won by the country on Tuesday at the Asian Para Games, while new entrants also showed promise.

Nishad was the standout performer, adding the men's high jump gold to his T47 long jump title from Monday. His 2.04m effort also set a Games record, making him only the third Indian to win gold in two events at a single edition of the Para Asiad.

Deepthi Jeevanji sets a Games record of 56.36 seconds in the women's 400m T20 event

At the end of day two, India stood sixth in the medal standings with 35 medals — nine gold, 11 silver and 15 bronze. Athletics accounted for 20 of those medals.

Deepthi set the tone early, winning her second consecutive women's 400m T20 gold in a Games-record time of 56.36 seconds to reaffirm her continental dominance.

The T20 classification is for athletes with intellectual impairments. The 23-year-old from Telangana is a former world champion and won bronze at the 2024 Paralympics.

The gold rush continued as visually impaired sprinter Simran won the women's 200m T12 title, while wheelchair athlete Pranav Soorma claimed gold in the F51/52/53 discus throw and Devender Kumar triumphed in the F44/64 discus throw. **PTI**

SP Group Wants Tata Sons to Consider ₹25kcr Share Buyback

Debt-laden co pushing for agenda at board meet to unlock funds to repay creditors

Kala Vijayraghavan & Sagar Malviya

Mumbai: The Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group wants Tata Sons to review on priority at its next board meeting a proposal to buy back about ₹25,000 crore worth of its shares, as the debt-laden conglomerate urgently seeks funds to repay borrowings, people familiar with the matter said.

The SP Group has not withdrawn the proposal, which was placed before the Tata Sons board by Noel Tata at its last meeting, the people said.

The subsequent Reserve Bank of India (RBI) directive requiring Tata Sons to pursue a listing has not altered the group's need for funds, even as it has welcomed the regulatory move, they said.

The plan envisages monetising part of the SP Group's roughly 18.4% stake in Tata Sons, held through Sterling Investments Corp and Cyrus Investments. The proceeds would be ring-fenced for debt repayment.

The group had submitted a plan to Tata Sons for a. selective capital reduction over 18 months, generating gross proceeds of at least ₹25,000 crore. The valuation would be based on income-tax fair value, according to details of the proposal.

SP group did not comment. Officials close to the matter said that it is up to Tata Sons to decide on the best way to enable the monetisation through buyback, an SPV structure or any other plan. Seeking a buyback immediately after a potential listing of Tata Sons could undermine the listing process, the people said.

The group had recently cleared an approximately ₹3,500 crore in bond repayments after securing fresh funding commitments from a majority of its existing lenders, easing near-term liquidity pressures and helping it avoid a possible default ahead of a September deadline.But there is an urgency for immediate capital to handle the debt burden, officials said.

Experts said a selective capital reduction could provide a route to monetise the stake, but the process would require regulatory approval and scrutiny of the valuation and treatment of shareholders.

"Selective buy-back of shares can be done by capital reduction under Section 66 of the Companies Act, 2013, through the NCLT approval process rather than a conventional buyback under Section 68," said Uday Ved, tax partner at KNAV.

"Valuation and fairness for all shareholders could lead to challenges during the NCLT process. Equally relevant, the board may need to evaluate use of funds for the capital reduction vis-a-vis protecting for future growth, assuming listing in future," he said.

The SP Group, Tata Sons' second-largest shareholder, has pledged its stake against borrowings and is seeking to unlock value from the investment to strengthen its finances.

Experts said a selective capital reduction could provide a route to monetise the stake but the process would require regulatory approval and scrutiny of the valuation and treatment of shareholders

It completed a ₹21,500-crore refinancing in July after telling investors it planned to monetise part of its Tata Sons holding through a listing or share sale within 18 months. The group also faced a repayment obligation of about ₹3,500 crore at the end of September.

The funding request comes amid uncertainty over Tata Sons' future structure. The RBI rejected the company's application to surrender its registration as an upper-layer non-banking financial company (NBFC) and directed it to comply with the applicable regulatory framework.

Under RBI rules, upper-layer NBFCs must list their equity shares on a recognised stock exchange within three years of being identified in that category.

SP Group chairman Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry backed the RBI decision last month, describing listing as a means to strengthen transparency and public accountability. His position contrasts with that of Noel Tata, who opposes a public listing.

Tata Trusts, which collectively hold a majority stake in Tata Sons, have said they have not agreed to a listing and that alternatives should be considered.

The trusts have argued that preserving the existing ownership structure would help sustain philanthropic activities funded by dividends from Tata companies.

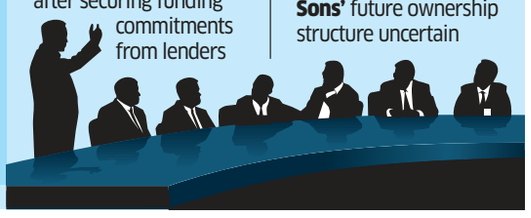
Buyback Push

SP Group wants **Tata Sons** to fast-track a **₹25,000 crore** share buyback proposal at next board meet

Plan envisages monetising part of **SP Group's 18.4%** stake in **Tata Sons** to repay debt

SP Group cleared **₹3,500 crore** in bond repayments after securing funding commitments from lenders

RBI's listing directive hasn't changed **SP Group's** fund-raising urgency, even as **Tata Sons'** future ownership structure uncertain



Eyeing Strong Participation

▸▸ From Page 1

"This will encourage increased participation," the person said.

Roadshows are being planned in cities such as Dubai and Singapore, besides Mumbai, to attract international investors, he said.

While Varanasi airport will be clubbed with Gaya and Kushinagar, Amritsar will be clubbed with Kangra, Bhubaneswar with Hubballi, Raipur with Aurangabad and Tiruchirappalli with Tirupati.

The government expects a new group of investors to participate in this bidding round, alongside current airport operators such as the GMR Group and the Adani Group.

In addition to sovereign wealth funds in West Asia, major Indian corporate houses like the JSW Group are looking to acquire airports, according to people with knowledge of the matter.

The AAI did not respond to ET's queries on the development.

In this round, the government will cap the number of airports a single entity can bid for, due to growing concerns over market concentration and the risk of monopolies in the aviation sector.

Available 75 Acres Developed NA Land Nagothane (Maharashtra)

Prime land at Nagothane on Mumbai-Goa Highway available on Outright Sale, Long Term lease, Joint venture Development. Most ideal for Luxury Wellness & Retreat Center, Universities & Educational Campuses, Resorts & Hospitality Projects, Data Centers, Subsea cable landing station, Townships & Plotted Developments, Warehousing & Logistics and Non-Polluting Industries.

tpemarch2026@gmail.com

BARC Registration Delay Hits Broadcasters

Javed Farooqui

Mumbai: The delay in renewing the registration of the Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) India has exposed divisions over broadcaster influence, audience measurement and competition in India's television ratings market, while a prolonged ratings blackout is putting pressure on broadcasters and distribution platforms.

The ministry of information and broadcasting (MIB) is yet to decide on fresh registration applications from BARC and TAM India, a joint venture between Nielsen and Kantar Media. Key concerns include BARC's ownership structure, progress on cross-media measurement and the absence of an updated Broadcast India study, according to people familiar with the matter. The ministry is also keen to introduce competition into a market dominated by BARC.

At the centre of the dispute is BARC's ownership. The Indian Broadcasting and Digital Foundation (IBDF) holds a 60% stake, while the Advertising Agencies Association of India (AAAI) and the Indian Society of Advertisers (ISA) own 20% each.

"While the MIB has stated that BARC needs to comply with the TV Ratings Guidelines 2026 to get fresh registration, one of the key concerns of the MIB has been the stranglehold of broadcasters on BARC," said a person familiar with the government's thinking.

BARC's previous registration expired in 2025. It has since appointed new independent directors and expanded its measurement panel to nearly 80,000 meters, but the ministry reportedly remains dissatisfied with its progress on cross-media measurement and the lack of an updated Broadcast India study, which underpins its measurement framework.

The MIB stopped BARC from publishing audience measurement data in June, while news viewership data has been withheld since March. An informal group of ministers is understood to be examining the issue.

The blackout has deprived broadcasters of a key benchmark for evaluating channel performance and demonstrating advertising value. India's television advertising market is estimated at ₹30,000 crore to ₹40,000 crore.

"Entertainment broadcasters are paying the price of divisions in the news industry," a regulatory official said, noting that news accounts for a smaller share of the market than entertainment.

The suspension has also raised questions about BARC's finances. While Crisil said in a bulletin published in late August that BARC's operations remained unaffected despite the suspension, citing continued cash inflows from broadcasters, healthy liquidity and minimal debt.

A broadcasting industry official claimed that most broadcasters had stopped paying the ratings body. "Barring two broadcasters, other broadcasters are not paying BARC, which means that BARC is on the brink of a collapse," the official said.

A prolonged impasse could threaten smaller and free-to-air channels, while affecting advertising sales, production and marketing jobs. It could also hit revenues at DD Free Dish and distribution platforms such as Hathway and Siti Networks.

Prime Focus

Stakeholding in BARC

60% Broadcaster ownership

20% AAAI

20% ISA

2025 Registration expiry left BARC awaiting fresh approval

80,000 Meters that now **measure audiences**, yet concerns remain

₹30,000–₹40,000cr Television advertising's estimated annual market value

Deepening Strategic Ties

▸▸ From Page 1

Foreign secretary Vikram Misri, US ambassador to India Sergio Gor and other officials were also present at the meeting.

Rubio said that he and Jaishankar discussed energy security and defence cooperation.

"In Mumbai, Indian External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and I discussed energy security and defence cooperation while reaffirming the importance of advancing the US-India strategic partnership," the US secretary of state posted on X.

The US state department confirmed the broad nature of talks between the two leaders.

"The secretary and minister discussed regional and global issues, including developments in the Middle East. The Secretary reiterated that increased energy trade with the United States can play a transformative role in diversifying India's supply chains while meeting its sizable consumer demand," said a state department readout of the meeting. "He also commended recent progress in bilateral defence and civil nuclear cooperation, and advocated for the increased purchase of US technologies and systems, which can enhance the security and prosperity of both our countries."

Talking to reporters during his Mumbai visit, Rubio said New Delhi had repeatedly expressed its desire to diversify its energy portfolio, describing it as a "smart thing to do."

VENEZUELAN SUPPLIES

Rubio added that the US had discussed Venezuela and other countries as potential sources of energy for India, saying Washington had an interest in maintaining strong alliances with countries that have diverse energy portfolios. He said he would hold discussions with Ambani, who owns the country's most advanced refinery in Gujarat's Jamnagar.

Earlier in the day, Rubio arrived in Mumbai for his second visit to India as the US secretary of state. After his engagements in Mumbai, Rubio would travel to Jamnagar for talks that will include "enhanced energy cooperation," the US state department said.

He will meet the Reliance chairman Ambani and visit the refinery in Jamnagar. It is understood that Rubio is encouraging Reliance to refine additional volumes of Venezuelan crude.

Separately, Rubio paid tributes to victims of the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks at the Taj Mahal Palace Hotel memorial, accompanied by ambassador Sergio Gor.

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump defended his decision to waive fresh sanctions and punitive measures on Russian energy exports, calling it a "very good decision" that would benefit the US and the world.

The move offers India relief from potential tariffs of up to 100% for buying Russian oil.

Special Waiver

In an executive order last Friday, Trump invoked a provision allowing the president to waive further punitive measures if doing so was in the US national interest. Trump has announced a deal with Russia to purchase diesel, drawing international attention.

On Monday, Rubio said that the India-US trade deal is close to being finalised. "We're trying to finalise a trade deal with India right now. We're very close to doing that," he said in Samarkand ahead of his India visit.

He also said that the US considered global energy needs before imposing sanctions linked to Russian oil exports. "We've had to waive sanctions over the past few months because of the impact on global supplies and prices... We have to manage all of these things," he said.

"We're trying to finalise a trade deal with India right now. We're very close to doing that. That's one of the things we take into consideration when the President makes a decision about national security waivers and things of that nature. Every country has a complex set of factors that it has to take into account. Geography is real. For some countries, it's very difficult to acquire energy from alternative sources. That's not an excuse, but all of that has to be balanced when making foreign policy," Rubio said.

Meanwhile, Foreign secretary Vikram Misri met US Congressional staffers in Mumbai on Tuesday, highlighting Congress's role in advancing India-US ties. He also discussed growing technology and defence cooperation and the strong people-to-people links between the two countries.

Skydance Bets Big on AI-Driven Content

Hollywood consolidation's been blistering

Earlier this month, Paramount Skydance completed its $110 bn acquisition of Warner Bros Discovery, creating a debt-laden Hollywood giant whose focus will now be on cutting costs. This was the reason the deal was opposed widely in courts. But Skydance boss David Ellison says he's planning to lower costs through tech synergies, and not by laying off employees. Skydance Corp, which now houses a sprawling collection of film, TV and news organisations, has committed to film release pledges for 5 yrs and an editorial independence board for news channels CNN and CBS. These assurances follow concerns expressed over how media concentration throttles content, and Donald Trump accusing the group's news channels of bias. Ellison is betting big on content to take on tech giants like Apple, Amazon and Meta that are amping up competition for Hollywood's iconic studios.

Skydance has built up an impressive arsenal with this merger. It now owns the studios Warner Bros and Paramount Pictures, streaming services HBO Max, Discovery+ and Paramount+, and news channels CNN and CBS News. It also has a large collection of cable networks and live sports and entertainment franchises. Ellison's empire faces declining cable TV subscription, rising costs of streaming services, and audiences shifting to creator content for news and entertainment.

Pace of consolidation in the Hollywood entertainment industry has been breathtaking. Skydance acquired Paramount and Warner Bros a little over a year apart. Mergers make sense when the competition is with the vast resources and reach of Netflix, Amazon, Google, Apple, Meta and ByteDance. But efficiencies of media concentration derive from creating less content with fewer people. Streaming video platforms have overtaken cable TV, and social media has outrun video-on-demand. AI is chipping away at the cost structure of studio production, largely by replacing humans. Ellison will have to pull a few rabbits out of the hat from a conglomerate that owns Mission Impossible, Harry Potter and the DC superheroes.

The Past is as Glorious As You Care for It

Earlier this month, Supreme Court sharply rebuked MCD and ASI over their failure to protect Delhi's historic sites. It's a telling reminder of how little *real* value state agencies place on the past. That MCD lacks basic land ownership records for Lal Mahal, a 13th-c. palace near Nizamuddin Dargah, tells its own story. Lodhi-era tombs in Zamrudpur in south Delhi being left vulnerable to encroachment is also telling. These are not obscure ruins on a distant frontier but part of the capital city's inheritance. Public agencies are duty-bound to safeguard them.

Delhi is Delhi because of its layers of history, visible in its monuments, tombs, gardens, old neighbourhoods. This is lived heritage, not just reserved for heritage walks or as sites for official speeches. These spaces define the city's distinct character, bridging its present with the past. Allowing them to be encroached upon, or forgotten, diminishes the city itself. Conservation need not mean cordoning off history. Properly protected and imaginatively managed, historic sites can anchor urban renewal, creating accessible public spaces. Sunder Nursery is compelling proof: restoration, landscaping and sensitive public access transformed a neglected landscape into a vibrant urban destination.

Government agencies must stop using overlapping jurisdictions as an excuse for inaction. They must establish clear ownership records, halt encroachments, secure conservation funding and collaborate to integrate heritage into public life. The apex court must demand measurable action, not another round of empty official assurances. For a country that talks about its 'glorious past' at a drop of a hat, we sure find investing in a more liveable, distinctive and humane city to be cumbersome.

JUST IN JEST

A new idiomatic English phrase coined in India is all the rage

'As Slow as an India-US Trade Deal'

There are forces who have probably been assigned the task of ensuring that Marco Rubio doesn't overhear this during the next few days he's here in India. But India is a big and loud place, and this corner column only mirrors it. So, consider our duty to put on record a new idiomatic phrase in English that has gained traction over the last few months: 'As slow as an India-US trade deal'. Those familiar with formulations such as 'watching paint dry' and 'waiting for Godot' may already know what we're talking about. Except, this latest idiom describes an activity that is simultaneously happening, not happening, and about to happen.

Its most remarkable feature is its elasticity. A delayed flight is merely late. A delayed marriage may be called off. But something proceeding 'as slow as an India-US trade deal' enjoys permanent forward momentum without the inconvenience of arriving. Whenever an official announces that negotiations are 'almost complete', seasoned observers understand that it's nudge-nudge, wink-wink for another postponement. 'We are very close' means further away than previously feared. 'Final stages' suggests the beginning of another round. 'Constructive discussions' indicates that nobody has thrown a chair. Trade negotiators on both sides of the Indo-Pacific water table have finally produced something of lasting value: a phrase.

CJP won't determine Gen Z's political future, how opposition parties harness its energy will

Tryst with Hyperpolitics

Jay Vinayak Ojha

Approach the mighty roach

In 1962, John Kenneth Galbraith, then US ambassador to India, wrote to President Kennedy arguing that politics is not 'the art of the possible' but rather 'consists in choosing between the disastrous and the unpalatable'. With Lutyens' Delhi still emerging from a fortnight of protest-and-crackdown, the aftertaste is certainly bitter enough. Galbraith's definition, however, presupposes someone willing to choose, and options on a ballot to choose between.

Opposition parties now mobilising against EC, with a rally planned for Nov 1, fit the bill well enough. Whatever one thinks of them, theirs is the familiar case to make — we are the least bad option; pick us. It's not quite so with the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). It is amorphous, with its founder, Abhijeet Dipke, last week reiterating his insistence that it remains 'an independent pressure group'.

Indeed, CJP does not seem to have any form of legal existence as a body at all even as its social media handles boast millions of followers. Most of the reactions to the CJP phenomenon have eschewed an attempt to genuinely understand it, and have fallen, instead, into one of the familiar camps. Upon asking someone what they think of 'all this', one is usually met either with a jaundiced eye and vague grumblings about a foreign hand or a sort of gawping, wide-eyed celebration of the youthful, 'Bob Dylan' vitality of it all.

Anton Jäger contrasts hyperpolitics with 'mass politics', where grand political ideologies are supported by a thick network of permanent institutions: associations, trades unions, etc

The key to a more nuanced understanding might lie in a phenomenon recently observed by Belgian historian and political theorist Anton Jäger: hyperpolitics, that is, 'extreme politicisation without political consequences'. He contrasts this with the 'mass politics' of the greater part of the 20th c., an era during which grand political ideologies — communism, fascism, liberalism — battled it out for supremacy, each supported by a thick network of permanent institutions: clubs, associations, trades unions, church groups, and the like.

The present 'hyperpolitical' moment in the West, by contrast, though marked by the extreme polarisation of public life along political, racial and gender lines, and frequent outbursts of political rage, lacks the thick network of social institutions that marked the earlier age. Jäger's examples range from the protests that followed George Floyd's killing in the US in 2020 to the *gilets jaunes* (yellow vest) movement in France, a 2018-20 mobilisation of remarkable scale that, in his words, 'explicitly refused all institutionalisation'.

It is difficult to escape the conclusion that CJP marks the coming of 'hyperpolitics' to India. Anybody who has observed party organisational work at close quarters will tell you that it is deeply unglamorous. Voters must be canvassed, booth-level workers organised, and success ultimately tested by the brutally objective metrics of votes and seats.

CJP offers a different model. It does not see itself as a vehicle to reshape society on an ideological pattern, but appears to be a loose container and channel to direct fleeting moments of youth and student anger. When an issue gathers enough traction in the press or on social media, and if it appears to catch the fancy of the 'leadership', the word goes out online and the protest is organised.

Its victories are individual scalps, rather than political settlements. Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigned in July. But, by August, the movement was back on the streets complaining that GoI had not kept its other promises. With no permanent cadre or institutional base, there is little way to sustain pressure. It is precisely the sort of politics that Jäger describes as 'low commitment, low cost' (that is, in the sense of low barriers to entering or exiting the movement — as opposed to joining or leaving the cadre of an established party — not in terms of personal costs to protesters).

For the actual turnout at protests, CJP owes a great deal to traditional political outfits, which many of its adherents love to disdain. Much of the staying power of the protests against EC comes from parties of the INDIA bloc. Any observer of the earlier protests following the NEET paper leak couldn't fail to note that much of the actual manpower and organisational backbone were supplied by the student wings of the Left parties — complete with almost charmingly quaint SFI posters decrying the 'nijikaran' and 'bazaarikaran' of education.

Ultimately, therefore, the political future of 'Gen Z' is likely to be determined not by Cockroach Janta 'Party' but by how the more traditional political formations harness its energy. Jäger concludes that a greater degree of political institutionalisation is the only alternative to a permanent state of 'impotent volatility'. If Jäger is right, then all parties to the standoff have homework.

CJP must decide whether it's anything more than a passing mood; opposition parties how they can co-opt this anger; institutions of government how they may win these back

CJP must decide whether it is anything more than a passing mood. Opposition parties must decide whether and how they can co-opt this anger. And, above all, the institutions of government — which, one might charitably say, have experienced what Tocqueville called 'the gradual extinction of the love and respect that used to attach to power' — must reflect on how they might win these back. Until then, Galbraith's choice is all that remains.

The writer is senior resident fellow, Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy. Views are personal

Give Without Fear of Failing

Roopa Kudva

Philanthropy is the only significant pool of capital with no financial return to deliver. No LP expecting a multiple, shareholder demanding earnings, or exit timeline. That should make it the most patient, most risk-taking money in the system. Mostly, though, it isn't.

Finance has agreed measures of return. Philanthropy has none. So, funders fall back on caution. In India, a CSR mandate hardened that caution by making giving an audited, annual, compliance-shaped activity. Founder wealth sits outside that. It's personal money, with unmatched freedom to deploy while founders still work. To use that freedom, founders must avoid 5 habits that cancel out their unique advantage:

❶ Asking for evidence before funding If the proof already exists, the idea may no longer need philanthropic risk capital. Often, the work is upstream: uncovering problems, funding research and testing pilots. The question is how much proof each decision needs. A small early pilot and a large scale-up require different evidence bars. At the earliest stage, philanthropy is often the only capital available, yet, demands evidence that cannot exist.

❷ 1-yr grant cycles for 10-yr problems Nothing structural moves in 12 mths. Short cycles reward activity over capability and impact. While a long grant can also produce years of activity without change, annual cycles remain the binding constraint. Annual funding diminishes capacity for innovation, advocacy and long-term risk. Founder money faces neither mandate nor FY limits. So, it has the least excuse.

Give a hand

❸ Refusing to fund salaries, systems and overheads We fund programmes and starve the institutions that run them, then wonder why systems and capacity are never built.

❹ Micromanaging execution Funders often know less about the problem than the organisations working on it daily. Prescriptive milestones leave little room to learn and adapt. Accountability hardens into auditability, which is easier to administer. As a result, non-profits are made accountable to funders rather than *for* the people they serve, with effort going into performance rather than the work.

❺ Requiring attribution Desire to claim credit can undermine collaborative, long-horizon efforts across funders.

Individually, these look prudent. Together, they route money towards organisations best equipped for compliance, rather than where it's needed most. If every grant goes to an established organisation, a proven intervention and a predictable outcome, philanthropic capital will behave like conservative institutional capital. The caution buys nothing.

Founders are well placed to avoid these mistakes. They have been the unproven bet themselves, know that some bets will fail, and understand why patient, unrestricted capital matters. That differs sharply from compliance-driven CSR.

Philanthropic boards have no language for failure in a material part of the portfolio. But founders have faced that question in their businesses and boardrooms. They also understand funding capable teams before the model is proven.

There are risks founders must guard against: impatience with organisations that can't move at startup speed; assumption that what worked in a company will transfer to social problems of a different complexity; and an instinct for metrics sharper than the sector's ability to supply them. Founders may back work that can be copied elsewhere over work that only succeeds in one community, because scaling is what they have spent their careers doing.

This is not an argument against expecting returns or rigorous impact assessment. Seeing funders as investors in an equitable future is a better frame than donor and recipient. Funders should expect returns — in impact and in policy change. The question is what is being measured, over what horizon, and who pays for it.

Learnings from that assessment should be shared externally so the whole sector benefits. Donors should fund the full cost of assessment instead of leaving it to recipients. For shorter-term reporting, accept what recipients already produce. Don't impose bespoke formats and metrics. The power balance between donors and recipients is heavily skewed. Donors must make the engagement as light touch as possible.

Philanthropy has the rarest privilege in capital: freedom to be wrong. Not using it is the real waste.

The writer is former CEO, CRISIL

Smell the Vietnamese Coffee

Ashish Dhawan & Swagato Ganguly

Clearest evidence of how completely Vietnam has captured the 'China plus one' moment is its trade relationship with the US. In H1 2026, Vietnam's trade surplus with the US touched $114 bn, the largest of any country. US imports from Vietnam were up about 40% y-o-z, driven by companies reorienting supply chains away from China.

Vietnam's success in building an overwhelmingly large export channel is worth examining in India. It's not a story of low wages alone, but also of institutional predictability, tariff simplicity, an extraordinarily wide FTA network, and a state apparatus organised end-to-end around courting and retaining GVC anchors.

India has comparable or larger advantages — market size, engineering talent and capital markets. But it lags on these fronts. Fortunately, this doesn't require reinventing India's economic model but executing at scale on things Vietnam has proven to work. One corrective to the usual argument that Vietnam merely imports from China to export to the West is that Vietnam's exports to China are worth $70 bn. India's are $17-20 bn.

6 ingredients have made Vietnam a powerhouse exporter:

❶ Tariff simplicity Vietnam's simple average applied tariff is around 3.4%, with a trade-weighted average of near 1%. Effective input tariffs for GVC manufacturers are close to zero, and customs classification disputes are rare, because Vietnam has built its tariff and rules-of-origin regime for a small number of high-volume GVC categories rather than the sprawling, exception-laden, litigation-creating schedules in India.

❷ Top-level courtship In August, Vietnam's president Tô Lâm met Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon on the same day its PM Lê Minh Hung met Samsung CEO Roh Tae-moon. This signals to a global C-suite that the relationship is a state priority, not a departmental one.

❸ Institutional infra for top exporters Monthly PM office reviews with top exporting GVCs helps policy intent overcome firm-level bottlenecks far faster than an annual budget-cycle, or occasional investor-summit approach. Vietnam's success metric for such investors as being 'net foreign exchange-positive within 10 yrs' should be read as the operating principle officials apply, rather than any published government formula.

Take a sip

❹ Unmatched FTA lattice Vietnam sits inside Asean, RCEP, CPTPP, the EU-Vietnam FTA, and a growing set of bilaterals, giving its exporters near-duty-free access to markets covering the large majority of world GDP, while importing inputs duty-free too.

❺ Scale first, DVA later Vietnam deliberately accepts low domestic value addition (DVA) in the early years of a GVC relationship, targeting only 'net forex-positive within 10 yrs' the same way China did in 2002-15. This is a conscious trade-off against India's more common instinct to gate incentives on local content and value-addition thresholds from year one, which can filter out very high-volume assembly investments that build scale, skills and supplier ecosystems first.

❻ Competitive, predictable tax treatment Zero effective export taxation and a stable corporate tax/incentive regime for GVC investors removes a second layer of negotiation friction that in India often plays out state-by-state and scheme-by-scheme.

India should adopt a bold, 3-yr reform agenda where the primary task is sequencing and follow-through, mapped against 6 Vietnamese actions:

❶ Move toward a small number of tariff bands for GVC-relevant inputs with pre-published, binding classification rulings. This can be done Asap.

❷ Create a Top 30 Exporters Council chaired at PMO level, paired with state-level counterparts in the 5-6 states that host bulk of India's GVC-scale electronics and auto-components manufacturing, so the engagement is continuous and high-level.

❸ Monthly, not annual, review cadence with these 30 exporting GVCs, with the authority to resolve bottlenecks in real time.

❹ Britain, the EU, EFTA and New Zealand deals are wins on paper. The 3-yr priority is exporter awareness, digitised certificate-of-origin issuance, and rules-of-origin simplification, so utilisation rates approach Vietnam's. India should also quickly conclude a trade deal with the US, still the largest market for Indian goods.

❺ Lower or phase in domestic value-addition thresholds in the first 3-5 yrs of a GVC investment, converging toward Vietnam's 'net-forex-positive in 10 yrs' logic.

❻ Stabilise and simplify the export tax and incentive regime, reducing the degree to which GVC investors must separately negotiate state-level land and power terms on top of central schemes — a single, published national compact that states can opt into.

None of these 6 requires a change in India's economic model. They require sequencing, cadence and predictability, executed with the same diligence and continuity Vietnam has shown for two decades.

Dhawan and Ganguly are founder-chairperson and senior fellow, respectively, The Convergence Foundation

THE SPEAKING TREE

Invisible Barriers

SRIPRIYA SATISH

The northeast has a fascinating geographical feature. Cherrapunji, one of the wettest places on Earth, receives heavy annual rainfall. But Shillong, located just about 54 km away, receives considerably less rainfall. The topography of the Khasi Hills explains this striking contrast and influences rainfall distribution in the region.

This geographical phenomenon reminds one of a beautiful spiritual metaphor from the Gospel of Sri Ramakrishna. During their exile, Ram, Sita and Lakshman walked one behind the other, in that order. Ram represents God, Lakshman the individual soul, and Sita, who stands between them, represents maya, divine illusion. Although Ram was only a short distance ahead, Lakshman could not see him clearly because Sita stood between them. Lakshman could behold the Lord only when Sita moved aside. This metaphor conveys a profound spiritual truth: although God is always near us, maya may veil His presence.

In Gita, 7. 25, Lord Krishn declares: 'I am not manifest to everyone, being veiled by my divine Yogmaya energy. Hence, those without knowledge do not know that I am without birth and changeless.'

The rain may be likened to divine grace, while the hills symbolise barriers between us and the experience of that grace. Maya, too, prevents us from recognising the divine presence ever so close to us.

PEAS IN A PODCAST

When Rocky Wasn't Welcome

What makes a city's identity? Its grand cultural institutions, or a fictional boxer who refuses to stay down? '99% Invisible', a podcast hosted by Roman Mars, explores the overlooked design, architecture and ideas that shape the world around us. It finds compelling stories in the ordinary, revealing how the built environment reflects power, culture and human behaviour.

In the episode **The Rocky Statue**, Mars and producer-reporter Kurt Kohlstedt unpack the unlikely journey of Philadelphia's most recognisable tourist attraction. Created for Rocky 3 at Sylvester Stallone's behest, the bronze statue was intended to stand permanently atop the steps of the Philadelphia Museum of Art, where Rocky Balboa celebrated his triumph in the film.

But the city's culturati had other ideas. Officials and art patrons dismissed Rocky's statue as a prop, rather than art. A 25-yr tussle followed between elite notions of artistic merit and working-class affection for a character who embodied grit and self-made success. In 2006, a compromise finally gave the statue a permanent home at the museum's base.

This episode is a deft reminder that, sometimes, a city's most enduring icons are the ones its gatekeepers reject.

Chat Room

Profitability for Keeps, Not Peeps

'Pivot to Privatisation 2.0' by Arvind Panagariya (Oct 19) rightly questions recurring losses, but underestimates reform within public ownership. IDBI Bank's recovery before the proposed ownership transfer warrants asking the pertinent question as to why should successful restructuring justify sale rather than confidence in institutional renewal? PSBs earned ₹1.78 lakh cr in FY25, with net NPAs declining to 0.52%. While earlier recapitalisation costs remain relevant, these results demonstrate that public ownership can deliver improvement. India should retain and empower its PSUs and PSBs through professional boards, transparent appointments, stable leadership and commercial autonomy, free from administrative micromanagement. The next reform should make public ownership more productive by empowering PSUs to perform while compelling their leadership answerable for the results.

Koushik Acharya
Executive Director (Retd), BHEL Noida

Eye on Adulteration

▸▸ From Page 1

Products on shelves are replenished many times a day during the busy season, said Naqvi.

The Uttar Pradesh Mithai Namkeen Bakery Association recently urged the state food safety department to adopt a what it described as a supportive approach during the festive season, allowing small and medium-sized traditional businesses adequate time, training and technical guidance to formalise such practices.

"For minor documentation, display, record-keeping or other correctable deficiencies, businesses may kindly be guided and given a reasonable opportunity to rectify them, instead of facing immediate disruption of production or disproportionate action," the grouping wrote to the Uttar Pradesh Food Safety and Drug Administration (FSDA) on October 11.

Other states such as Maharashtra, Karnataka and Haryana have also stepped up vigilance against adulteration during festivals and other large gatherings, when demand for sweets, edible oils, dairy products and other food items typically rises.

Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) commissioner Tukaram Mundhe has been on a food safety, hygiene and anti-adulteration crusade that has led to widespread action with inspections of restaurants, hotels, cloud kitchens, dairies, quick-commerce dark stores and manufacturing units.

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has asked states to increase surveillance to prevent the sale of adulterated and counterfeit food items during the festive season. It has also intensified scrutiny of packaged food products, issuing notices to major companies over alleged misleading health and nutritional claims, labelling discrepancies and non-compliance with food regulations.

This comes as prices of key ingredients — milk and other dairy products, dry fruits, sugar, gram flour (besan) — have risen to records this year.

IMPACT ON MARGINS

The rising prices of inputs including fuel has had a cascading effect on the end product and will squeeze manufacturers' margins, said Suresh Goel, chief executive officer, Bikanervala Foods.

"Inspections happen during all festival seasons and so good and hygienic practices have become a part of our processing and packaging systems," he said. Since the Covid pandemic, the industry has aligned itself with health trends with even unorganised players making efforts to adopt best practices, he said.

Extended EMI Tenures

▸▸ From Page 1

There were virtually no car sales for a month prior to the cut last year.

Ashutosh Varma, chief business officer at the India business unit of the country's largest two-wheeler company, Hero MotoCorp, said Navratri retail sales exceeded last year's levels despite the high base. Scooter sales were a standout, he said.

Iyer said average billing had increased 6–7%, while same-store sales accelerated more than 10%. Lifestyle and footwear retailer Woodland reported growth of more than 20% each, as did electronics chain Vijay Sales, with AC sales surging more than 50%.

Electronics companies extended equated monthly instalment (EMI) tenures and expanded financing offers to entry-level products to sustain demand, while delaying the announced price hike from October until after Diwali—which falls on November 8. LG, Godrej Appliances, Haier and Havells-owned Lloyd reported sales growth of more than 20% during Navratri, industry executives said.

"This Navratri has been the best for the home appliances industry in the last five-six years, with high growth across categories," said Kamal Nandi, business head (appliances) at Godrej Enterprises Group. "AC sales have surged three-four times in the south, while in the west they have increased over eight times due to higher than normal temperatures. The industry overall has grown by 18-20%, including the mass segment in tier-2 and tier-3 markets. Volume growth will be 10-15%. Consumers made purchases fearing a price hike after Diwali."

Improved affordability following last year's GST rationalisation and special festive EMI schemes supported demand, said Sanjay Chitkara, co-chief sales and marketing officer at LG Electronics India, the country's largest appliance maker.

Lifestyle International chief executive Devarajan Iyer said that money is now being funnelled into retail spending, in contrast to the disproportionately higher spending on experiences such as travel and hospitality over the past four to five years. Suitcase sales have stalled this year, for instance, while consumers are spending more on apparel, handbags and footwear.

Haier India chief executive Satish NS said Navratri buoyancy had laid the foundation for a robust Diwali.

Memory-heavy gadgets buck the festive boom

However, smartphones, laptops and televisions faced volume pressure as repeated price hikes, driven by a two-to-three-fold increase in memory-chip prices, pushed products beyond consumers' budgets, although premium products remained more resilient. Average prices of memory products have risen 15-40% over last year's Diwali levels, according to industry executives.

Counterpoint Research estimates that online smartphone unit sales during Navratri fell 16% year-on-year, while the All India Mobile Retailers Association estimates that brick-and-mortar volumes declined nearly 20%. The association said value sales across India remained almost flat, with Gujarat being an outlier that showed 15% volume growth.

Various State Policies

▸▸ From Page 1

This comes as Lucknow and Noida are resource constrained. Karnataka is promoting sites in the northern and coastal areas as potential locations for new data centre clusters. Mangaluru, Udupi and Karwar offer relatively better land availability, while districts such as Gadag, Vijayapura and Chitradurga have strong wind potential, Karnataka officials said. On the other hand, states such as Tamil Nadu have chosen to focus instead on areas such as manufacturing, given the resource crunch.

Jitin Prasada, minister of state for electronics and IT, said on Wednesday that a new data centre policy is in the works. This will address some of the concerns over power. Globally, as well as in India, large-scale data centre investments have provoked a swarm of protests from residents living in adjoining areas.

Earlier this week, Microsoft pulled out of a $2.7 billion data centre commitment in Loughton, Essex, developed by Nvidia-backed Nscale, after delays in securing electricity connections pushed the project's operational timeline into the 2030s.

Key test for states will be if they can provide power at scale, create capacity quickly and offer globally competitive electricity tariffs, according to executives and officials tracking the sector.

Uttar Pradesh, which announced its Data Centre Policy 2026 recently, is broadening investments beyond Noida and Lucknow. "Data facilities require massive power, continuous supply, and large land parcels," said Alok Kumar, the state's principal secretary for IT and Electronics. "Bundelkhand provides the ideal strategic ecosystem, where abundant land is available and substantial solar and renewable energy resources can be tapped directly to power these energy-intensive facilities."

Karnataka's recently approved Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026-2031, backed by a budget framework of around Rs 1,300.45 crore, places the emphasis on renewable energy, electricity-efficiency measures, wheeling-charge reimbursement and resource heat mapping.

"Reliable and uninterrupted power with dual-source redundancy matters more than anything else," Karnataka IT minister Priyank Kharge told ET. He said the state was focusing on powered land, stronger transmission infrastructure and renewable energy rather than relying only on fiscal incentives. Powered land refers to sites with adequate electrical capacity and grid connections.

Karnataka is seeking to address power availability concerns by expanding its transmission network and identifying locations where land, power and connectivity can be developed together. The state currently has 147 intra-state substations at 220 kV and above, and 17 inter-state substations at 400 kV and 765 kV levels. Its transmission expansion plan envisages 91 new substations by 2029-30.

Telangana has received interest from data centre developers for nearly 13-14 GW of potential power demand. However, the state has said it will commit generation and transmission capacity only after companies make firm pledges, pay connection charges and provide deposits or sign long-term power procurement agreements.

(Surabhi Agarwal contributed to this story)

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

A-One Steels India Limited

CIN : U28999KA2012PLC063439

E-mail: Aone@aonesteelgroup.com | Website: www.aonesteelgroup.com

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in lakhs except EPS)

Particulars	STANDALONE			
	Quarter Ended			Year Ended
	30.06.2026 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Unaudited	30.06.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Audited
Revenue from operations	87,559.52	95,400.93	85,892.93	3,39,609.20
Profit / (loss) before tax and exceptional items	5,842.70	7,426.26	3,661.38	14,682.09
Profit / (loss) before tax	5,842.70	7,478.94	3,661.38	14,734.77
Profit / (loss) after tax for the period/ year	4,406.37	5,578.64	2,754.49	11,095.72
Total Comprehensive Income / (loss) (net of tax)	4,393.20	5,543.55	2,770.77	11,114.31
Paid-up equity share capital (face value ₹10 each fully paid)	6,846.53	6,846.53	6,846.53	6,846.53
Other Equity				69,020.80
Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (not annualised for interim periods): Basic and diluted (₹)	6.44	8.10	4.02	16.21

(₹ in lakhs except EPS)

Particulars	CONSOLIDATED			
	Quarter Ended			Year Ended
	30.06.2026 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Unaudited	30.06.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Audited
Revenue from operations	1,04,054.81	1,18,824.33	1,00,813.91	4,14,856.74
Profit / (loss) before tax and exceptional items	6,632.66	9,261.97	4,315.32	16,478.33
Profit / (loss) before tax	6,632.66	9,314.65	4,315.32	16,531.01
Profit / (loss) after tax for the period/ year	4,785.33	7,146.43	3,198.75	12,569.36
Total Comprehensive Income / (loss) (net of tax)	4,774.77	7,192.33	3,228.33	12,729.75
Paid-up equity share capital (face value ₹10 each fully paid)	6,846.53	6,846.53	6,846.53	6,846.53
Other Equity				77,093.91
Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (not annualised for interim periods): Basic and diluted (₹)	7.01	10.37	4.67	18.22

Notes :

1) The Unaudited Financial Results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on October 19, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out limited review on the above results in terms of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ('the Regulation'), as amended and expressed an unmodified conclusion.
2) The Company has identified two reportable segments viz. India Operations and Foreign Operations, in accordance with Ind AS 108, based on Internal Reporting reviewed by the CODM
3) The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly and annual results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange website www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and also on our Company's Website www.aonesteelgroup.com

Place : Karnataka
Date: October 19, 2026

SCAN ME

For **A-One Steels India Limited**
Sd/-
Sunil Jallan
Chairman and Whole-Time Director
DIN: 02150846

FORTUNA + SHARK

ET World Leaders Forum

SPOTLIGHT

MDR on UPI: A necessity for long-term sustainability

'NPCI has struck a perfect balance without compromising on resilient growth'

The framework's central choice is whom it leaves out. P2P transactions, 71% of total transaction value, carry 0% MDR, as do P2M transactions below₹2,000 and those by qualifying small merchants.

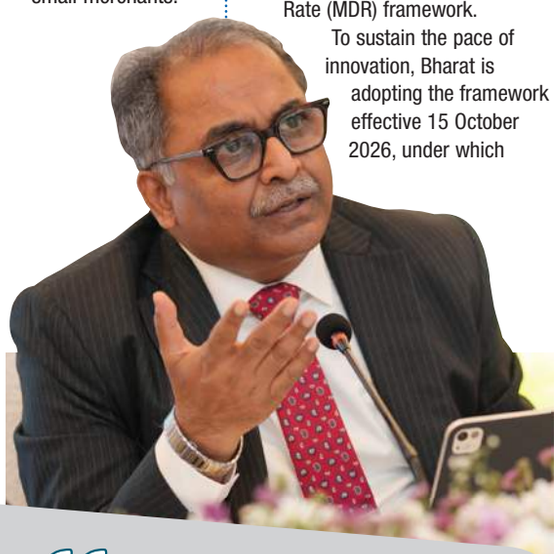
Pallavi.Chakravorty
@timesofindia.com

Few systems anywhere operate at the scale of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI). It carries 85% of Bharat's digital payment volume and processed more than 241.62 billion transactions in FY 2025-26 alone. Operational in 11 countries, it is the world's largest real-time payment system by volume, accounting for nearly 49% of global real-time payment volume.

That scale is the backdrop for Bharat's new Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) framework.

To sustain the pace of innovation, Bharat is adopting the framework effective 15 October 2026, under which certain transactions will incur a nominal fee to be distributed among ecosystem participants. This includes banks, payment service providers, and UPI application providers, helping them cover costs incurred in maintaining fraud/risk controls, customer service, and infrastructure upgrades, while also enabling payment apps to operate and invest in their businesses moving forward.

In a free-wheeling conversation with ET, Ajay Kumar Srivastava, MD & CEO, Indian Overseas Bank, does a deep dive into MDR and what difference it will make to the existing system.



> According to estimates, this new MDR framework will ensure that 96% of P2M transactions will remain unaffected
>
> **AJAY KUMAR SRIVASTAVA**
> MD & CEO
> Indian Overseas Bank

WHERE THE LINE IS DRAWN

The framework's central choice is whom it leaves out. P2P transactions, 71% of total transaction value, carry 0% MDR, as do P2M transactions below ₹2,000 and those by qualifying small merchants. "Essential, thin-margin sectors, including telecom, insurance, fuel, utilities, education and agricultural inputs, pay a flat ₹5. The charge falls on merchants, and customers continue to use UPI without fees or hidden charges," Srivastava said.

The usage data explains the choice. P2M accounts for 63% of transaction volume, but 86% of those payments are below ₹500. This is UPI's high-frequency, low-value retail layer, and most of it stays at zero MDR. P2P makes up 37% of volume but 71% of value, and it also stays free.

"According to estimates, this new MDR framework will ensure that 96% of P2M transactions will remain unaffected, a very important fact that needs to be considered when evaluating the likely impact on the merchant ecosystem," he said.

THE REVENUE LOGIC

By keeping P2P outside the MDR ambit, NPCI has kept UPI the preferred channel for both retail payments and larger-value transfers, while creating a revenue stream that does not touch the consumer ecosystem. Revenue from larger merchant transactions will be split among key participants, supporting remitter risk management, authentication, settlement, onboarding and upkeep of the core payments interface. "A dedicated fund equal to 5% of total MDR collections will promote UPI adoption among small merchants, supporting wider acceptance, sustained usage and the inclusion of more small businesses," Srivastava added.

The framework follows detailed deliberations by the UPI Steering Committee.

THE LARGER SHIFT

By monetising the higher-value commercial layer instead of the mass-market microtransaction layer, NPCI has undoubtedly made UPI's payment infrastructure more commercially sustainable.

"It could also gradually transition UPI from a public digital payment rail to a broader commercial payments ecosystem that achieves financial self-sustenance and draws greater investments into the network," he said.

Aiming for the Sky

India opened space activities to private firms via IN-SPACe a few years ago; companies like Ananth Technologies now build satellites domestically while eyeing global export contracts

Pallavi.Chakravorty
@timesofindia.com

Three years after India opened satellite manufacturing, launch vehicles, and ground segment work to private players through IN-SPACe, the sector is still finding its footing. It is moving from vendor status toward genuine end-to-end ownership of missions, but unevenly and against real constraints.

We caught up with Dr. Subba Rao Pavuluri, chairman and founder of Ananth Technologies — one of the earliest private entrants into India's space industry — who framed the transition as necessary but gradual.

ISRO spent decades building launch vehicles and satellites almost entirely with government funding. While opening that space to private players removes structural hurdles, the industry needs time to build the requisite pace and competence.

Pavuluri said Indian companies are beginning to make progress in the small-satellite segment, while opportunities for Indian-built launch vehicles are likely to emerge as domestic production scales up.

"World can be served from India. I am confident," he said, pointing to the potential for India to become a global manufacturing hub as production becomes more streamlined and volumes rise.

For the private sector, however, infrastructure remains a significant constraint. Large, state-of-the-art manufacturing and testing facilities are still limited, leaving companies dependent to some extent on ISRO infrastructure. Pavuluri said ISRO's policy of opening its facilities to industry could provide an important boost, alongside more aggressive technology transfers and greater handholding of private players.

He also identified funding and export-control regulations as important barriers to international expansion. While India has a strong pool of young talent, funding availability and export regulations need to evolve to support the sector's long-term sustainability.

Pavuluri believes policy must now move beyond enabling private participation to actively building globally competitive companies. "The NASA kind of model where private is treated more as a technology as well as manufacturing partner would yield better results," he said.

Ananth Technologies illustrates the scale of this evolution. Founded without the expectation of sweeping space-sector reforms, the company has progressively built its own manufacturing, assembly, integration and testing capabilities. It now has facilities capable of producing around 25 small satellites a month and eight large satellites in a six-month period.

Its Bengaluru clean room can accommodate up to three satellites of around four-tonne class simultaneously, reflecting the company's bet on future demand rather than merely existing requirements.

The trajectory signals a broader transformation: India's private space industry is no longer simply supporting the national space programme. It is building the capabilities to become an exporter of space technology, manufacturing and services.

Globalisation is increasingly central to this journey, with Ananth building satellites for customers in France and Sweden and pursuing strategic partnerships for GEO communications satellites, alongside deepening its domestic programmes.

> Indian companies are beginning to make progress in the small-satellite segment, while opportunities for Indian-built launch vehicles are likely to emerge as domestic production scales up
>
> **DR. SUBBA RAO PAVULURI**
> Chairman and Founder
> Ananth Technologies

Lifetime Free Newspapers Access

FREE • LIFETIME ACCESS • ALL CHANNELS

EDITORIALS PDF

- **English Editorials PDF**
  with International Newspapers Editorials [35–40 pages]
- **Hindi Editorials PDF**
- **Daily Vocabulary PDF**

MAGAZINE CHANNEL

National & International
[General & Exam related]

INTERNATIONAL NEWSPAPERS

Newspapers around the world.
Asian, European & American

INDIAN NEWSPAPERS CHANNEL

1. The Indian Express
2. The Hindu
3. Business Line
4. Financial Express
5. Times of India
6. Hindustan Times
7. Economic Times
8. Live Mint
9. Business Standard

HINDI NEWSPAPERS

1. दैनिक जागरण
2. जनसत्ता
3. हरिभूमि
4. हिंदुस्तान
5. लोकमत
6. लोकसत्ता
7. दैनिक भास्कर

CLICK HERE ▼

Tap the button above to get free access

ON A ROLLERCOASTER RIDE

Brent Scales 5-mth Peak, Then Slips

Reuters

Oil prices slipped after touching a five-month high on Tuesday as traders weighed a meeting between the Iranian president and Pakistan's army chief, a key US-Iran mediator, against continued Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure and reports of vessel attacks in the Gulf.

Brent crude futures fell 83 cents, or 0.76%, to $108.72 at 9 pm. Earlier in the session, the front-month contract reached $111.99, a five-month high.

The November contract for US West Texas Intermediate crude, which expires on Tuesday, was down 70 cents, or 0.68%, at $102.96. That was down from the session high of $110.48, the highest since April for a nearby contract. The more active December contract was down 64 cents, or 0.65%, at $97.90 a barrel.

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian discussed mediation efforts and regional developments during a meeting with Pakistan's army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir in Tehran, Iran's Nournews reported on Tuesday.

Pakistan's mediation efforts resulted in an interim peace agreement signed in June. But that deal quickly faltered amid new fighting between Iran and the US weeks later.

The talks in Tehran are against the backdrop of continued attacks by Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis, who said on Monday they launched several attacks on Saudi energy, airport and military targets, such as an Aramco site in Yanbu, the Shaybah oilfield, Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport and Abha airport.

Saudi authorities did not immediately confirm the Houthi claims and Reuters could not independently verify them.

"Oil prices remain well-supported. ... This suggests the market is pricing in a significant risk premium, given the situation's volatility," ING analysts said in a note on Tuesday.

At least 18 vessels were reportedly attacked over two weeks, which keeps the risk premium intact, shiptracker Kpler said in a note on Monday.

Also on Monday, a Houthi attack on a training camp for government security forces in Yemen's Shabwa province killed 58 people and injured more than 200.

The renewed attacks heightened fears about regional stability and underscored continuing risks to energy supply from the region, keeping oil prices above $100 a barrel.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in a statement he is "committed to completing the elimination of the Iranian regime," and spoke with US President Donald Trump about it on Sunday.

Schaeffler India MD Taken into Custody over Factory Accident

Two workers died on June 9 at Pune plant; co says operations continue as usual

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Schaeffler India CEO and managing director Harsha Gopal Kadam has been taken into custody after an investigation into a June 9 accident at the company's factory in Talegaon, Pune, which killed two workers employed by its service provider, the Indian subsidiary of the German auto component maker said in a regulatory filing on Tuesday.

The manufacturer of high-precision engine and transmission parts said that the Talegaon MIDC Police Station, under the Pimpri Chinchwad Police Commissionerate, took Kadam into custody on October 19 under the provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023.

The accident involved a sudden discharge of carbon dioxide gas during a scheduled cylinder replacement at the factory premises, resulting in the death of two workers, the company said.

The scope of the investigation has now been expanded to include Kadam on the grounds that he is the "occupier" of the factory premises under applicable law, according to the filing. He was taken into custody at around 6.40 pm on Monday.

"The company and its officers have duly cooperated in the investigation and will continue to do so," Schaeffler India said in the filing.

The company said that it "has complied and continues to comply with all laws applicable to it". "The company's senior management continues to be in charge of the day-to-day management, and the business operations of the company continue in the ordinary course," it said.

Schaeffler India said it is evaluating the developments in consultation with its legal advisers and will take all necessary legal steps.

'India's Branded Home Mkt to Double by 2032'

New Delhi: India's real estate firms are bullish on branded residences market on rising demand from super-rich, with nearly 25 such ultra-luxury housing projects to be completed by 2032, according to Savills report. Branded residences are ultra luxury homes developed by real estate companies in association with globally renowned hospitality, design and lifestyle brands. Residents get hotel like services apart from wellness, leisure and lifestyle amenities in such projects. – PTI

Delhi Airport Traffic Rises to 38.5 million in First Half of FY27

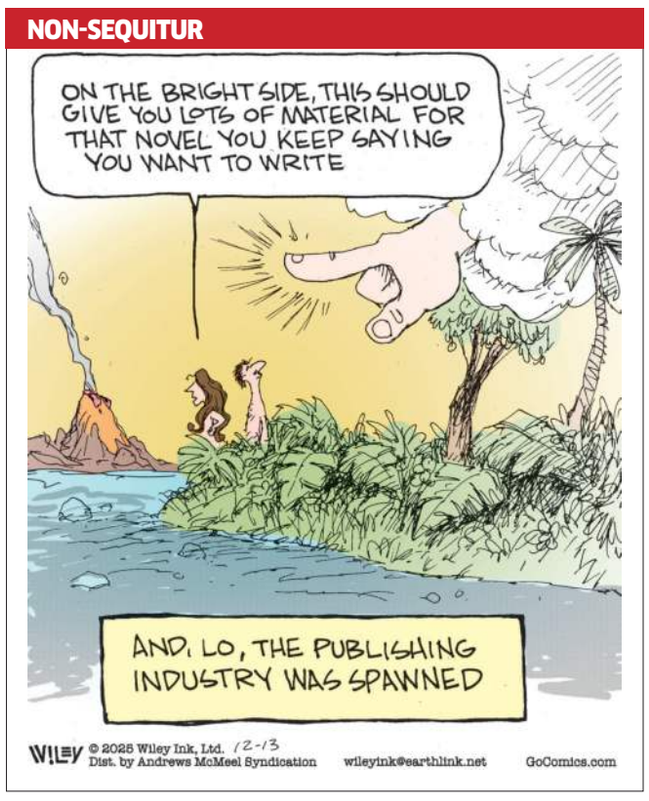
Press Trust of India

New Delhi: Total passenger traffic at Delhi airport rose 5% to 38.5 million in the first six months ended September 2026, driven by more number of domestic as well as international travellers.

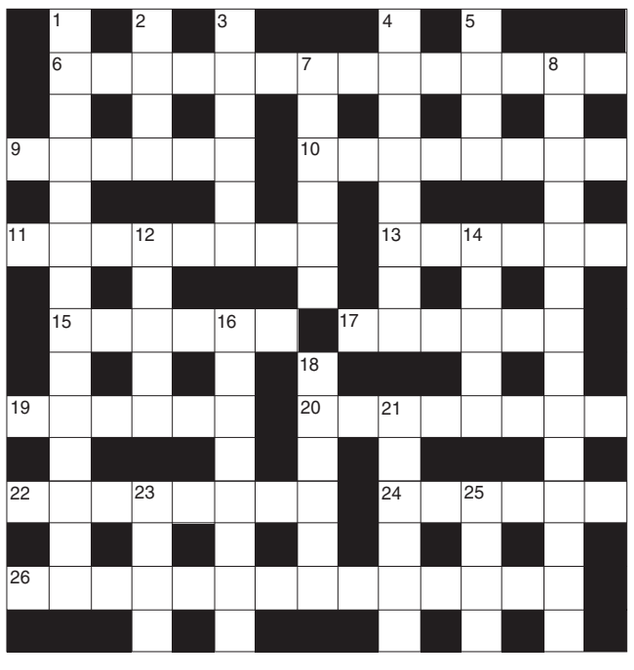
In the first half of 2025-26, Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA) in the national capital had reported passenger traffic of 36.7 million. Latest data provided by GMR Airports showed that Air Traffic Movements at the airport also jumped 6.9% to 2,33,331 in the first half of the ongoing 2026-27 fiscal year. During this period, the domestic traffic climbed to 28.1 million while the international traffic increased to 10.4 million, taking the total traffic to 38.5 million. IGIA is operated by Delhi International Airport Ltd.

At the Delhi airport, average monthly traffic stood around 6.5 million and also recorded the highest-ever H1 total passenger traffic in the first six months of this fiscal year, GMR Airports said in a recent regulatory filing.

NON-SEQUITUR



Crossword 9735



ACROSS

6 Dim seaman sat fidgeting around artist – that's almost totally accurate! (2,4,2,6)
9 Take an extended time to fit in? (6)
10 Stop for liquid after taking in ordinary sites for aerials? (8)
11 They supply counsel as drives are put in order (8)
13 Join military type leaving island (6)
15 This gym with no end of machines could make one strong (6)
17 Competes in a velodrome in recurrent series (6)
19 Cite set of rules about words for duty on alcohol, say (3,3)
20 A baron is treated for graze (8)
22 Bachelor enters charming area with yard and small tree (5,3)
24 Party with rain upset chap (6)
26 Like former pupils, characterising those valuing tradition? (2,3,3,6)

DOWN

1 Regard poorly weak idea of TV broadcast about source of incredible money (4,1,3,4,2)
2 Release part of fund, officially (4)
3 Hang loosely standard lastly over corner (6)
4 Losing head, boy is loud sadly in an offensive way (8)
5 Exclude some from Italy (4)
7 Stop suspect rates? About right (6)
8 Easily influenced young troublemaker able seniors put right (14)
12 At home, obtained lump of metal (5)
14 Learner losing marks considers temporary pauses (5)
16 Model to message reserve (8)
18 Welsh chap, father and daughter touring sides of factory (6)
21 Bring down wine for all to see with case of champagne (6)
23 Resounding sound in one choir (4)
25 Origin in course, it's said (4)

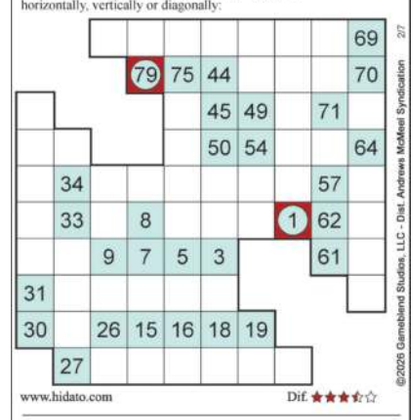
SOLUTION TO No. 9734:
ACROSS: 1 Depravedness. **8** Inflict. **9** Plateau. **11** Come to heel. **12** Card. **14** Underarm. **16** Bender. **17** Oaf. **19** Thurso. **21** Co-editor. **24** Oats. **25** Pre-eminent. **27** Sunburn. **28** Orleans. **29** Additive free.
DOWN: 1 Defamed. **2** Paint brush. **3** Antihero. **4** Espied. **5** Neat. **6** Steward. **7** Discourteous. **10** Under protest. **13** Weedkiller. **15** Mac. **18** Foregone. **20** Untoned. **22** Teenage. **23** Brunei. **26** Fuji.

©The Daily Mail

HIDATO

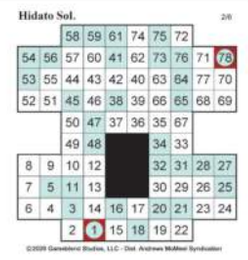
FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 79 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:



www.hidato.com Dif. ★★★½☆

Yesterday's puzzle solution.



7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES

1 "Solo" actor Donald (6)
2 refused admittance to (8)
3 time outside the capsule (9)
4 held on to a grudge (8)
5 self-conscious (8)
6 fake people (7)
7 Genghis Khan, often (7)

SOLUTIONS

VER GLO LUD ALK SPA
ED RE PH ES INS
AD INV EXC SEN EC
ER URE ONI TED CEW

Yesterday's Answers: 1. PALLIATE 2. EARS 3. SLEEPING 4. BIGHT 5. MANCHESTER 6. OCTOPUS 7. JARRE

TIMES interact

Connecting People, Connecting Needs.

To book your ad

Logon to: ads.timesofindia.com
or Call: 18001205474 (Toll Free)

Scan QR Code

real estate

PROPERTY ANCILLARIES

COMMERCIAL PREMISES

FOR SALE HAVELI on Main Hawa Mahal Road Jaipur, (Raj)
1500 Sq. Yards (Approx) East-Facing. Prime Location with three side Road Access. Ideal for Hotel, Showroom Or Commercial Use.
Excellent Location
Just 200-300 Meters from Govind Dev Ji Temple Kale Hanuman Ji Temple City Palace & Hawa Mahal.
9782793001

jobs

SITUATION VACANT

ACADEMIC

GENERAL

DELHI Heights School req TGT-Hindi, TGT, PRT, NTT. Candidates will apply on delhiheightsschool@gmail.com. Add Jhankar Rd,Qutub Vihar,Dwarka Sec-19B,ND- 71

DELHI ENGLISH ACADEMY
(CBSE affiliated Sr. Sec. School)
Sector- 25, Dwarka , New Delhi-110077
Ph.No: 8810270723
delhienglishacademy2026@gmail.com
Applications are invited for the following posts:
- Vice-Principal (Minimum having 2 yrs experience as Vice Principal or 5 yrs experience as Academic coordinator)
- PGT: Chemistry, Physics, Mathematics
- Coordinator (Primary classes)
- Mother Teacher (Pre-primary classes)
- Mother Teacher (Primary classes)
- Fee Assistant

Eligible candidate e-mail their application with detailed resume at school mail Id or send by post on school address.

HARI VIDYA BHAWAN
SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL
K-II/600, Sangam Vihar, N.D-80
REQUIRES
TGT - Sanskrit IX - X
PRT - Computer
PRT - All Subject
Walk-in for Interview
Between 8:30 am to 12:30 pm
9312037700
8130707700
harividyabhawan@gmail.com

REQD (F) PGT Accounts, History, Special. Educator, Office Assistant for a School in Sector 7, Rohini. Send CV to recr.roh@gmail.com

REQUIRED PGT - Chem, Phy, Music Tchr, PRTs, NTT, Office Asst. # MNDP School Sangam Vihar, ND-80 # 93151-08711, E: mndpsss@yahoo.com

Arise, Awake, and Stop Not Till the Goal is Achieved
Estd. 1978
Vivekanand School
D-Block, Anand Vihar, Delhi-92
Ph. : 46516983, 41055675
www.vivekanandschool.in
Invites applications for the following posts
PGT English
PGT Economics (leave vacancy)
TGT English
TGT Mathematics
TGT Hindi
PRT Music
Psychological Counsellor
Activity Coordinator
(Preferred Qualifications & Skills)
* Graduate in any discipline.
* Tech-savvy with proficiency in MS Office, Google Workspace, and digital tools.
* Good communication, organisational, and interpersonal skills.
* Ability to plan, coordinate, and execute school events and activities effectively.
Receptionist
Tech savvy candidates with good communication skills will be preferred.
Send your resume to the Chairman along with a passport size photograph within a week at
jobs@vivekanandschool.in

WE ARE HIRING
A reputed organization based in Gurgaon requires experienced personnel for Govt. Liaison work
LIAISON OFFICER (Gurgaon)
JOB ROLE:
- Liaison with Govt Dept.MCG, Town and Country Planning (DTCP), Civil & Court matters
- Drafting and Representation- Official Letters & Application in English & Hindi
- Follow-up with all concerned Govt. Department

REQUIREMENT:
- Retired Senior Officers from Govt./MCG/HUDA/DTCP/ Courts Administration pref.
- Excellent knowledge of Gurgaon Govt. office procedures
- Good command over written English & Hindi

Salary Rs.30K-50Kpm | Full Time/Part Time,Flexible for retd. person
Apply Now | Immediate Joining | Opportunity for Retired Professionals
9810061124 dinesh-jain@live.in

TEACHER

GLOBAL NAV JEEWAN Sr. Sec. School (An ICSE School) D-Block, DLF Ankur Vihar Karawal Nagar Delhi Requires : PGT Computer ScienceVisit School office or E-mail: career.gnjss@gmail.com

NAV JEEWAN MODEL School, Vishnu Garden New Delhi-18 Requires : TGT Social Science and Computer Science Teacher Visit School office or E-mail: njmsjob@gmail.com

ACCOUNTS

ACCOUNTANT

WANTED Senior Accountant for permanent position with reputed All-India Company, role based in South Delhi. Must have excellent knowledge of financial statements, GST, EPF, ESI, labour compliances, etc. Minimum 15 years of experience or CA qualification, good command of Excel and ability to work independently. 12 lacs + PA with annual growth. Send CV to hr@getgi.com

WANTED Accountant Female 3–4 yrs exp. Reqd. in Tally/BUSY software Location: Punjabi Bagh,N.D. # 9811161068 Em: harshsoni.stc@gmail.com

REQD. Expd. Accountant (Male) Qualification: B.Com Age: Below 40yrs Location: Noida Sec 90/Okhla. Mail CV sanskartradex@gmail.com

ACCOUNTS & FINANCE

WANTED Female Accountant for Accounting Firm at Mayur Vihar Office, B.Com Qualified, Fresher/Exp, Good Salary. # 8287807546

ADMINISTRATION

SECRETARIES

SECRETARY Cum Agent reqd by an insurance officer at Vasant Vhr. A Grad. with Good English. Sal+Stipend+Comm. & promotion. 9810315375

ENGLISH Speaking Ladies for highly prestigious social-noble work for women. Biodata: Wh'App 9871803515 Em: dr.surinder@yahoo.com

OTHER VACANCIES

MULTIPLE VACANCIES

*MANAGER/ EXECUTIVE (Civil Maintenance)
Male, Diploma Civil with Min. 1 yr. exp. of property maintenance work
*WARDEN (PG) M/F
*SWEEPER / PEON
A PG in North Delhi, reqrs experienced candidate.
Interested To Send CV/ Appear for Walk in interview on:
26th Oct. 2026 (Mon.)
From 2:00 To 5:00 PM
at JAI GROUP
19/2A, NEAR NAGIA PARK, SHAKTI NAGAR, DELHI -07
WhatsApp:9810091121

REQUIRED: 1. Sr.Accountant-2 Vacancies. 2. Store Keeper- Conversant with ERP & Manual Store management. Apply in confidence to: chintamanimetaludyog@gmail.com

GURGAON based growing Co. dealing in Real Estate, Hotel & Hospitalities require 1) Sr. Accountant 2) Admin Manager E: speedlines44@yahoo.co.in

IT RELATED

COMPUTER OPERATORS

WANTED 15 Computer Operators for permanent position with 32 year old ISO Certified Indian Company. Must be proficient in MS Office. Sincere and hardworking Candidates. Freshers welcome. Remuneration dep -ending on calibre. Walk in interviews on 19th to 24th Oct 26 between 11:00 AM and 4:00 PM at G.I. Group, TA-264/265, First Floor, Main Road Tughlakabad Extn., (Next to Pocket No-8, DDA Flat Kalkaji Extn.), New Delhi-110019.

REQD. Unmarried Female Comp. Operator with good com. skils for LPG agency at Karampura, Moti Nagar (Sunday Closed). 011-4503 2506, 4142 7254 Preferably from nearby area.

MARKETING, ADVERTISING & SALES

MARKETING

A leading group in Hospitality & Commercial leasing req a Sales & Marketing Manager for its guest houses & commercial offices in Gurgaon. Candidate should be pleasant looking, fluent in Eng., with good communication skills, preferably residing in Gurgaon & have own conveyance. Em: hr@enkayresidency.com

SALES

REQD Sales Executive female with minimum five years experience in jewellery line. Attractive Salary and perks, Contact 9811570280

REQUIRED
SALES PERSON
Exp. > 3 Years
Contact:
9818525500 ,9319699949
PREF. EXPERIENCE in Refinery Products like: Sulphur and Petcoke. Salary negotiable.

PART TIME JOBS

WE req Part/Full Time for sec-18,Noida. age 30-70yrs edu-grad +pref-retired, h'wife,VRS,CA, self empl earn 50k-1lac fix+vari frgn trip 8368480428,7011667190

WORK FROM HOME

WORK Only Sunday Earn Rs. 10000 to 30000 from Home/ Off. No Insurance/Field work 17yrs Old Co. 9911212632, 8810235686, 8595084987 Free Training.

SERVICES

RESTAURANTS

JADE Garden Bar reqs. Cashier,Captain,Stewards,cook -Chineese/ Tandoor, Helper, UT at 5/66, Padam Singh Rd., Karol Bagh, ND-5 # 9810131663

TECHNICAL

SUPERVISORS

WANTED: Mech. Engineer/ Diploma, with experience in working with Indian railway, In Ghaziabad. Email CV to: hiring@v2s.co.in

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Sachin, S/o Moolchand, R/o 219/220, Kailashpuram, Govindpuram, Police Station-Kavinagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201013, have changed my minor son's name from Lakshaya to Lakshaya Sharma (DOB- 7.11.2012) for all future purposes.

I, Indira dependent mother of Akula Madhusudan resident of H No 3-43/11, Hathnoora,Dist - Sangareddy, Telangana -502296 have changed my name from Indira to Akula Indira vide affidavit dated 03-10-2026 before Fareed khan at Civil court Sangareddy

I Rohit Sachdeva S/O Gurjeet Sachdeva, R/O H.No.1 Begumpur Malviya Nagar New Delhi. I have changed the name of my Minor daughter Myra Sachdeva aged 14 years and she shall hereafter be known as Mriganggi Sachdeva.

I, Dalbir Kaur W/o Jitender Singh R/o D-48,first floor,Kiran Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059, in my son's Dakshjeet Singh birth certificate my name was written as Dalbir Singh, whereas my correct name is Dalbir Kaur.

I, Saroj D/o No 7098300W Sep Late Banwari Lal R/o VPO-Bharawas, Distt-Rewari (HR) have changed my name & corrected DOB from Saroj (17/07/1969) to Saroj Devi (20/03/1969) for future purpose

I, Shirin, W/o Mohammad Naushad Ansari, R/o T-33, Huts, Ramesh Park, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-92, have changed my name to Shirin Ansari for all purposes.

I, Balbir Singh S/o R.S. Walia R/o B-50,GF, Lajpat Nagar IV, Dayanand Colony, Delhi-110024 declare that Balbir Walia and Balbir Singh Walia both are same person.

I Praveen Shukla S/o Ashok Shukla do hereby solemnly declare that Praveen Kumar and Praveen Shukla are the names of one and the same person.

I Uday Soni S/o Ramekbal Sah R/o Village Bhikampur, Post-Dangsi, Gopalganj, Bhishunpura, Bihar-841407 declare that Uday Sah & Uday Soni both are same person

I, Naveen S/o Chand Rathi, R/o H. No. 386, Raj Pur Khurd, Delhi – 110068, have changed my name to Naveen Rathi for all purposes.

LOST & FOUND

LOST of my FDR NO-31603, File No.F-16(20670)/2012/RHN, Application No.215703, Priority No.12859 in Rohini LIG Scheme C-1/555, Sector-35, Rohini, Delhi. In the Name-of Kali Charan Mehra S/o Late Sh. Atma Ram Mehra. Finder may Contact-Rooma Mehra D/o Sh. Baldev Kumar Mehra at-House No- L-4, Flat No-101, Mahavir Enclave, First Floor, Front Side, Palam Village, Delhi-45.

LOST of my FDR NO-32648, File No.F-16(21534)/2012/RHN, Application No.156013, Priority No.15088 in Rohini LIG Scheme A-1/537, Sector-36,Rohini,Delhi. In the Name-of Ghasi Ram S/o Sh. Bhagwan Singh. Finder may Contact-Jagdish S/o Late Sh. Ghasi Ram at-House No- I-275, Mangolpuri, Delhi-83.

LOST My Original Perpetual Lease Deed of Property Number BG-7/110 Paschim Vihar ND -110063 Please Finder cont: Veena Gupta (8920961158)

LOST My Original Perpetual Lease Deed of Property Number BG-7/109 Paschim Vihar ND -110063 Please Finder cont: Bhoti Devi (9811054570)

TIMES interact BUSINESS CONNECT

THRIVE WITH KAUSHIK
Trusted by Leaders
STRESS IS COSTING YOU MORE THAN MONEY.
Executive Life Coach for CEOs & Founders
1-to-1 | Confidential | Virtual / In- Person
• Clarity • Peak Performance
• Stress Management
APPLY FOR A 15-MIN CONFIDENTIAL STRATEGY CALL
REGISTER: www.thrivewithkaushik.com
SCAN TO BOOK 15-MIN CALL

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquires and seek appropriate advice before sending money, incurring any expenses, acting on medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication. All creatives marked as Advertorial, Spotlight and Promotional Features are to be treated as Advertisements. The Times of India Group doesn't vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of the products and services. The Printer, Publisher, Editor, and the owners of The Times of India Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences, in the event such claims are not honoured by the Advertisers.

TIMES TRIBUTES
RATE CARD

Publications	Rates per sq. cms
TOID Capital + NBT (Delhi+NCR)	1295
TOID Full Run ## + NBT (Delhi+NCR)	1360
THE TIMES OF INDIA (Delhi+NCR)	780
THE TIMES OF INDIA (Delhi) Full Run##	900
NAVBHARAT TIMES (Delhi+NCR)	595
THE ECONOMIC TIMES (Delhi+NCR)	715
SANDHYA TIMES (Delhi)	100

Rates effective 5th June 2019

►*Placement on specified obit pages only.► This rate benefit is extended up till the size of 320 sq. cm only. ► ## Full run includes Delhi City + NCR (Including Gurgaon + Noida) + Chandigarh + Western U.P. + Uttarakhand ► TOI Capital (Delhi & NCR) Includes TOI Gurgaon & TOI Noida.

To place an Obituary announcement or Remembrance message please call
Vinod: 9958992088
Pankaj : 8130604727

BOOK YOUR RECRUITMENT ADS
For Booking please contact:
Amit Ghosh - 9811790649
Raghav Arora - 9999995460
Scan to book
Book online to access exclusive offers and personalized assistance. Log on to
Ads.timesofindia.com

ETMarkets

Hope · Greed · Fear · Panic · Hope

Beating Volatility

WWW.ETMARKETS.COM
NEW DELHI / GURGAON, WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026

SMART INVESTING

Sun Pharma to Raise ₹10k-cr to Part-finance Organon Deal

A DIGITAL PLAY THAT SPEAKS TO INDIA

Jio Platforms Well Placed to Ride AI, Data Centre Wave

Ranjit Shinde

ET Intelligence Group: India's largest IPO to date offers a theoretically compelling reason - beyond its superlative size - for retail investors to dial into Jio Platforms: Valuation comfort relative to its closest peer Bharti Airtel. Of course, that shouldn't hide the challenges Jio faces in an industry where technology changes faster than seasons, creating a perennial demand for hefty capital.

On paper, Jio has industry-leading scale with 533 million telecom customers that underscores numerical superiority in both the mobile and broadband markets. But Jio's monthly average revenue per user (ARPU) at ₹215.6 trails Bharti Airtel's ₹263.9 (India business) as of June 2026 quarter. On the profitability front, too, Jio's Ebitda margin range of 50-53% lags 56-57% range for the closest peer. The IPO forms only 2.9% of the post-issue capital. The promoter stake will fall to 64.4% after the IPO from 66.4%. Relative valuation comfort, however, leaves sufficient room for upside – and justifies retail commitment to the ₹30,213-crore issue.

IPO WATCH

Numbers Game

Peer Comparison (FY26 data unless stated)

	Jio Platforms	Bharti Airtel
Total customers (m, Jun'26)	533.3	491.1*
ARPU (Jun'26)	₹215.6	₹263.9*
Data traffic (b GB, Jun'26)	69.4	31.1*
Revenue from operations	₹1,46,885 cr	₹2,10,972 cr
EBITDA	₹76,255 cr	₹1,21,267 cr
EBITDA margin (%)	51.9	57.5
Net profit	₹30,049 cr	₹33,822 cr

*India business

IPO dates: **October 21-23**
IPO Price: **₹1,065-1,119**
IPO Size: **Upto ₹30,213 cr**
Implied Market Cap: **Upto ₹10.3 lakh cr**
Face Value: **₹10**
Lot Size: **12 shares**
Retail Portion: **35%**

BUSINESS

Incorporated in 2019, Jio Platforms offers digital connectivity and services pan India through its subsidiary Reliance Jio Infocomm (RJIO), which holds the spectrum licences for wireless telecom services. Jio Platforms provides wireless connectivity, fixed broadband, enterprise and cloud services, and AI services. It is India's largest digital connectivity platform, carrying over 60% of the country's wireless data traffic in FY26. It had 284.9 million 5G subscribers as of June 2026, forming 53% of its total subscriber base. It operates one million route kilometres of fibre network across India. Its spectrum holding was 26,800.8 megahertz (MHz) as of June 2026, the highest among telecom operators in India and with a remaining average life of 15.8 years.

FINANCIALS

Consolidated revenue increased by 15.8% annually between FY24 and FY26 to ₹1,46,885.3 crore. Net profit rose by 18.4% annually to ₹30,049 crore during the period. While RJIO continues to be the major contributor to the total revenue of Jio Platforms, its share fell to 87.7% in FY26 from 91.4% in FY24. The share of digital services rose to 11% from 6.9% during the period. The operating margin before depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda margin) improved to 51.9% in FY26 from 50.2% in FY24. In the June 2026 quarter, revenue and net profit increased 11.8% and 9.2% to ₹39,172.9 crore and ₹7,764.1 crore while Ebitda margin expanded by 150 bps to 53.3% YoY.

VALUATION

Considering post-IPO equity, Jio Platforms demands a price-earnings multiple of 34.3 on FY26 earnings and 33.2 on annualised June 2026 quarter earnings. Bharti Airtel trades at an FY26 P/E of 43.8 and forward P/E of 35.8. Given the improving data traffic, and traction in data centres and AI related services, Jio Platforms looks well placed to take advantage of these opportunities.

Jio IPO Pricing Leaves Enough for Investors to Gain: Akash Ambani

Himanshi Lohchab

We will selectively focus on partnerships where our technology and operating experience can create lasting value for both sides
AKASH AMBANI
MD, Jio Platforms

Mumbai: Jio Platforms set the price range for its initial public offering with market uncertainty in mind while leaving room for investors to benefit, managing director Akash Ambani said, as the first IPO in two decades from the Reliance Industries group opens Wednesday amid choppy market conditions.

"Market conditions are without doubt an important consideration in pricing any issue…True to the Reliance philosophy, we believe in leaving enough on the table for investors who wish to participate in the company's long-term growth. That thinking guided our approach to the price band," Ambani said in an email interview with **ET**.

The company has set a ₹1,065-1,119 price band for the ₹30,188 crore IPO, the largest in India's stock market history. Jio plans to use the IPO proceeds to eliminate $3 billion (about ₹28,500 crore) in net debt and fund growth using free cash flow, which constitutes 30% of its annual revenue of about ₹1.5 lakh crore.

"Our focus remains on consistently growing our customer base and engagement, improving monetisation, maintaining healthy margins and generating strong cash flows. We will also continue strengthening our balance sheet and technology capabilities," Ambani said.

Jio's anchor book of ₹8,110 crore received bids worth about ₹2.5 lakh crore, or more than 30 times the shares on offer, from global and domestic investors on Monday. The company is offering 270 million newly issued shares in the IPO. No existing shareholder is selling shares. The IPO will close for public subscription on Friday.

Beyond the listing, Jio is pursuing opportunities to monetise its telecom technology overseas, Ambani said. "We see opportunities in both developed and developing markets. We will selectively focus on partnerships where our technology and operating experience can create lasting value for both sides," he said.

The technology spans cloud-native radio access networks, 5G core systems, operating and business support platforms, fixed wireless connectivity and AI-driven network automation.

"Our initial focus is markets that need network upgrades, a 5G rollout or FWA-led fixed broadband, working through local operators, managed-services arrangements and, where it fits, greenfield deployments," he said.

Jio is also exploring a sovereign low Earth orbit satellite constellation for India, while developing ground infrastructure and considering partnerships to bring services to the market at the earliest, he said. Satellite services would address needs in maritime, aviation and remote areas while complementing terrestrial networks. The company has not announced a date for the commercial launch of its satellite services. "That depends on approvals, technology and deployment readiness, and we will share milestones as plans firm up," Ambani said.

He said it would be premature to indicate a price point now for the services. "We will share tariff details as our plans and the necessary approvals progress," he said.

In its core telecom business, Jio expects greater engagement and adoption of entertainment, cloud, productivity, AI and enterprise services to support average revenue per user (ARPU).

BULLION LOSES SHINE

Gold Extends Decline on Inflation and Rate Outlook Worries

Bloomberg

Gold declined as elevated oil prices added fuel to inflation concerns and clouded the outlook for the Federal Reserve's interest-rate path. Bullion traded around $4,120 an ounce, after falling 0.6% in the previous session.

The precious metal has mostly moved in the opposite direction to oil since the US-Iran war erupted in late February, as disruptions to energy shipments from the region triggered a quickening in inflation and led major central banks to tighten monetary policy. Higher borrowing costs are typically bearish for gold, which yields no interest.

US Treasury yields steadied on Tuesday, after rising in the previous session. A rebound in tech shares sapped some haven demand for the US debt at the start of the week, pushing yields higher and weighing on the yellow metal. Traders are trying to anticipate Fed's next move in its battle to keep inflation in check.

Spot gold fell 0.4% to $4,123.59 at 12.32 pm in London. Silver steadied at $57.20, while platinum traded in a narrow range and palladium dipped. Bullion has generally held above $4,100 so far in October.

UNSTABLE CORRELATIONS A DRAG

JPMorgan Asset Sees Bitcoin Beating Stocks, But With a Big Catch

Bloomberg

JPMorgan Asset Management has included Bitcoin in its long-term capital market assumptions for the first time, forecasting returns that could beat stocks, bonds and gold in a milestone for its Wall Street acceptance.

But there's a catch: Bitcoin's extreme volatility threatens to undermine its appeal on a risk-adjusted basis.

JPMorgan's base case projects annualised returns of 10% over the next decade, but also assumes annual volatility of 55%, more than three times that of US large-cap stocks. The firm stops short of incorporating Bitcoin into its main portfolio models, it said in a report this week, citing its unstable correlations with other assets.

Such volatility can eat into compounded returns as steep losses require even larger gains to recover. That's a risk familiar to Bitcoin ETF investors who bought near the cryptocurrency's peak of just over $126,000 in 2025, only to see their holdings lose as much as 50% as prices retreated. Since the pandemic, various Wall Street firms have been making more earnest inroads into the world of cryptocurrencies.

OIL RETREAT ALSO HELPS

US Stocks Rise as Strong Earnings Lift Sentiment

AP

The US stock market is rising Tuesday following strong profit reports for Equifax, Hasbro and other companies, while oil prices ease back after nearing their highest levels since the war with Iran began. The S&P 500 added 0.4%. The Dow Jones Industrial Average was up 539 points, or 1%, as of 1.48 pm Eastern time, while more swings for the AI industry had the Nasdaq composite up a more modest 0.2%.

Keeping the market in check was GM, which sank 8.2% even as profit beat analyst expectations

Stock prices tend to follow the path of corporate profits over the long term, and several companies delivered results for the latest quarter that were better than analysts expected. Big expectations for growth generally are what have allowed the US stock market to hit records recently despite worries about high inflation, higher interest rates and other challenges weighing on Wall Street.

Equifax rallied 10.6% for one of the market's biggest gains after reporting a bigger profit for the summer than analysts expected, despite high mortgage rates slowing some parts of its business.

Stocks also got a lift after the price for a barrel of Brent crude erased an early gain to fall 0.8% to $108.70. Earlier in the morning, it got near $112 and approached its highest price since the war with Iran began in late February.

TRADE SHOW Avg daily client buys of unlisted shares have nearly halved since NSE's listing; some say other players will emerge

With NSE Out, Unlisted Share Market Loses Zip

Ravindra Sonavane

Mumbai: Trading activity in the unlisted share market has dropped following the National Stock Exchange of India's (NSE) stock market debut last month. The value of average daily client purchases of unlisted shares has nearly halved across various platforms since the exchange's listing, according to brokers. NSE had accounted for more than half of trading volumes in this unregulated over-the-counter market.

"NSE made up nearly 50-60% of trading volumes in unlisted markets, so with NSE listing, many expect unlisted activity to slow down sharply," said Umesh Paliwal, co-founder, Unlisted Zone.

For over a decade, NSE had been one of the most sought-after names among investors in the unlisted market. In the past two years, the exchange dominated activity in the space, with demand picking up further ahead of its much-awaited IPO in the third week of September. With the process of buying NSE shares, which earlier could take several months to complete, becoming significantly faster in the run-up to the IPO, millions of shares changed hands on a daily basis. That has stopped

"Whenever a major unlisted company gets listed, some of the liquidity and investor attention naturally shifts, but another set of companies tends to emerge and take its place. It is essentially a cycle," said Manan Doshi, co-founder, Unlisted Arena.

Trading activity in some other companies has gained momentum. Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India (MSEI) has emerged as the most actively bought unlisted stock, while Transline Technologies, Quality Enviro Engineers and Sun Drops Energia are also attracting interest. However, none has come close to matching NSE's popularity in terms of purchase volumes, said brokers.

"NSE practically sold itself, since every investor understood an exchange's business model and its dominance," said Paliwal. "With other companies, we'll need to explain the business, the growth story, and why it's worth owning before the IPO. Selling will take more effort, but the opportunity remains."

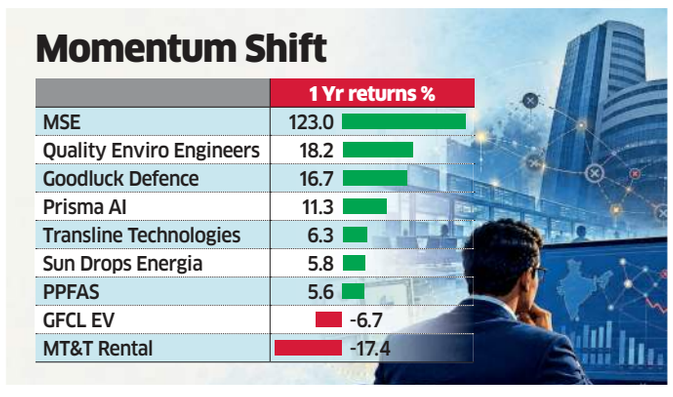
Hitesh Dharawat, founder of Dharawat Securities, said API Holdings, the parent company of Pharmeasy, Oravel Stays, the parent of Oyo, and Hindustan Power Exchange are among the other popular stocks in the segment.

Unlisted market participants said interest is also emerging in companies such as PPFAS, GFCL EV, MT&T Rental, Prisma AI, Goodluck Defence and Vervesemi.

"While NSE's listing may cause some near-term moderation in volumes, the market is continuing to see interest in the next set of potential opportunities," Doshi said.

Momentum Shift

	1 Yr returns %
MSE	123.0
Quality Enviro Engineers	18.2
Goodluck Defence	16.7
Prisma AI	11.3
Transline Technologies	6.3
Sun Drops Energia	5.8
PPFAS	5.6
GFCL EV	-6.7
MT&T Rental	-17.4



MSEI TOPS BUYERS' WISHLIST

Trading activity in some companies has gained momentum. Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India has emerged as the most actively bought unlisted stock, while Transline Technologies is also attracting interest

responsible for renewables

ENERGY FOR EVER
इरेडा IREDA
ONCE IREDA ALWAYS IREDA
(A Navratna CPSE)

THE LARGEST PURE-PLAY
GREEN FINANCING INSTITUTION
IN THE COUNTRY

*Q2 FY 2026-27 vs Q2 FY 2025-26

LOAN DISBURSEMENTS* ₹10,579 crore — Up by 31%
LOAN BOOK* ₹97,411 crore — Up by 15%
REVENUE FROM OPERATIONS* ₹2,345 crore — Up by 14%
NET WORTH* ₹14,337 crore — Up by 11%
NET NPAs* 1.08% — Improved by 45%

Extract of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year Ended September 30, 2026

(₹ in crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
		30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26	30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	2,344.75	2,249.54	2,057.45	4,594.29	4,016.98	8,337.48	2,346.88	2,250.60	2,057.85	4,597.48	4,017.69	8,338.89
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
4.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	554.26	337.50	549.00	891.75	795.68	1,873.34	552.14	338.53	549.33	890.67	796.21	1,874.00
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	427.65	277.65	614.00	705.30	879.38	1,993.46	425.99	278.30	614.76	704.29	880.97	1,997.15
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹10/- each)	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23
7.	Other Equity	11,528.17	11,323.27	10,110.95	11,528.17	10,110.95	10,972.12	11,531.21	11,327.96	10,112.92	11,531.21	10,112.92	10,976.19
8.	Securities Premium Account (net)	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56						
9.	Net Worth	14,337.40	14,132.50	12,920.18	14,337.40	12,920.18	13,781.35						
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt	80,882.38	79,002.01	69,939.39	80,882.38	69,939.39	77,845.63						
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	5.64	5.59	5.41	5.64	5.41	5.65						
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)												
	A. Basic:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
	B. Diluted:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
13.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-

Notes:

a) The above results have been recommended by the Audit Committee of Directors and approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on 19.10.2026 and have been audited by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.

b) The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly & half yearly financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI LODR Regulations. The full format of the said financial results are available on the website of the Company, www.ireda.in/financial-results, and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com.

c) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI LODR Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and can be accessed at www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com, respectively.

For and on Behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty
Chairman & Managing Director (Addl. Charge); Director (Finance)
DIN No.: 08816532

Date: 19.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

INDIAN RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Registered Office: 1st Floor, Core-4A, East Court, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003, **Tel.:** 011-24682206-19, **Fax:** 011-24682202
Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, August Kranti Bhawan, Bhikaiji Cama Place, New Delhi-110066, **Tel.:** 011-26717400-12, **Fax:** 011-26717416
Business Centre: NBCC Office Complex, Office Block No. II, Plate B, 7th Floor, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110023, **Tel.:** 011-24347729-99
Website: www.ireda.in | **CIN:** L65100DL1987GOI027265

SCAN THE QR CODE FOR ACCESSING FINANCIAL RESULTS

Follow us on: IREDALtd · IREDALimited · iredaofficial · IREDA Ltd. · IREDALtd

ET GRAPHICS

How to Invest ₹10 Lakh in Uncertain Markets

With uncertainty looming large over equity markets, investors looking to deploy a lump sum are facing a tricky question: how to go about allocating money to various assets. Wealth managers generally favour a mix of equities, debt and gold, with allocations varying as per investors' risk appetite. ET spoke to four wealth managers to understand how they would invest ₹10 lakh for conservative, moderate and aggressive investors.

JUZER GABAJIWALA, Director, Ventura Securities

CONSERVATIVE INVESTOR		MODERATE INVESTOR		AGGRESSIVE INVESTOR	
Allocation	**Schemes and Amount**	**Allocation**	**Schemes and Amount**	**Allocation**	**Schemes and Amount**
Equity 0%	Nil	**Equity 70%**	WOC Flexi Cap Fund (₹3.5 lakh), Invesco India Mid Cap Fund (₹2.5 lakh), Bandhan Small Cap Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Equity 90**	WOC Flexi Cap Fund (₹5.5 lakh), Invesco India Mid Cap Fund (₹2.5 lakh), Bandhan Small Cap Fund (₹1 lakh)
Hybrid 100%	DSP Multi Asset Allocation Fund (₹2.5 lakh), HDFC Multi-Asset Active FOF (₹2 lakh), Nippon India Multi Asset Allocation Fund (₹2 lakh), WOC Multi Asset Allocation Fund(₹1 lakh), Kotak Multi Asset Allocation Fund (₹2.5 lakh)	**Hybrid 20%**	WOC Multi Asset Allocation Fund (₹2 lakh)	**Hybrid 0**	Nil
Gold 0 %	Nil	**Gold 10%**	Kotak gold ETF (₹1 lakh)	**Gold 10**	Kotak Gold ETF (₹1 lakh)

VISHAL DHAWAN, Founder, Plan Ahead Wealth Advisors

Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount
Equity 20%	MOSL Nifty 500 Index Fund (₹1 lakh), HDFC Flexicap Fund (₹1 lakh - STP over 6 months)	**Equity 40%**	MOSL Nifty 500 Index Fund (₹2 lakh), HDFC Flexicap Fund (₹2 lakh - STP over 6 months)	**Equity 70%**	MOSL Nifty 500 Index Fund (₹2 lakh), Oldbridge Focused Fund (₹2 lakh), Parag Parikh Flexicap Fund (₹1.5 lakh), DSP Value Fund (₹1.5 lakh -STP over 6 months)
Hybrid 30%	ICICI Balanced Advantage Fund (₹1.5 lakh), SBI Equity Savings Fund (₹1.5 lakh Lumpsum)	**Hybrid 30%**	ICICI Balanced Advantage Fund (₹1.5 lakh), Edelweiss Balanced Advantage Fund (₹1.5 lakh)	**Hybrid 20%**	HDFC Balanced Advantage Fund (₹1 lakh), Edelweiss Balanced Advantage Fund (₹1 lakh)
Debt 35%	Kotak Income Plus Arbitrage Fund (₹2 lakh), Invesco India Arbitrage Fund (₹1.5 lakh Lumpsum)	**Debt 20%**	Kotak Income plus Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh), Invesco India Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Debt 0%**	Nil
Gold 15%	SBI Gold ETF (₹1.5 lakh)	**Gold 10%**	SBI Gold ETF (₹1 lakh)	**Gold 10%**	SBI Gold ETF (₹1 lakh)

DHEERAJ GAUR, Chief Investment Strategy Officer, Choice Wealth

Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount
Equity 45%	Kotak Multi Cap Fund (₹2.5 lakh), Nippon India Large Cap Fund (₹1 lakh), ITI Small Cap Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Equity 70%**	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap Fund (₹2 lakh), HDFC Mid Cap Fund (₹1.5 lakh), ITI Small Cap Fund (₹2 lakh), WhiteOak Capital Dividend Yield Fund (₹1.5 lakh)	**Equity 80%**	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap Fund (₹2 lakh), HDFC Mid Cap Fund (₹2 lakh), ITI Small Cap Fund (₹3 lakh), WhiteOak Capital Dividend Yield Fund (₹1 lakh)
Hybrid 25%	WhiteOak Capital Multi Asset Allocation Fund (₹2.5 lakh)	**Hybrid 10%**	ICICI Prudential Aggressive Hybrid Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Hybrid 10%**	ICICI Prudential Aggressive Hybrid Fund (₹1 lakh)
Gold/NCDs 30%	Motilal Oswal Gold and Silver Passive Fund of Funds (₹1 lakh), NCDs [2-3 years maturity 9-11% YTM] (₹2 lakh)	**Gold/NCDs 20%**	Motilal Oswal Gold and Silver Passive Fund of Funds (₹1 lakh), NCDs [2-3 years maturity 9-11% YTM] (₹1 lakh)	**NCDs 10%**	NCDs [2-3 years maturity 9-11% YTM] (₹1 lakh)

FEROZE AZEEZ, Joint CEO, Anand Rathi Wealth

Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount	Allocation	Schemes and Amount
Equity 65%	Quant Large Cap Fund (₹1.63 lakh), HDFC Flexi Cap Fund (₹1.43 lakh), ICICI Prudential Dividend Yield Fund (₹1.3 lakh), Kotak Mid Cap Fund (₹1.04 lakh), Invesco India Smallcap Fund (₹1.1 lakh)	**Equity 75%**	Quant Large Cap Fund (₹3.68 lakh), Canara Robeco Multi Cap Fund (₹1.88 lakh), Kotak Mid Cap Fund (₹0.83 lakh), HDFC Small Cap Fund (₹0.55 lakh), Invesco India Smallcap Fund (₹0.56 lakh)	**Equity 80%**	Quant Large Cap Fund (₹3.84 lakh), ICICI Prudential Focused Fund (₹1.2 lakh), Kotak Mid Cap Fund (₹1.04 lakh), Invesco India Smallcap Fund (₹0.96 lakh), HDFC Small Cap Fund (₹0.96 lakh)
Arbitrage 30%	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh), Kotak Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh), SBI Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Arbitrage 20%**	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh), Kotak Arbitrage Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Arbitrage 15%**	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage Fund (₹0.75 lakh), SBI Arbitrage Fund (₹0.75 lakh)
Or		**Or**		**Or**	
Target Maturity Funds 30%	Kotak Nifty SDL April 2032 Top 12 Equal Weight Index Fund (₹1.2 lakh), Bandhan CRISIL IBX 90:10 SDL Plus Gilt - April 2032 Index Fund (₹1.2 lakh), HDFC NIFTY G-Sec Jun 2036 Index Fund (₹0.6 lakh)	**Target Maturity Funds 20%**	ICICI Prudential Nifty SDL Dec 2028 Index Fund (₹1 lakh), Kotak Nifty SDL Jul 2033 Index Fund (₹1 lakh)	**Target Maturity Funds 15%**	ICICI Prudential Nifty SDL December 2028 Index Fund (₹0.75 lakh), Kotak Nifty SDL April 2032 Top 12 Equal Wt Index Fund (₹0.75 lakh)
Gold 5%	UTI Gold ETF (₹0.5 lakh)	**Gold 5%**	UTI Gold ETF (₹0.5 lakh)	**Gold 5%**	UTI Gold ETF (₹0.5 lakh)

Note: Invest in either arbitrage funds or target maturity funds, not both

ET IN THE CLASSROOM

As Rates Rise, Should Investors Bet on Gilt Funds?

Gilt funds are back in focus among investors with interest rates rising and bond yields across the world moving up sharply. A look at what these developments mean for this debt fund category

WHAT ARE GILT FUNDS?

Gilt funds are debt mutual funds that invest in government securities issued by the central and state governments. Long-duration gilt funds typically invest in government bonds with maturities of 10 years or more. Since these securities are backed by the government, the credit risk is extremely low with the chances of default being minimal.

HOW ARE GILT FUNDS DIFFERENT FROM SHORT-TERM FUNDS?

Gilt funds typically invest in longer-duration government bonds. Returns from gilt funds that invest in long-term securities can fluctuate sharply when bond yields move up or down.

On the other hand, short-term debt funds invest in bonds and money-market instruments with shorter tenures. They tend to be less sensitive to interest-rate movements. As a result, they see lower fluctuations in returns

BUT AREN'T INVESTMENTS IN GILT FUNDS RISK-FREE?

From a credit-risk perspective, that's true. But that does not mean these funds are entirely risk-free. This is because the big risk comes from volatility in bond prices. There are a whole host of factors such as RBI rate decisions, inflation, government borrowing, liquidity conditions, US Treasury yields, Federal Reserve decisions, crude oil prices, foreign investor flows and geopolitical developments that influence bond prices. They affect gilt fund returns.

SO, WHEN IS IT FAVOURABLE TO INVEST IN GILT FUNDS?

Gilt funds tend to be most attractive when investors expect bond yields to decline. Investors often start looking at gilt funds when they feel interest rates and bond yields are at their peak, and the scope for further rate increases is limited. This is because bond prices and bond yields move in opposite directions. When yields fall, bond prices rise, benefiting gilt funds.

Invesco Mutual Fund

An investor education and awareness initiative

For Know Your Customer (KYC) guidelines along with the documentary requirements and procedure for change of address, phone number, bank details, etc., please visit the Education and Guidance section on www.invescomutualfund.com. Investor should deal with only SEBI registered Mutual Funds, details of which can be verified under "Intermediaries/Market Infrastructure Institutions" on https://www.sebi.gov.in/index.html. For any grievance / complaint, please call us on 1800-209-0007 or write to us at mfservices@invescoindia.com. Alternatively, complaints can be registered on the SEBI SCORES Portal at https://scores.sebi.gov.in

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

HOW DO BOND FUND MANAGERS GENERATE RETURNS FROM GILT FUNDS?

Fund managers generate returns in two ways. The first is the interest earned on the government bonds held by the fund.

The second is when bond prices change. When bond yields fall, bond prices rise, allowing fund managers to book profits by selling some bonds at higher prices. But if bond yields rise, bond prices fall, which in turn hurts returns.

SACHIN KUMAR

IS THIS THE RIGHT TIME TO INVEST IN GILT FUNDS?

That depends largely on where investors believe bond yields could move from here.

Gilt funds tend to perform best when investors expect bond yields to decline. A section of market participants believes the bond yields have peaked.

"The current environment offers an opportunity to gradually build exposure to long-duration government bonds," said Basant Bafna, Head of Fixed Income, Mirae Asset Mutual Fund. According to him, bond yields have already risen sharply, and markets may be pricing in more RBI rate hikes than the central bank ultimately delivers.

However, others remain cautious. They say uncertainties such as the likelihood of further US rate hikes, inflation risks and weaker foreign flows could keep bond yields higher for longer periods

So, investing in gilt funds requires investors to get the timing of bond yields right, which is easier said than done.

FALL SEASON Currency likely to slip further despite lower CAD and RBI support

Rupee's Got No Place to Hide from Global Financial Turmoil

Won Wins

Asian currency performance since January 2026

Currency	Spot Returns (in %)
South Korean Won	8.53
Chinese Renminbi	4.60
Singapore Dollar	0.50
Malaysian Ringgit	-0.70
Hong Kong Dollar	-0.72
Japanese Yen	-1.01
Taiwanese Dollar	-3.33
Indian Rupee	-4.98
Thai Baht	-6.19
Philippine Peso	-6.69
Indonesian Rupiah	-7.30

Source: Bloomberg

Rozebud Gonsalves

Mumbai: The Indian rupee is expected to weaken further, despite a contraction in current account deficit (CAD) to around 0.5% of the GDP from about 2.5% three years ago, as tighter global financial conditions and persistent foreign portfolio outflows make the gap harder to bridge, economists said.

The rupee has depreciated 5% this calendar year, with further weakness likely despite sustained Reserve Bank of India (RBI) intervention, as external pressures remain beyond the central bank's control.

The rupee is the fourth-worst performing currency in Asia this year, with the Indonesian rupiah the weakest, Bloomberg data showed. The Indonesian currency fell 7.3% while the South Korean won was the best performer, gaining 8.5%. The Chinese yuan gained 4.6% this year.

"The size of the deficit that can be financed without persistent pressure on the exchange rate or FX reserves… needs to adjust as global capital becomes scarcer and costlier," said Dhiraj Nim, economist and FX strategist, ANZ Bank. "Therefore, an expected FY27 CAD of 1–1.5% of GDP could prove difficult to finance," Nim said.

Additionally, with Brent crude prices hovering near $105 a barrel, further rupee depreciation would be a natural consequence of a higher oil import bill, economists said. As one of the world's largest oil importers, India remains vulnerable to elevated crude prices, which add to inflationary pressures and weigh on the currency.

Persistent foreign portfolio outflows are compounding the pressure, with sustained selling of Indian assets adding to dollar demand and reinforcing expectations of further rupee weakness.

"Despite the recent measures, we see limited room for sustained INR appreciation on grounds of manufacturing and trade competitiveness. A challenging portfolio flows outlook leaves the door open to further gradual rupee depreciation, with high sensitivity to oil price movements and risk sentiments," Radhika Rao, senior economist at DBS Bank said in an October 17 report.

Recently, the RBI introduced a special window to meet the daily dollar requirements of three state-run oil companies diverting their purchases away from the spot market. It has also tightened rules on foreign-exchange derivatives to curb speculative dollar demand and excessive hedging.

FUNDS TO FLOW Co's board has okayed NCD issue of up to ₹15,000 cr

Sun Pharma to Raise ₹10k-cr to Part-finance Organon Deal

Shilpy Sinha

Mumbai: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries, the country's largest drugmaker by market value, is raising ₹10,000 crore through two tranches of rupee-denominated bonds, with coupons of 8.05% and 8.20%, people aware of the development told **ET**.

The funds are being garnered to partly help refinance bridge loans the drugmaker took to buy US healthcare company Organon.

The company is pricing the bonds with maturities in 2031, said the people cited above.

One tranche of ₹7,000 crore carries a coupon of 8.20%, while a ₹3,000 crore tranche carries a coupon of 8.05% and includes a put option in 2028, allowing investors to seek early redemption in accordance with the terms of the issue, according to sources. The fundraising follows Sun Pharma's board approval last week to issue non-convertible debentures worth up to ₹15,000 crore. The company had disclosed the proposed borrowing programme but had not specified the final pricing and tranche-wise terms.

The proceeds are intended to support acquisition-related financing. Sun Pharma agreed in April to acquire Organon in an all-cash transaction valued at an enterprise value of $11.75 billion, marking a major expansion of its global business and women's health portfolio.

Organon, a global healthcare company spun off from Merck, reported revenue of $6.2 billion and adjusted operating profit of around $2 billion in calendar year 2025, translating into a healthy operating margin of around 31%, according to a latest Crisil report. Sun Pharma is expected to deploy $2.0-2.5 billion of its cash surplus and internal accruals towards the acquisition, with the balance funded through additional debt of $9.5-10.0 billion, the report said.

Institutional investors, including insurance companies, pension funds and mutual funds, are likely to participate in the bond issue. The anchor investors are likely to be SBI Pension Fund, SBI Life Insurance, ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, Aditya Birla Sun Life Insurance, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Edelweiss Mutual Fund and SBI Mutual Fund, among others. Crisil Ratings has assigned AAA/Stable rating to the proposed NCDs.

SBI Capital Markets, Standard Chartered Bank and MUFG Securities India are arranging the bond sale.

The two tranches have seen initial interest from a broad institutional investor base, including entities investing on behalf of pension subscribers and insurance policyholders. Such investors are significant participants in India's corporate bond market, particularly in longer-dated debt issued by highly rated companies.

SURGING YIELDS FUEL CONCERNS

Bessent Sees No Spillover from France Bond Market's Turmoil

US Treasury secretary Scott Bessent said he doesn't anticipate a spillover from the French bond market, which has seen surging yields that have in turn driven a broader conversation about the European nation's finances.

"I don't anticipate a spillover from what's happening in France," Bessent said on Tuesday. "The French have a tough hand, but president Macron's economic team, whom I know very well, are really first rate."

France has been embroiled in protests in recent weeks, with the unrest turning more violent over the weekend and taking the government by surprise. This added pressure on the country's debt, which has underperformed its peers under a government struggling to contain its budget deficit.

—**Bloomberg**

AI Debutant's Flameout Stokes Fears Boom is Ending

REALITY CHECK Elice among over half a dozen firms that the past few weeks have shown investors souring on AI

Bloomberg

Scarcely known outside its home market until this week, Elice on Tuesday found itself at the heart of a roiling debate about AI valuations and whether companies will be able to deliver on them.

The $750 million data centre and AI developer became a surprise poster child for the loss of faith in so-called neoclouds when it tanked 32% on its debut in Seoul. It joined a half dozen other companies in the sector that just over the past few weeks have shown investors souring on artificial intelligence. Australia's Firmus Grid and AirTrunk have delayed public offerings, Britain's Nscale and US peer SB Energy faced investor pushback on their valuations, and CoreWeave's bond yields shot up to 15%.

In a sharp reversal from the broad-based pile-in of recent years, global markets are now being much more selective and demanding with AI bets. Neoclouds, the firms that specialise in running dedicated facilities for AI computation delivered over the internet, are an essential part of the supply chain that customers like Anthropic PBC and OpenAI tap in multibillion-dollar deals for capacity. But worries about financing, delays in data center construction and the uncertainty of returns have jolted the entire tech ecosystem, triggering the longest losing streak in semiconductor stocks since the global financial crisis.

"Elice's disastrous debut is another confirmation that the era of 'buy everything AI' has given way to 'question everything AI,'" said Hebe Chen, senior market analyst at Vantage Global.

Neoclouds are particularly vulnerable. New Jersey-based CoreWeave is the best known among them, pioneering the business model of taking on significant debt to load up on Nvidia graphics processing units (GPUs) that it later rents out in multiyear contracts. Its 18 months on public markets have shown the wild swings of confidence in this strategy: the company's market value approached $90 billion last year, with Nvidia a vocal backer and investor, but it's endured a brutal selloff since then and is now more than 60% off its peak.

Firmus's initial public offering valuing it at $30 billion collapsed, while Nscale is facing investor skepticism on a listing at a similar valuation. The two have run into the real-world challenges of converting AI computing demand and orders into functional operations, as both have only a small fraction of their planned data centre capacity live. As the cost of capital increases, investors are becoming more wary of companies depending heavily on future revenues.

Soaring borrowing costs were the catalyst for CoreWeave's most recent selloff. Its bonds this month sank into distressed territory — leading Nvidia chief executive officer Jensen Huang to step in to reassure markets — while AI investor SoftBank Group's credit risk rose to the highest level in nearly four years. SB Energy is SoftBank's vehicle for setting up AI infrastructure in the US, but its IPO talks have slowed to a crawl and regulatory approvals have also taken longer than expected.

One of the world's most enthusiastic investors in AI, SoftBank faces pressure on several fronts. Its largest holding is a significant share in OpenAI, which already pushed its IPO into next year, and the SB Energy debut was designed to help it raise funds to support its construction projects in the US. SoftBank pushed through the largest corporate junk-bond offering on record last month, raising roughly $11 billion.

THE AIM: MAKING EPC PROJECTS MORE ATTRACTIVE

On a High-way! High-Performer Builders to Pay Lower Security

Penal provision introduced for contractors in case of fatal accident on the highway

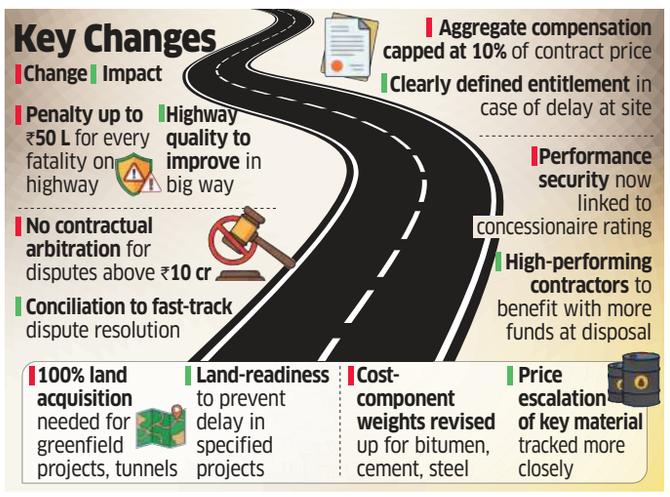
Yogima Seth

New Delhi: The Centre has linked national highway contractors' performance security to their ratings so that high performers have to furnish lower deposits, thus creating a quality-driven incentive framework for India's massive motorway network development.

Three slabs of 3%, 4% and 5% have been introduced for engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) projects through the revised model concession agreement introduced recently. Until now, a standard 5% performance security was applicable on all projects.

"The idea is to give financial advantage to highly rated contractors as quality of highway construction is the top priority," a government official said. "However, additional-security retention can affect cash flow for low-rated contractors."

Besides, it has introduced penal provision for contractors for every fatal accident on the highway, put in place a formula-based compensation mechanism with a cap, set up higher standards for land acquisitions and introduced price adjustment for key raw materials to suit the current need.



All this is aimed at making EPC contracts more attractive while ensuring the current hurdles for EPC contracts are addressed as more EPC bids are invited in the current year and next.

As per the revised framework, contractors with rating above 80% will have to deposit a 3% of the project value as security while the rate of deposit is 4% for contractors with rating between 70% and 80% and 5% for ratings below 70%.

The last major revision in the concession agreement for EPC projects happened in 2022.

Jagannarayan Padmanabhan, senior director and global head, consulting at Crisil Intelligence said the revised EPC framework contains both contractor-supportive and authority-protective changes.

"Differentiated performance security and a formula for prolongation costs may improve bid financing and entitlement certainty," he said. "Howeevr, restrictions on contractual arbitration for large disputes and limits embedded in compensation and escalation mechanisms can constrain claim recovery," he added.

The last major revision in the concession agreement for EPC projects was in 2022

The government plans to award highest number of highway projects in the EPC mode in the current financial year with the National Highways Authority of India identifying 26 projects under the engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) mode, 21 under the hybrid annuity model (HAM) and seven under the build-operate-transfer (BOT) model for awarding.

Disclosure Must for G-Sec Tax Exemption Claims

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has prescribed a disclosure requirement for taxpayers claiming exemptions on interest and capital gains from government securities under the Income-Tax Act, 2025.

The Income-tax (Seventh Amendment) Rules, 2026, inserted Rule 281A into the Income-tax Rules, 2026, requiring taxpayers claiming exemptions under Schedule IV in a notification issued on Monday.

The newly inserted Form 173A seeks details of the taxpayer's name, country of residence, address, permanent account number (PAN), tax year, email address and contact number. It also requires the value of government securities held on April 1 and March 31, purchases during the tax year, sale proceeds, gross interest received or accrued, and capital gains earned.

Taxpayers must identify the securities by their International Securities Identification Number (ISIN), specify their type and tenor, and provide a declaration confirming the accuracy of the information submitted, the notification said.

The form covers treasury bills, fixed-rate bonds, floating-rate bonds, state development loans and other government securities.

PSBs Ready Diwali Gift, Tailor New Products for Youth

To cover savings, investments, insurance and loans; may offer counselling too

Dheeraj Tiwari

New Delhi: State-run banks plan to launch three products targeting youth ahead of Diwali, covering savings, investments, insurance and loans. The initiative follows finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman's directive to banks to strengthen engagement with young citizens entering the formal financial system.

Banks are also working on a shared portal with interactive features to engage youth and provide easy access to banking information.

The features being considered for the new products include free demat accounts and counselling on financial planning, said people familiar with the development.

These products will be launched before Diwali, while the portal is expected to go live by the end of November, they said.

"Besides these three products, which will have similar offerings across all lenders, individually banks can top them up with more features," said a senior executive at a state-run bank.

Options like waiving charges and offering incentives to encourage youth to open accounts are also being considered, another bank executive said.

Banks have shared their branch and ATM location details to enable the creation of a branch locator facility on the portal, the executive said. "It will be an interactive set up, offering guidance on financial planning, entrepreneurship and positive financial behaviour."

At PSB Confluence, the two-day strategy and ideation conclave of state-run banks held in August, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman asked the lenders to develop strategies to attract the youth, leveraging their products, regional presence and other strengths.

Banks were asked to sensitise youth about the importance of maintaining good credit scores and history for responsible credit discipline. The minister also pitched for a web- and mobile-friendly portal dedicated to banking awareness for youth. It was suggested that the portal have interactive features such as quizzes, graphics and certificates aimed at building interest among the youth.

CHARGED UP!

Options like waiving charges and offering incentives to encourage youth to open accounts also being considered

According to the latest Reserve Bank of India Financial Stability Report, prime-plus borrowers in the ₹5–10 lakh income segment drove the fastest increase in fresh bad loans or non-performing assets in nine quarters through the third quarter of 2025-26.

A month-long campaign targeting youth above 16 years is currently ongoing. Started on October 2 and coordinated by the Indian Banks' Association, it seeks to strengthen engagement with young citizens entering the formal financial system.

FOOD TO FEED: DEMAND IS ON THE RISE

Drought-hit Maize Sparks Tussle for Priority Access

Poultry producers, ethanol and starch makers lobby with govt as production falls and alternatives remain limited

Jayashree Bhosale

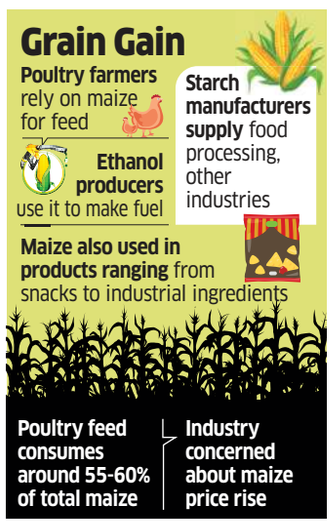
Pune: A dwindling supply of maize has triggered a competition among key industries for priority access. With drought affecting maize production and alternatives remaining limited, sectors including poultry producers, ethanol manufacturers and starch makers are urging the government to prioritise their sector.

Poultry farmers rely on maize for feed, ethanol producers use it to make fuel, and starch manufacturers supply food processing and other industries. The grain is also used in products ranging from snacks to industrial ingredients, while its conversion into ethanol has linked it to India's efforts to reduce reliance on imported crude oil.

The National Egg Coordination Committee (NECC) and the Grain Ethanol Manufacturers Association (GEMA) are among the industry bodies making representations to the government to secure supplies.

The oil marketing companies (OMCs) have released their first tender for procuring ethanol for the ethanol blending programme (EBP) for the upcoming ethanol year beginning November. They have decided to exclude sugar-based ethanol from the first tender for EBP of 2026-27 ethanol year and have reduced the incentives for maize-based ethanol by Rs 3/litre.

"In the absence of a substantial contribution from sugarcane-based ethanol, the tender appears to place a disproportionate burden on rice-based feedstocks, particularly surplus foodgrains (SFG) and damaged foodgrains (DFG), while potentially diluting the role of maize as an industrial feedstock," said Grain-Based Ethanol Manufacturers (GEMA) in a release.



"The industry's concern is that procurement may initially favour SFG up to the prescribed cap, followed by DFG as the next-lowest-priced option, with limited scope of maize receiving any allocations," said GEMA president CK Jain. "Cutting the maize incentive while lower-priced rice-based supplies remain available risks weakening the economics of maize-based production and the market it creates for farmers."

Even as grain-based ethanol manufacturers are trying to ensure that the government does not curtail procurement of maize based ethanol, the poultry industry is concerned about the maize prices that have been continuously rising over the last few months.

"While maize supply is tightening, demand continues to surge due to the government's grain-based ethanol blending programme, which scaled up dramatically. Alongside needs from the starch and food-processing industries, poultry feed typically consumes around 55-60% of total maize, placing it in direct competition with ethanol plants," the NECC said in a letter to the government last week.

"Maize should get priority for food as it is used in many foods in the form of starch, and it is a main feed for poultry. If we increase the use of maize for ethanol, then we may starve poultry and may have to import starch from China," said GK Sood, a senior agricultural expert.

Russia Ships Least Crude in a Month

Russia shipped the least crude in a month as operations at its key Baltic port were paused, most likely for maintenance work.

In the four weeks through October 18, overseas crude flows fell to 3.59 million bpd, tanker data compiled by Bloomberg showed.

Satellite images of Primorsk terminal near St. Petersburg show no tankers berthed at jetties in middle of last week, while industry reports and automatic tracking signals suggest a three-day gap in arrivals and departures. Similar interruptions in the past have been linked to maintenance.– **Bloomberg**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
02260001	12V, 7AH CAPACITY SEALED MAINTENANCE FREE BATTERY	5797 NOS	02.11.2026
19261230	BRAKE SHOE COMPLETE (STANDARD SIZE)	27762 NOS	16.11.2026

NOTE-
1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice NO. 51/2026-2027 Dated: 19.10.2026 **3649/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CHHATTISGARH TOURISM BOARD
UDYOG BHAWAN, 2nd FLOOR, TELIBHANDHA RAIPUR - 492 006
दूरभाष : (0771) 4024600, 4024611, 4224630 फैक्स : (0771) 4066425 ई-मेल : visitcg@gmail.com

NIT no GENS/64693/2026 **Date - 15/10/2026**

Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)

Subject - Notice Inviting Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Contractor for Balance work with external development for Pandrapath Resort, Dist. Jashpur, Chhattisgarhas mentioned in below table

The Chhattisgarh Tourism Board (CTB) (the "Authority") has decided to Select a Contractor for Balance work with external development for Pandrapath Resort, Dist.Jashpur, Chhattisgarh. In this regard, CTB is inviting eligible bidders to submit Bid Online through Chhattisgarh e-Procurement website : https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in/ in Two cover Bid System, for the subject Project in compliance with the NIT.

Sr. No.	Name of Project	Date of issue of tender document	Last Date for sending Pre-Bid Queries	Date of Pre-Bid Meeting	Last Date for Submission of Bid (Online)	Last Date for Submission of Bid (Offline)	Date of Bid Opening
1.	Selection of Contractor for Balance work with external development for Pandrapath Resort, Dist. Jashpur, Chhattisgarh	21.10.2026	28.10.2026 Till 12:00 PM	28.10.2026 at 03:00 PM	23.11.2026 Till 05:30 PM	23.11.2026 Till 05:30 PM	25.11.2026 At 12:00 PM

Managing Director,
Chhattisgarh Tourism Board

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer (Const.), North-Western Railway, Bikaner for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-Tenders under **Two packet system** for the following works:- **1. Tender No.:** NWR-SC-BKN-05-2026-27, 2. **Name of the work with its location:** Provision of new ballast siding including Earthwork in filling and cutting in formation, blanketing, Extension of Minor Bridges, Rail level platform, shifting of duty hut of level crossing, linking of track, points and crossings, transportation of P-Way materials and other ancillary works at Ramdevra station in connection with construction of new Railway line from Ramdevra to Pokran via Bhairav Gufa-Kailash Tekri over Jodhpur Division. **3. Approx. cost of the work:** Rs. 17,64,56,960.72, **4. Bid Security (Earnest Money) to be deposited:** Rs. 35,29,100.00, **5. Date for submission of e-Tender:** On 13.11.2026 upto 15.00 hrs, **6. Details and particulars of website where e-tender can be seen & filled up.: www.ireps.gov.in**, **7. Official email address: dycecbkn@gmail.com, Note:- 1.** No manual tender will be accepted. **2.** The Bid Security (Earnest Money) shall be deposited in cash through e- payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in the tender documents. The bank guarantee bond should be issued in favour of FA & CAO/Construction, North Western Railway Jaipur otherwise tender will not be considered.

1505-DO/26

Follow us on : /NWRailways NWRailways_

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ General, North Western Railway, Bikaner for & on behalf of the President of India, invites E- tenders for the following work. **1. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website No.: http://www.ireps.gov.in, 2. Date & time of closing of e-tenders:** 12.11.2026 at 15.00 hours., **3. Date & time of opening of e-tenders:** After 15.00 Hrs on 12.11.2026, **Tender Notice No.:-** 19-El-BKN-E-Tender-26-27, **Name of work:-** Electrical work in c/w Augmentation of facilities at Lahli Goods shed, Augmentation of passenger amenities at Bhiwani City station and additional room & toilets for running staff at Running room at Hisar over Bikaner division, **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):-** ₹ 9631040/-, **EMD/SD (in Rs.):-** ₹ 192600/-, **Tender Documents cost:-** Nil, **Tender Notice No.:-** 20-El-BKN-E-Tender-26-27, **Name of work:-** Electrical work in c/w Extension of PF no. 1 at Kolayat to accommodate 24 coaches trains and raising of ML PF no. 1 & 2 at Bap along with extension to 480 meter and raising of ML passenger PF no. 1 & 2 at Sird & Nokhra stations over Bikaner division., **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):-** ₹ 6049147/-, **EMD/SD (in Rs.):-** ₹ 121700/-, **Tender Documents cost:-** ₹ 121700/-, **Tender Notice No.:-** 21-El-BKN-E-Tender-26-27, **Name of work:-** Electrical work in c/w Proliferation of HABDs (9 nos.) over Bikaner division., **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):-** ₹ 5559427/-, **EMD/SD (in Rs.):-** ₹ 111200/-, **Tender Documents cost:-** Nil, **Tender Notice No.:-** 30-El-BKN-E-Ten-23-24R, **Name of work:-** Provision/ replacement of earth for protection against leakage current at various station/service building/Railway residential quarters over Bikaner Division, **Approx. Cost of the work (in Rs.):-** ₹ 21067750/-, **EMD/SD (in Rs.):-** ₹ 421400/-, **Tender Documents cost:-** Nil

1507-DO/26

Follow us on : /NWRailways NWRailways_

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

शुद्धिपत्र (CORRIGENDUM)

ई–निविदा सूचना संख्या: 35265410 दिनांक: 13.10.2026 पूर्व प्रकाशित निविदा संख्या–35265410 में "विकल्प खंड" (Option Clause) एवं "विभाजन खंड" (Splitting Clause) जोड़ने के संबंध में। एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि उपर्युक्त निविदा, जिसे दिनांक 28.10.2026 को खोला जाना निर्धारित है, में निम्नलिखित खंड जोड़े जाते हैं। **1. विकल्प खंड (Option Clause) 2. विभाजन खंड (Splitting Clause)** निविदा की अन्य सभी नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

सहायक मुख्य सामग्री प्रबंधक
सामान्य भंडार / उ.प.रे. / जोधपुर

1511-CQ/26

Follow us on : /NWRailways NWRailways_

e-Tender Notice No. 29/2026-2027

Executive Engineer, Kolhapur Electrical Division Kolhapur, Tarabai Park, PWD Campus, Kolhapur, Invites Bids from Electrical Contractor in Whow Class Mentioned in B-1 (Percentage rate) Tender Format Bids Documents can be Downloaded From Website. Executive Engineer Reserve all Rights to Accept or reject Bids Conditional Bids will not be accepted.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Amount Put to Tender (with out GST)
1)	Est.No.112131 of 2026-27 Providing Electrical Installation, CCTV and Networking Audio Visuals and Fire Fighting in Poland Muscum Valivade Tal. Karveer Dist.Kolhapur.	₹ 1,79,12,401/-

TIME TABLE

Publish Bid Date	Dt. 21.10.2026 @10.00 AM
Tender Submission Period	Dt. 21.10.2026 @10.00 AM to Dt. 28.10.2026 @18.00 PM
Pre-bid Meeting place & Date, Time	Dt. 26.10.2026 @ 12.30 Office of The Superintending Engineer (Elect.), Pune Regional Electrical Circle, ShivKirti, Government Rest House g-2/3, & g-10, Ghopardi, Pune-411003 Email- elepune.se@mahapwd.gov.in, elkolhapur.ee@mahapwd.gov.in Phone No.020-25816010
Tender Opening	Dt.28.10.2026 @ 12:30 PM at Office of The Superintending Engineer (Elect.), Pune Regional Electrical Circle, ShivKirti, Government Rest House g-2/3,& g-10, Ghopardi, Pune - 411003 Email- elepune.se@mahapwd.gov.in, Phone No.020-25816010

The detailed tender notice will be available on **www.mahatenders.gov.in** (any changes in the NIT will be published on the above website

Sd/-
Sanjivani Dhananjay Katti
Executive Engineer,
Kolhapur Electrical Division Kolhapur

DGIPR/2026-2027/3316

#ETTech500

THE ECONOMIC TIMES | BUSINESS VERTICALS

TECH500

THE ENTERPRISE TECHNOLOGY LEADERSHIP SUMMIT

INDIA'S NEXT CHAPTER WILL BE BUILT INSIDE ITS ENTERPRISES.

500 of India's most influential technology decision-makers.
One room. One powerful conversation about what comes next.

THE ROOM WHERE INDIA'S NEXT MOVES BEGIN.

AI & Emerging Tech | Cloud & Infrastructure | Cybersecurity & Resilience | Data, Analytics & Intelligence | Digital Transformation | Enterprise Technology Leadership

500 LEADERS. | 1 ECOSYSTEM | ∞ COUNTLESS POSSIBILITIES.

27TH NOVEMBER 2026 I GRAND HYATT, MUMBAI

INVITE-ONLY

For Invitations: nikhar.aggarwal@timesinternet.in I 8588815395
For Partnerships: ashish.kumar3@timesinternet.in I 9740761921

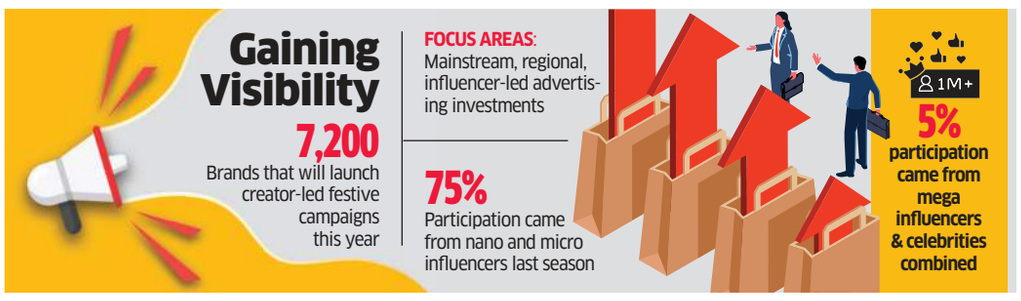
A TIMES INTERNET INITIATIVE

DESPITE COST PRESSURES AND REGULATORY CRACKDOWNS...

Brands Jazz Up Ad Show to Drive Growth

Momentum to remain strong this fiscal year as FMCG players focus on volumes, consumer trust

Ratna Bhushan



New Delhi: Multiple packaged goods makers increased advertising spends during July-September and said they will sustain the momentum through the next two quarters, despite input cost pressures, to drive volume growth, while food companies also seek to retain consumer trust amid regulatory crackdowns.

Maggi noodles and Nan infant formula maker Nestle India, which has received various notices from regulator Food Safety & Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) over misleading claims in recent months, increased its ad spends by 46% year-on-year in the September quarter—more than twice its revenue growth rate of 20.5% for the quarter.

"We continued to focus on efficiencies across our operations while significantly increasing investments behind our brands, with advertising and marketing spends up by 46%," Nestle India managing director Manish Tiwary said while announcing the September quarter earnings last week.

"Rising inflation, particularly food inflation, is a reality. We remain focused on navigating these external challenges through sustained investments behind brands," he added.

PepsiCo, Colgate, Parle and Dabur have also indicated to their agency partners that ad spending momentum will continue in the second and third quarters of the current financial year, media buying executives said. "While we are facing continuous pressure on profit margins, protecting consumer demand is crucial for us. Hence, we are scaling up ad spends," the chief of a large packaged goods maker said. He requested not to be named as the company is in a pre-earnings silent period.

Hindustan Unilever, ITC, Britannia and Coca-Cola are among the companies that have not yet declared their quarterly earnings. Marico said in its September quarter pre-earnings update that its advertising and promotion investments have "increased significantly." The Saffola edible oils maker is yet to announce its September quarter earnings. The increase cycles a 25% year-on-year step-up in ad spends in the April-June quarter. Bajaj Consumer Care too increased spends by 7.1% year-on-year in the September quarter.

"We have directions from two of our largest brands that advertising and communication should centre around 'safety and trust' over taste," a senior executive at a large media buying firm. "They are spending ahead of the curve in the current scenario." He requested not to be named, citing client sensitivity. The FSSAI, which has sent more than 150 notices to foods and beverages makers, ecommerce platforms and food services chains for either misleading claims or labelling violations, has itself triggered a surge in ad spends, as brands are looking to reinforce consumer trust.

The regulator has sent notices to Nestle, ITC, PepsiCo, Mondelez, Red Bull, Zepto and Swiggy, among others.

India's retail food inflation shot up to 7.74% in September as prices of vegetables, staples, edible oils and sugar increased. Other key inflationary triggers include costs of packaging and transportation. The increase in advertising and marketing spends is a mix of mainstream and regional advertising, and influencer-led social media spends, executives said.

Festive spending on influencer-based advertising and marketing alone is estimated to touch ₹900 crore in 2026, 29% higher over the previous year, according to a report by creator intelligence platform Qoruz. The report noted that 7,200 brands will release creator-based festive campaigns in the year, versus 6,000 last year.

SUITS & SAYINGS

ET's roundup of the wackiest whispers in corporate corridors

Show Stopper

The who's who of fashion played real-life musical chairs when an awards gala and designer showcase unfolded in neighbouring ballrooms of the very same venue. Half the A-list spent the evening shuttling between the two, but the other half stayed put – much to the chagrin of editors and PR staff, who easily noted who skipped one event for the other. One yesteryear star was reluctantly nudged into attending both, once she realised the traffic excuse wouldn't hold up. Apparently, the frazzled 70-something diva needed a pep talk to take to the ramp. Except that for someone with her formidable acting chops, the catwalk is a cakewalk.

Factory Fix

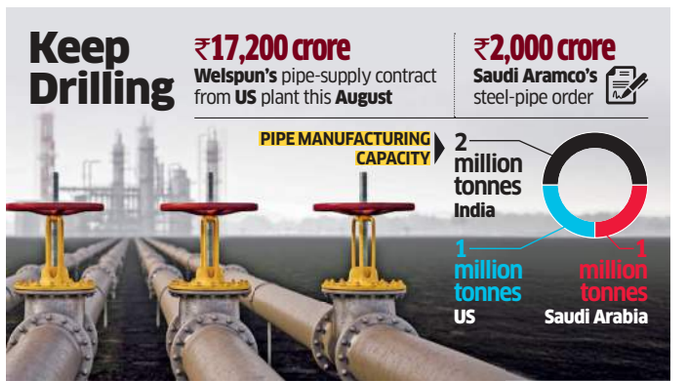
A gleaming new factory coming up may be grabbing the headlines, but the real action at this auto major could be unfolding elsewhere. A shortage of local labour is reportedly threatening to slow the production ramp-up, even as inventory pressures build. Enter an unlikely Plan B: a mothballed facility belonging to an overseas player. An initial survey is said to be complete, with ready infrastructure, available labour and port access making for an attractive proposition. Could the answer to an ambitious greenfield venture lie in someone else's abandoned plans? Skeptics, however, point to the facility's less-than-happy history with previous suitors. Will this courtship fare any better? Watch this space.

Privy to the whispers in power corridors or juicy tips on India Inc? Do share with us at **etsuits.sayings@timesofindia.com**

Welspun Expects US Bet to Pay Off Amid Surging Demand for Oil & Gas Pipelines

Order book in the US gives visibility for three years, co eyes up to 35% market share, says exec

Kalpana Pathak & Nikita Periwal



Mumbai: Welspun Corp, a flagship line pipe manufacturer in the $10-billion Welspun Group, is focusing on the US where it has invested $300-350 million in two plants to capitalise on the rising demand for oil and gas pipelines in the region amid soaring energy expenses.

The company, which already has a significant presence in India and Saudi Arabia, expects its US manufacturing operations to benefit from increased drilling activity, higher global oil and gas consumption and investments in pipeline infrastructure, managing director and chief executive officer Vipul Mathur told **ET**.

The US is stepping up both refining and drilling capacity amid a surge in energy costs, with crude oil prices climbing nearly 70% in a year after the Iran war began in February. "We saw that the global supply chain was getting disrupted, and we felt it would be a good idea to invest in the US and be ready when the opportunity arises," Mathur said. Welspun's order book in the US provides visibility for nearly three years, Mathur said, strengthening confidence in a business which usually operates with a visibility of 4-6 quarters.

As one of the largest in the world, Welspun Corp has a global pipe manufacturing capacity of around 3.5-4 million for line pipes and ductile iron pipes. Of this, 2 million tonnes of capacity is in India, and around 1 million tonnes in the US and Saudi Arabia each. Of its two plants in the US, one has been commissioned, while the other will be commissioned by the end of this year.

The company estimates a 30-35% market share in the US oil and gas pipe market, with increased drilling, higher energy consumption, and supply disruptions involving several traditional oil and gas suppliers expected to boost demand.

The US administration's emphasis on domestic oil and gas production, alongside efforts to facilitate infrastructure development and provide faster right-of-way approvals, has further supported the outlook, he said.

In another key market, Saudi Arabia, Welspun has invested around $100-150 million on an oil and gas pipe manufacturing facility. Welspun has a presence in the region through East Pipes, which was formerly known as Welspun Middle East.

Mathur expects Saudi Arabia's infra spending under Vision 2030 to generate substantial demand for pipes, particularly as the country looks to diversify its oil evacuation routes and strengthen energy infrastructure. The company is exploring opportunities arising from reconstruction activity in West Asia and has announced plans to establish an entity in Jordan, with a proposed manufacturing facility to cater to regional demand.

In bid to expand into other revenue sources, Welspun Corp intends to focus on specialised, value-added pipes rather than standard pipes. "We don't want to be a commodity player. We are interested in niche, value-added segment," Mathur said.

Over the last year, shares of Welspun Corp have risen from a low of ₹710 to an all-time high of ₹2,900, an over four-fold jump in the stock price. Its consolidated profit for the June quarter surged three-fold year-on-year to ₹1,048 crore. The company has guided for a revenue of ₹20,000 crore and Ebitda (earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortization) of ₹2,850 crore in the current fiscal. This compares to a revenue of ₹16,770 crore and Ebitda of ₹2,371 crore in FY26.

TO DRIVE MONETISATION...

New OTT Players Eye Niche Audiences, CTV Growth as Competition Intensifies

Javed Farooqui

Mumbai: India's crowded over-the-top (OTT) market continues to attract new entrants, with platforms betting on the growth of connected TV (CTV) and differentiated content, though monetisation remains a challenge amid low average revenue per user (ARPU) and intensifying competition.

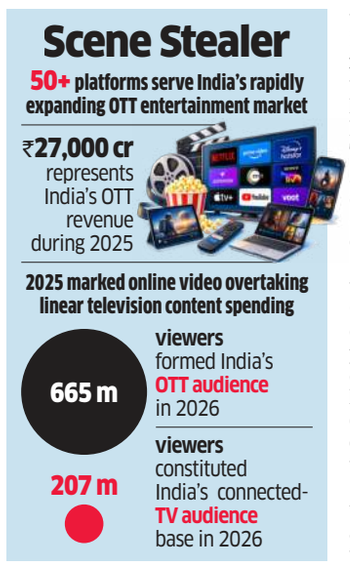
The latest entrants include Tiger TV, launched by Lionsgate Play founder Rohit Jain, targeting Hindi and Punjabi-speaking audiences, and Brew TV, founded by filmmaker Ankur Singla, which aims to help independent filmmakers distribute their work. Regional platforms AVR Cine-Max and Vihari OTT are also targeting specialised audiences through Kannada cinema and Telugu travel and cultural content, respectively.

The launches come as broadcasters, streaming platforms, social media services and microdrama apps compete for viewers' attention and spending amid increasing fragmentation in content formats and distribution.

India's OTT audience stood at 665 million in 2026, while its CTV base reached 207 million, according to Ormax Media. The OTT market generated more than ₹27,000 crore in revenue in 2025, according to FICCI-EY estimates. Media Partners Asia estimated India's online video spending at $5 billion in 2025, with online video accounting for 46% of total content spending, overtaking traditional television's 42% share for the first time.

However, audience scale does not necessarily translate into paying subscribers or sustainable revenues.

Jain said Tiger TV is targeting 10 million subscribers and ₹500 crore in annual recurring revenue (ARR) in three years. The platform has launched across 12 markets, including India, the US, the UK, Canada, New Zealand and Australia, with subscriptions priced at ₹799/year in India and 5.99 in local currency in international markets. "The beauty of a market of our size is that there is a market for everyone who is focused and clear about what they are trying to build," Jain said. Brew TV is focused on independent feature films, shorts and other formats. "After experience of releasing Ghich Pich in theatres, I realised how broken film distribution is. So, Brew TV's mission is to help filmmakers globally to distribute their films, shows, shorts, vertical cinema," Singla, founder and chief executive of Brew TV, said in a LinkedIn post.



An industry analyst, who requested anonymity, said the growth of CTV and the opportunity to tap niche audiences were attracting new players. "Internationally, a lot of niche apps are launching but the ARPUs in those markets are good. In India, the ARPU is a big challenge even though the market has scale," the analyst said.

India's OTT market has over 50 players, including JioHotstar, Netflix and Prime Video. For new entrants, the challenge will be to convert audience reach into recurring revenue in a market where differentiated content and a large potential audience may not, by themselves, guarantee profitability.

Pepsi Bets on New Products to Maintain Sales Momentum

PTI

New Delhi: PepsiCo India expects its food business to match last year's festive growth momentum driven by new product rollouts and convenience-focused choices that match modern consumer habits, a top company official said on Tuesday.

The company is expanding its portfolio across snacks, 'better-for-you' products and premium offerings to cater to diverse consumer preferences during the festive season, said Sakshi Verma Menon, chief marketing officer, Foods at PepsiCo India.

Co recently strengthened ready-to-eat offerings on ecommerce platforms to make festive snacking convenient

"We expect PepsiCo Foods to deliver a growth trajectory similar to last year during the festive season, growing in line with the industry," Menon told PTI.

The company has recently strengthened its ready-to-eat offerings on ecommerce platforms to make festive snacking more convenient.

Hotel rates expected to rise more than 25% as holiday bookings see a big surge: Industry execs

Festive Travel Shows No Signs of Slowing Despite High Airfares

Anumeha Chaturvedi

New Delhi: Despite a spike in airfares, travel bookings are on an upswing for the festive season with travel companies, hotels, alternative accommodation players, and vacation ownership companies reporting a substantial uptick in bookings.

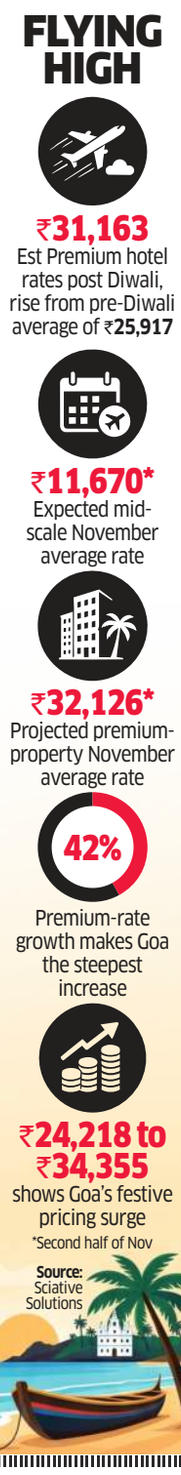
As per an analysis of 3,114 properties across 13 Indian destinations conducted by AI powered pricing and revenue management firm Sciative Solutions shared with ET, average mid-scale hotel rates are likely to rise 26.94% above the pre-Diwali period between November 11-15. Premium rates could follow a similar pattern, rising from a pre-festive average of ₹25,917 to ₹31,163 during post-Diwali weekend.

Sciative Solutions estimates rates are likely to remain elevated through the second half of November, with mid-scale accommodations averaging ₹11,670 and premium properties averaging approximately ₹32,126.

Vijeta Soni, co-founder and CEO of Sciative Solutions, said the data points to growing demand for festive breaks across destinations such as Goa, Ooty and Mahabaleshwar, and the strongest rate pressure is likely to emerge after Diwali. Goa is likely to see steepest upward price trajectory, with premium rates climbing nearly 42% from ₹24,218 in the pre-Diwali period (October 25-31) to ₹34,355 between November 16-30.

Sterling Holiday Resorts is seeing a 24% year-on-year uptick in festive season demand. Chief marketing officer Anupam Dutta said drive-to holidays are gaining popularity, and improved highway connectivity is reshaping leisure breaks in India.

"We see this opportunity across regional circuits such as Ooty-Wayanad, Coorg-Sakleshpur and Kasauli-Chail-Kufri as well as wildlife destinations such as Pench, Tadoba, Jawai and Gir," he said.



Pickyourtrail is seeing an 80-90% year-on-year uptick in international bookings, with Dussehra long weekend bookings rising 30-32% year-on-year. Maldives, Thailand, Vietnam, Singapore and Sri Lanka remain popular festive destinations for the company. Bookings across travel categories are growing 3-4x between October-December for travel fintech platform Scapia. Rathinamurthy R, head of travel at the company, said smaller beach towns, and wildlife destinations are growing rapidly in demand. Beach and hill station bookings for the Dussehra week were up 3.5x year on year for Scapia.

Ixigo started seeing an uptick in its trains business in quarter two itself as train bookings start two months prior for Dussehra and Diwali, said group CEO Aloke Bajpai. Bajpai said while he remains cautious on the flights business, as supply hasn't reached pre-conflict levels in West Asia, he is very optimistic about how the festive season will play out for hotels.

"We are seeing an uptick on long weekends, and we hope to continue seeing that as we head into Diwali, Christmas, and the New Year winter vacation period. Near-term momentum looks best for buses and hotels," he added.

Hindustan National Glass Lines Up ₹500-crore Expansion Plan

PTI

New Delhi: Hindusthan National Glass & Industries (HNGIL), now part of the Africa-based Madhvani-Turner Group, is planning to invest ₹300-500 crore over next five months to ramp up manufacturing capacity by the end of this fiscal year.

HNGIL, which was acquired by Independent Sugar Corporation through the insolvency resolution process under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) for ₹2,250 crore in September 2025, has invested around ₹700 crore in the business since the change in ownership.

"Another ₹300-500 crore will be invested during the remaining part of the current financial year, which will be for capacity expansion and meeting operational expenses," HNGIL chief strategy officer Suraj Mehta told PTI. The Mumbai-based container glassmaker, had received several orders during its Corporate Insolvency Resolution Period (CIRP), which are being delivered in the current financial year.

Following the change in management after the CIRP, HNGIL has already "turned around" its business and expects to return to profitability from the current quarter, with profits beginning to reflect in its financial performance.

"Our topline growth is directly linked to the capacity expansion, and that remains our primary focus. We expect the benefits to start reflecting in our profitability from this quarter onwards, with this quarter's numbers likely to be quite strong," Mehta said.

Since the change in ownership, HNGIL has added 1,100-1,200 tonnes per day of manufacturing capacity, he added. Last week, the company fired the second furnace at Bahadurgarh in Haryana, doubling the capacity of the unit from 300 to 600 tonnes a day.

Following management change, co has 'turned around' its biz and expects to return to profitability from the current qtr

With this, the operational capacity of the company has increased to somewhere around 2,500-2,600 tonnes per day against an installed capacity of 4,300.

"When we bid for this company in 2022, the operational capacity was 2,600 tonnes a day. By the time we took over, it had come down to 1,100 or 1,200. We had to rework all our numbers. This one year has been about getting that capacity back," he said. Rebuilding capacity has been capital intensive, and fuel and gas, which make up 20 to 25% of costs, are revised every fortnight and cannot be passed on in full, he said.

Movies, Big and Small, Keep Indian Box Office in High Spirits

REVIVAL OF RANGE Rising footfalls, which touched 378 m during Jan-June, and Hollywood hits add to stellar collections this year so far: Experts

Rajesh N Naidu

Mumbai: The performance of Indian films so far in 2026 provides hope of a sustained revival in the industry.

Box-office collections and footfalls at movie theatres have both posted healthy growth, according to a study by media and entertainment research firm Ormax Media. More importantly, according to film industry experts, movies across sizes, languages and genres have done well, in what a trade analyst termed as "revival of range".

CUMULATIVE COLLECTION

Footfalls at movie theatres increased 5% from a year earlier to 378 million between January and June this year, show Ormax Media data. Footfalls in the last three years had either fallen or stayed flat.

Cumulative box-office collection in the nine months ended September grew 17% to ₹11,000 crore from ₹9,409 crore a year earlier. The year is also about the returns that films across languages generated relative to their budgets, said producer Anand Pandit. "Audiences have increasingly accepted stories which feel authentic," he added.

Malayalam film Bethlehem Kudumba Unit, made on a budget of ₹25 crore, collected ₹192 crore in India alone. Films across sizes and genres have shown similar success. These include Hanuman Ansh (small-budget, devotional), Awarapan 2 (mid-budget, romance), Mirzapur (OTT, mid-budget), DC (mid-budget, slick action), Irumudi (mid-budget, devotional), Premada Oorali (small-budget, family drama) and Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge (big-budget, franchise value). Changing audience preferences and tastes are the key reasons behind these successes, said producers.

"Theatrical audience is coming in for newer experiences and rejecting 'sameness'," said producer Sunir Khetrpal. "Audiences are gradually but definitely becoming agnostic about genres, language or star status."

Increasingly, regional makers have been focusing on their home territories first. After resonating with their audiences in home states, these films travel to other territories through word-of-mouth recommendations and social media discussions.

EMOTIONAL CONNECT

These films have demonstrated that theatrical success is more about emotional connection with stories, said producer and film business expert Girish Johar. "Emotional connection with stories is a common aspect in most theatrical successes across languages in 2026," he said.

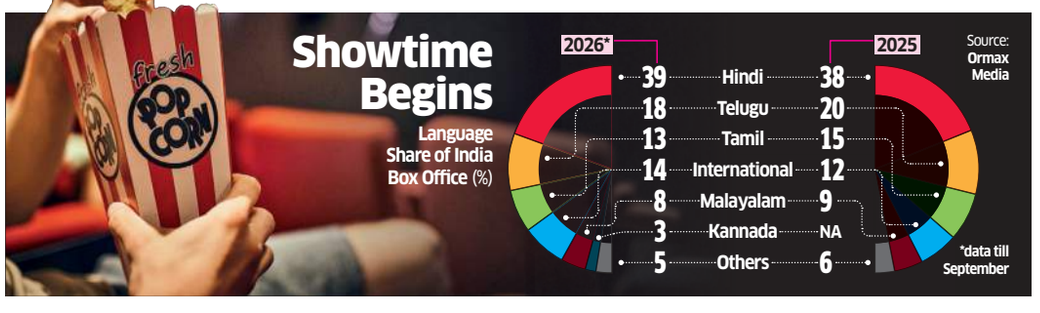
A similar story has played out in the India box office performance of Hollywood films as well. Films across scales and genres such as Obsession, Michael and The Odyssey have succeeded in India.

"Social media platforms, especially Instagram, YouTube, shorts and forums such as Reddit, are increasingly building audiences for Hollywood films in India," said Shaaminder Malik, a distributor and film business expert.

HOLLYWOOD HIGH

In the remaining period of 2026, Hollywood films such as Avengers: Doomsday and Dune: Part Three, and Hindi films such as The Ramayana and King are expected to boost collection further, said film trade analysts.

They expect Hollywood's contribution to India's box office likely to grow to 20-21% from the historical average of 15%.



BRAND EQUITY
THE ECONOMIC TIMES OCTOBER 21-27, 2026

CoverStory

THE MIDDLE KINGDOM

Between the brand and the creator, a growing cast of middlemen is making campaign costs and results harder to pin down

IMAGE: AI GENERATED

By **Pratishtha Bagai and Vidya Sathyapriyan**

In a police complaint filed in Mumbai in July, gaming creator **Kaashvi Lalit Hiranandani**, known as Kaash Plays, alleged that her former manager accepted ₹34 lakh from Samsung for a campaign she created content for, but told her the deal was worth ₹25 lakh. Under her agreement with the agency, she says, she was entitled to 70% of the deal value. So, she received only ₹17.5 lakh.

If her account is accurate, nearly half the sum paid by the brand was lost in the middle. Samsung India and its agency partner Cheil India did not respond to *Brand Equity's* queries. While the manager has publicly described the allegations as "false and misleading", he declined to comment for this article.

The episode points to a wider issue in influencer marketing: As campaigns scale, money and briefs pass through a maze of agencies, managers, and vendors, making it harder for brands to track costs, hold partners accountable and measure returns, while creators can be left waiting for their dues.

This wasn't part of the script. For years, influencer marketing promised brands a way around traditional media gatekeepers – reaching audiences through people they trusted. But as campaigns have expanded from a handful of influencers to thousands of creators, the new layers of gatekeeping that emerged may be turning into roadblocks, which obscures both the money and the message.

The Chain of Uncertainty

"If a brand invests ₹100 for a creator campaign, the creator may receive only ₹40, while ₹60 goes into facilitation and agency margins," says **Nitin Joshi,** co-founder of Open Grey, an influencer marketing operating system for brands and creators. This is the imbalance that is now becoming an issue.

The money can travel through a long chain – brand, media agency, influencer agency, talent manager, production partner and, finally, creator. Each additional layer potentially increases opacity in terms of pricing, payment, and accountability. Joshi estimates that agency margins in some campaigns can reach 60–70%, or occasionally more.

The consequences can extend beyond the campaign budget.

D2C ice cream brand Go Zero's founder **Kiran Shah**, who shut down influencer marketing after failing to see measurable returns, recalls blacklisting an agency after a creator reported unpaid dues months after the brand had cleared payment.

"I had paid the agency in good faith," he says, highlighting the reputational risk. "If the creator had chosen to run a negative reel against the brand, whatever goodwill the original campaign generated could have been undone by that one reel." It also affects the output quality and in turn the ROI, he agrees.

Continued on Page 2 >>

Kaashvi Lalit Hiranandani

Nitin Joshi

BEInterview Amit Agarwal, CMO, Croma

"It's a Myth that Products are Always Cheaper Online"

By **Anjana Naskar**

*The consumer electronics market is seeing a shift in how people discover, compare, and buy products. **Amit Agarwal**, CMO, Infiniti Retail, Croma, says physical retail continues to have a strong role, even as digital becomes an important part of the purchase journey: "The opportunity is not to choose between online and offline, but to make both work together for the consumer"*

India's consumer durables market is growing, and online retail accounts for a significant sales. How do you see the role of physical retail changing for Croma in the next few years?

Physical retail remains very strong, with around 70% of electronics sales still coming from offline channels. Modern retail is also growing well, even as online expands. Online plays a major role not just in purchases but also in discovery; around 70% of our customers have searched for our products online before visiting a Croma store, and 50% have visited our website. That is why we are building a truly omnichannel journey, being present wherever the customer wants to shop, and integrating the online and offline experiences so there is no difference in pricing or service.

Where does Croma see the biggest opportunity?

We see opportunity across both ends and are building an omnichannel approach without distinguishing between online and offline. At the same time, we are strengthening our e-commerce and quick-commerce presence, including our partnership with BigBasket, so customers can access Croma across the growing ecosystem.

Continued on Page 2 >>

Gear Up

Two-wheeler makers are investing more than ever in their accessories business

By **Lijee Philip**

When Ather Energy launched its latest scooter, the Konarc, accessories had already been factored into the product design. The adjustable backrest, for instance, was conceived to double as an armrest for women riding side-saddle in saris, while offering a greater sense of security.

Two-wheeler makers like Ather are increasingly viewing accessories not as an afterthought, but as extensions of the core ownership experience and a test of their brands allure and elasticity.

"The design language, materials, fit, and finish, colours are conceptualised when we are conceptualising the product itself," says **Ravneet S Phokela,** chief business officer, Ather Energy.

Accessories are not new to two-wheelers: Harley-Davidson was the OG and Royal Enfield brought the buzz to India ages ago. But now other manufacturers want in. From TVS Motor and Bajaj Auto to Ather, everyone wants to build relationships beyond the sale through riding gear, apparel, accessories and merchandise.

A Matter of Pull

For manufacturers, the opportunity extends beyond functional needs of protection, comfort, and storage and into apparel and merchandise, which allow customers to express their affinity for a brand even when they are not riding.

Ravi Bhatia, president, Jato Dynamics, identifies three businesses within this market: Vehicle accessories, riding gear, and lifestyle merchandise. Each serves different needs and has different purchase patterns and economics.

"Treating them as one category can exaggerate the market opportunity and obscure what customers actually value," he says.

Apparel and collectibles can also attract people who admire a brand but do not yet own its motorcycle. Royal Enfield's experience illustrates this pull. Their lifestyle portfolio, with apparel and accessories, has been delivering over 30% CAGR in the last five years, with more than 20% of apparel customers not owning an Enfield motorcycle.

As **Yadvinder Singh Guleria,** chief commercial officer, Royal Enfield, says, this business is an extension of "the culture we share with riders".

Extending It

The opportunity takes different forms across manufacturers.

Ather's Halo smart helmet pairs with the rider's phone and scooter, allowing calls to be managed through the handlebar. It is a way to make accessories part of the product's tech proposition itself.

Bajaj Auto's portfolio spans KTM's performance-oriented PowerWear and PowerParts, Triumph's personalisation-led accessories and apparel, and Chetak's practical additions for everyday mobility.

Chetak accessories include storage solutions, visors, crash guards, mobile holders, and seat covers, alongside TecPacs that add technology features.

Sumeet Narang, president, marketing, Bajaj Auto includes rides and community management at KTM and Triumph as core part of the biz. Customers get access not just to motorcycles but also to riding communities, specialised training academies, and organised rides.

TVS follows a similar approach. Apache riders gravitate towards motorsport-inspired gear and performance-led experiences, while Ronin's accessories and merch cater to lifestyle and self-expression.

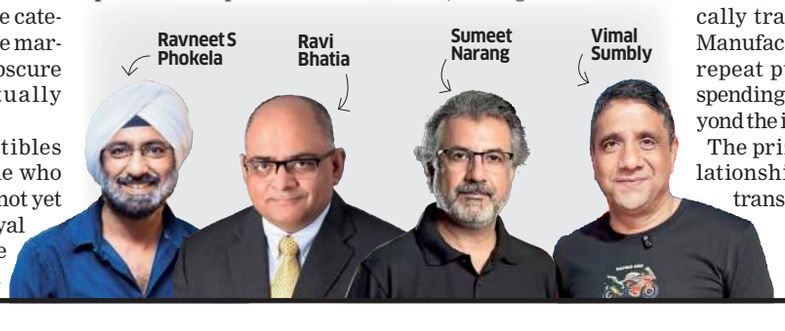
Brands want a relationship beyond the sale; merch attracts people who admire a brand but don't own it yet. So it's a win-win

"These offerings help us deepen rider engagement and build lasting connection with our brands," says **Vimal Sumbly,** head, business – premium, TVS Motor. Technical partnerships, such as its Alpinestars collection, can bring specialist expertise, while products must suit Indian weather, riding conditions, and budgets.

Bhatia cautions branded merch does not automatically translate into loyalty. Manufacturers need to track repeat purchase, customer spending, and engagement beyond the initial sale.

The prize, after all, is a relationship that outlasts the transaction.

lijee.philip
@timesofindia.com



SPOTLIGHT

Rewriting the rules of modern marketing in an AI-driven world

Gerri Tunnell, CMO, Dell Technologies, on how AI agents are reshaping B2B buying, why brands must out-system rather than out-campaign, and how to stay relevant when machines make recommendations

1 What makes the shift to AI agents fundamentally different?

Buying journeys have always evolved, but this shift is fundamentally different because there's a new customer to win. Increasingly, the customer researching, evaluating and shortlisting your company isn't a person; it's an AI agent.

We are already seeing incredible growth in AI-sourced traffic, and this isn't just a consumer phenomenon. It's beginning to reshape B2B buying as well. What makes this unique is that it's not simply a new channel. It's a handoff of entire stages of the journey. A buyer can ask an AI agent to find the best laptop for AI workloads, and that agent can handle the research, benchmarking, comparisons, pricing and even the purchase. And it all happens at machine speed. Decisions that once took weeks of human research can now happen in seconds. That means companies need to be discoverable and trustworthy on AI's timeline. For enterprises, the old playbook of winning at the point of human contact is no longer enough. You have to earn visibility and trust before anyone enters the process.

2 When an AI agent researches on behalf of a buyer, does it find you, trust you, recommend you? For a company at Dell's scale, what does earning that recommendation take?

It starts with the fundamentals: products, brand and customer experience. But in an AI-driven buying environment, those fundamentals also need to be optimised for large language models. That means machine-readable data, clear signals and making sure you are present in the prompts and conversations where decisions are being shaped.

First, you have to be findable. AI can only recommend what it understands, so treat structured, accurate information as core infrastructure, not an afterthought.

Beyond that, recommendation is earned through trust. LLMs synthesise signals from reviews, analyst reports, benchmarks, community conversations and customer experiences. There are no shortcuts. The same signals that earn the trust of AI are ultimately the signals that earn the trust of a customer. At Dell's scale, that means delivering consistency across thousands of products, messages and customer touchpoints.

3 You have identified three priorities: findability, trust and speed. Where are companies falling short, and where has Dell had to work hardest?

Many companies are still approaching this as a marketing or content challenge, when in reality it's an infrastructure challenge. Majority of organisations haven't yet made their product information truly machine-readable at scale. At Dell, we have focused heavily on increasing the speed of the system. Traditional plan-launch-measure cycles simply aren't built for a world where AI agents can change recommendations in real time. We have rebuilt how we operate for continuous adjustment instead of campaign cycles. That shift allows us to show up accurately for an agent's query today rather than analysing results weeks later and reacting after the fact.

4 Dell builds the infrastructure that powers AI and sells to customers whose buying behaviour AI is reshaping. How does sitting on both sides of that equation change how you lead marketing?

It means we are living through the same transformation we are helping our customers navigate. We can't credibly advise customers on agentic buying if we aren't solving for our own findability, trust signals and customer experience first.

It gives us a unique perspective. We are helping customers build their AI strategies while evolving our own go-to-market approach for an AI-driven buying environment. That creates a powerful learning loop that helps us move faster and make smarter decisions.

5 You have said winners won't out-campaign the competition; they'll out-system it. What does that look like in practice at Dell?

At Dell, that means recognising that marketing needs more engineering talent than ever before. Practically, it's about investing in the infrastructure behind the experience: structured data, consistent trust signals and faster feedback loops. The goal is to make sure we are always present and relevant when an agent is making a recommendation, not just visible during a campaign window.

6 As AI handles more of the buying journey, how do you keep the human experience at the centre?

I don't think this is a question of humans versus machines. It's about how they work together. Our partnership with McLaren is a great example. The technology in the car and the garage is incredibly sophisticated, but great technology alone doesn't win races. You still need talented drivers and strategists making decisions in real time.

The same is true in business. When done well, AI and human expertise reinforce one another. The result is a more consistent, trustworthy experience whether an agent is researching a product specification or a customer is speaking directly with a sales rep.

GERRI TUNNELL
CMO, Dell Technologies

"The window of opportunity is open right now, but it won't stay open forever. And that's exactly where Dell is leaning in. We are not waiting for this future to arrive, we are building it

GlobeTrotting

Consumer Apprehension Grows as Retailers Adopt AI-assisted Pricing Tools

US consumers aren't just frustrated with high prices. They're angry and confused about the increasingly high-tech ways restaurant chains and major retailers are setting those prices.

Digital price tags are rapidly replacing paper ones in grocery aisles. AI tools help businesses decide what to charge by predicting how customers might respond. Terms like "dynamic pricing" and "surveillance pricing" are stirring anxiety on social media, where users wonder if people are getting different prices for the same product.

Companies using the tech say concerns stem from misconceptions about how their pricing tools work. Walmart CEO John Furner said digital price tags save workers' time and keep prices up to date. He said the labels aren't used to raise prices based on the weather, time of day, or individual shopper.

But companies aren't always transparent about the customer data they collect and how it's used, which has led to speculation. **–AP**

KFC Switches Up to Coke

KFC's decision to switch from Pepsi sodas to Coca-Cola at its US restaurants could raise questions about PepsiCo's other longstanding food service partnerships.

The loss of KFC comes as PepsiCo grapples with sluggish demand and higher costs in North America, where a recovery in growth is taking longer than expected and has prompted it to deepen cost cuts.

Analysts estimate the loss of the KFC account represents about $500 million in annual sales, or a roughly 3% hit to Pepsi's North America sales, while boosting Coca-Cola's North America sales by about 2.5%.

Brokerage Jefferies says the bigger concern for PepsiCo is the "loss of brand interaction and public perception" rather than the immediate financial impact. "A longstanding Pepsi customer switching raises questions whether other accounts that have been historically off-limits are now up for grabs," Jefferies analysts said. **–Reuters**

Netflix Names Ex Disney Exec as Content Chief

Netflix appointed former Disney executive Peter Rice as chief content officer, succeeding Bela Bajaria, who is leaving after nearly a decade at the streaming platform.

Rice will oversee Netflix's content strategy from October 26, including series, films, and live events across regions. He served as chairman of Walt Disney Television and chairman of general entertainment at The Walt Disney Company.

Bajaria joined Netflix in 2016 and became chief content officer in 2023. Under her, Netflix released hits such as *Bridgerton* and *Squid Game* and expanded live programming.

The announcement came a day after Netflix told staff in an internal memo it was laying off 6% of its workforce, roughly 1,000 employees, marking its biggest job cuts since 2022. **–Reuters**

BE/DOPE

Neel Gogia, *co-founder, IPLIX Media*

The Business Beyond the Buzz

Reach is only the beginning when it comes to building brands

IMAGE: AI GENERATED

Working in the creator economy gives you a particular view of how businesses grow. You see how the right person can introduce a product to an audience, how a recommendation can influence purchasing decisions, and how brands use cultural relevance to get noticed.

But when you move from helping brands reach consumers to building a consumer business yourself, the questions change. It is no longer just about how many people a creator can reach, but what they can build, who they should build it with, and how they can create value beyond their existing audience.

Here are six things to consider when building creator-led businesses.

1. Start with a problem, not just an audience

The first step is to understand what has resonated most with a creator's audience and identify the right product-audience fit. Equally important is evaluating whether there is a genuine market need for that product. Is the problem limited to the creator's existing audience, or is it a larger, pan-India problem that the business can address?

Any product, business, or brand needs to solve a problem that exists at scale rather than cater to a niche audience alone. A creator may have a highly engaged following, but that does not automatically translate into demand. If a business depends entirely on the creator's existing audience, it may struggle to grow into a large, sustainable venture.

Founders and creators should play to their skills and work together to create businesses of lasting value

2. Find the right partners

Creators should recognise that their expertise has its limits. They need to understand their strengths and identify partners who have prior experience, the capability to build businesses, and the expertise to take an idea from concept to execution.

Rather than trying to figure everything out on their own, creators should approach the right partners and demonstrate why a partnership would make sense. Together, they can evaluate the market opportunity, identify the right category, and determine which business to build. Creators bring their understanding of their audiences, while experienced partners can help identify the right category and build a business with long-term potential.

3. Look beyond the usual creator partnerships

There are many founders and business operators with great ideas who may not necessarily understand marketing. Even on *Shark Tank*, we see businesses with promising products that could benefit from the right marketing and distribution strategy.

Creators should explore opportunities to connect with such founders and pitch the idea of building a new brand together. The operator can help determine which category and business would best fit the creator, based on their audience, market potential and the opportunity to build a sustainable business.

This creates an opportunity for founders to bring their business expertise to the table while creators contribute their understanding of consumers, content, and marketing.

4. Divide responsibilities according to strengths

A successful partnership requires clarity on what each person brings to the business. The creator should take ownership of the brand's marketing, going beyond simply leveraging their existing audience and distribution. The founder or operator should focus on ensuring that business operations, product development, and overall execution are handled effectively. The focus should be on bringing together complementary strengths.

5. Become the brand's chief content officer

A creator's role should go beyond selling a product to their existing audience. The next question should be: how can they help the brand reach consumers beyond their own audience base?

Creators should take ownership of the brand's content strategy, essentially becoming its chief content officer. Their immediate advantage is that they can generate excitement and drive a strong launch through their existing reach and influence.

However, their long-term value lies in helping the brand grow beyond that initial audience by leading the content game across social media, performance marketing, and other relevant platforms.

There is long-term value in creators championing their own brands and becoming CCOs

6. Bring years of learning to the business

An important aspect of a creator's contribution can be missed when the focus is only on launch reach. This is exactly what we have seen with LAYERS and SARKAR.

With LAYERS, Shlok Srivastava aka TechBurner's contribution goes well beyond launching a product. He brings in SOPs and learnings around performance marketing, social media content, community events and community engagement. Having built a community of 15 million followers over 10 years, he understands how to engage with an audience. And at the end of the day, customers are an audience too. This understanding creates significant value for the brand.

Similarly, with SARKAR, Bhuvan Bam provided a strong launchpad for the brand. But his value goes beyond that initial reach. His understanding of how to communicate with an audience, create effective social media content, and work with influencers is extremely valuable to the business. The kind of understanding these creators have developed is something very few people in the country possess. They have built their own distribution over the years, gaining invaluable insights into platforms, customers, and audience behaviour. That is the real value creators bring to a business.

(Views expressed are personal.)

In BE Dope, experts unpack big questions shaping the creator economy.

Continued from Page 1 >>

"It's a Myth that Products are Always Cheaper Online"

With consumers comparing prices online and offline, how do you compete when the same product is cheaper online?

It's a myth that products are always cheaper online. At Croma, brand offers, bank offers, and retail promotions often make offline prices equally competitive, and sometimes even more so. We also maintain price parity between our online and offline channels so customers don't feel a difference. Overall, our offline pricing remains very competitive.

Brands such as Haier have been rapidly gaining share in categories traditionally dominated by LG, Samsung, and others. What does this tell you about consumer preferences and brand loyalty in consumer electronics?

Customers are becoming more aware and savvy, with easy access to information leading to more research before purchases. They are increasingly looking for technology-first, feature-rich products that offer value, creating opportunities for brands that meet these needs. Haier is capitalising on this trend, and we have seen its growth across some of our channels.

Our own private label has also performed well in categories where we have been able to meet these customer needs. Overall, brands that deliver on technology, features and value are gaining market share.

Why haven't we seen any ads for Croma's private label?

It's not something we're ruling out for the future, is all I can say.

Do you see AI becoming a genuine reason for consumers to upgrade, or is it still largely a premium feature being sold by manufacturers?

Consumers are not necessarily looking for AI devices, but for the benefits AI provides. Devices are moving from being simply smart or connected to becoming more intelligent. For instance, TVs can personalise recommendations and adjust picture and sound, while refrigerators and ACs can adapt to usage and occupancy. AI is also helping address pain points such as servicing and energy efficiency. Overall, AI-enabled devices are gaining preference, first at the premium end and now across the market.

Consumers are not looking for AI devices, but for the benefits AI provides

What has omnichannel changed for the business in real terms?

The Tata Digital ecosystem has had a tremendous impact on our business and customer journey. We are also enabling online purchases with offline pickup. These initiatives are helping strengthen the overall customer experience.

In a category where consumers can easily compare prices, products and offers, what makes them choose one retailer over another?

Most retail communication revolves around discounts and offers, which remain important because customers want the right value. But long-term relevance also comes from trust, experience and emotional connect. So our strategy is to stay competitive on price while building a stronger emotional connection with customers. That was the genesis of our recent campaign 'Ghar Banta Hai Croma Se'. The insight was that homes are built through everyday moments, many of which happen around devices that customers trust Croma to purchase. Hence the thought: ghar banta hai kuch chhote-chhote moments se. It is a full 360-degree campaign led by digital films and a strong social story. We have partnered with celebrity chefs to create content around Croma appliances and are also doing below-the-line activations across stores.

anjana.naskar@timesofindia.com

Continued from Page 1 >>

The Middle Kingdom

The Fragmentation Problem

As influencer marketing scales in India, the fragmented creator ecosystem compounds the problem. The sheer scale makes it harder to track who represents whom, track payments, and establish accountability.

Anirudh Sridharan, co-founder of creator-brand network Hashfame describes instances in which people allegedly present themselves as creators' representatives to extract commissions. "Impostors claiming to represent creators can inflate, say, a ₹10 lakh fee to ₹15 lakh. Brands may pay the 50% premium or drop the creator over the inflated quote, costing them a campaign and future deals without their knowledge."

Campaigns that once involved around 25 creators can now encompass 1,000 or even 5,000, while parts of the business still run on spreadsheets, email and WhatsApp, says **Shekhar Banerjee**, president of client solutions, WPP Media South Asia. "The complexity rises when a creator works with multiple small agencies simultaneously. They may, in turn, subcontract to other intermediaries," says Banerjee.

The resulting opacity, he adds, affects pricing and audit compliance.

Go Zero's Shah says a primary agency might charge 10–15% of a campaign budget, but additional intermediaries make it harder to establish how much ultimately reaches the creator. The challenge is that brands often cannot tell whether the intermediaries bring in additional value or simply add another layer of cost.

Without a clear breakdown, advertisers cannot separate necessary costs from avoidable markups. They may be unable to compare creators, assess agency fees or decide where the next rupee should go reliably.

That uncertainty has consequences beyond accounting. When brands cannot connect creator spending to sales, they may conclude that influencer marketing does not work, when the problem could actually be about inefficient spending, improper execution or poorly structured campaigns.

IMAGE: AI GENERATED

The Briefing Issue

There is another issue. Somewhere between the brand manager, the agency, the influencer marketing team and the person speaking to the creator, the original marketing problem gets lost, says head of content at Fork Media Group, **Siddhaarth Aalambayan**. "Brands still see creators as the final extension of a campaign, rather than making them an integral part of the communication strategy from day one. Few brands have moved from a tactical to a strategic approach in creator marketing."

The industry is building infrastructure to address the problem. The Indian Influencer Governance Council has introduced a standardised creator contract framework covering payments, intellectual property and dispute resolution.

WPP Media is building its own platform 'influencer.ai' to streamline creator onboarding, contracting and payments. Open Grey's Grey Matter system is trying to improve visibility into payments, contracts, approvals and deliverables.

Hashfame is pursuing a platform model connecting brands with creators or verified managers. Opraah's OPay aims to pay eligible exclusive creators within 48 hours of receiving the required invoice approvals, compared to the usually stated 30-to-90-day cycles.

"The creator economy has scaled much faster than the infrastructure pillars supporting it. There are often multiple stakeholders involved, with the creator being the furthest from the payment centres," says co-founder **Mansi Panpalia.**

Yet, until brands can trace money from the original brief to the creator and connect that spend to results, they will struggle to know whether the marketing channel is underperforming or simply being poorly managed.

As creator marketing becomes sophisticated enough to command serious media budgets, its next battle becomes less about reach, and more about an age-old question – where exactly is the money going?

pratishtha.bagai
@timesofindia.com

The Next Era Of Starbucks

Having laid the foundation for a revival, can Starbucks scale its '90s heyday feeling and drive growth for investors?

Ahead of Starbucks' third-quarter earnings call in July, CEO Brian Niccol's grande Americano (with an extra shot) arrived with a message scrawled in Sharpie: "You got this."

The baristas near the company's Seattle headquarters naturally know his name, but every now and then he gets a note, a gesture that skeptics might consider a nice touch for the big boss.

Niccol views it as a small sign that Back to Starbucks, the plan he launched in 2024 to restore the coffeehouse experience and get customers to return, is working.

After 1,000 store refurbs, a leaner menu, a revamped loyalty programme, a marketing reset, and more than $500 million spent on smarter shift scheduling and putting more staff on shop floors during peak hours, Niccol wrote an open letter to employees in September. "Starbucks is back," he declared. "Now we raise the bar."

He had reason to be jubilant. Starbucks had just reported its fourth consecutive quarter of growth, with global comparable sales up 7.9%. While total revenue slipped 1% to $9.3 billion, after selling most of its China business, Starbucks stock is up 30% since Niccol joined, and it has raised its 2026 forecast.

If his bet plays out, Starbucks' next chapter will solidify its status as the so-called third place: "Somewhere you can be with your community, with friends," he said. "It's durable, sustaining, and highly human."

Of course, those who come in also need to spend more. During a January investor day, Niccol said he anticipates Starbucks can boost sales by at least 3% annually at its existing stores over the next three years.

Standing in the way of that goal is a roster of aggressive competitors, each with a different thesis about how to sell coffee. Dunkin' keeps expanding. 7 Brew and Dutch Bros are growing fast on convenience. Boutique brands are chasing younger, premium customers.

By contrast, Niccol's vision for Starbucks is rooted in its '90s heyday. Back then, he and his wife made a ritual of sitting in their then-local Cincinnati Starbucks, served by a barista who knew them as regulars. Having laid the foundation for a revival, the CEO now has to prove Starbucks can scale that feeling and drive growth for investors at the same time.

Growth is being driven by consumer recruitment, distribution and portfolio expansion

Back to Starbucks

Niccol has a history of successful turnarounds. Sales at Taco Bell grew from $8.5 billion to $10 billion during his 2015–18 tenure as CEO. His time leading Chipotle from 2018 to 2024 was also a business success, with revenue growing from about $5 billion to nearly $10 billion in 2023, his last full year.

When he arrived at Starbucks in September 2024, the company had cycled through four CEOs in just over two years, and sales were declining. Prior to starting, Niccol spent a month touring US stores and speaking to employees.

By then, the business had changed. Mobile and to-go ordering had turned interactions into fleeting moments, while customisation options – former CEO Howard Schultz (who did not respond to a request for comment for this feature) claimed there were 100,000 variations of hot, iced, and blended drinks at one point – made it difficult for staff to keep up.

The brand had become more transactional than the one Niccol felt nostalgic for. Getting back to it would require a different approach than the traditional QSR playbook of efficiency and cost-cutting that worked at Taco Bell and Chipotle.

His rewrite for Starbucks (announced on his second day) was, he acknowledged, "a little bit counterintuitive" and based on delivering a premium experience: Courtesies like handwriting on cups; amenities like comfortable seating, more power outlets, and free coffee refills; waiving charges for alternative milks; and more employees offering friendly, timely service.

Along with rising coffee and tariff costs, labour spend has eaten into operating margins.

It's a cost Niccol is willing to pay to become the "defining customer service brand", which will get people to stay longer and order more.

Over half of Starbucks' US sales (roughly $12 billion annually) happen before 11 am.

If those customers linger, Niccol can build a second post-2 pm peak, bolstered by cold drinks like refreshers and matchas.

Refocusing the Business

Upholding the Starbucks brand promise doesn't come without tough decisions.

Starbucks is chasing $2 billion in cost savings by 2028. It closed 627 stores in 2025 and another 250 in September, and has cut around 2,000 white-collar jobs since early 2025.

Those cuts have also given Niccol the leeway to make investments in the areas needed to help Starbucks grow: Staffing, tech, and, of course, marketing. Under him, Starbucks' advertising spend jumped to $869 million in 2025, up 46% from $597 million the year before.

Over the last year, Starbucks' marketing has sought to get people back into the coffeehouse by reclaiming its place in culture, from appearing in *The Devil Wears Prada 2* to sending fans into a frenzy with merch drops like its Bearista cup.

Product innovation has been high on the agenda, too. This summer's three-day return of the Unicorn Frappuccino, a blue and pink mango-flavoured drink mined from the 2017 time capsule, marked the chain's highest Saturday sales day ever in the US and Canada, with more than 2 million sold over the weekend.

In September, Starbucks released the Aerocano, an aerated chilled espresso.

Move Fast, Brew Things

Tech investment has always been a hallmark of a Niccol turnaround. At Starbucks, Niccol likes to keep the tech mostly out of sight, making sure staff stay visible.

For instance, Green Dot Assist, an AI-powered assistant, is being rolled out in coffeehouses to answer baristas' work-related questions.

For consumers, its app is currently the strongest link between its digital and physical experiences. It's home to the Starbucks Rewards, which has 35.8 million active members, who drive nearly 60% of U.S. company-operated revenues.

Lieberman said the recently revamped loyalty programme – which now puts customers into tiers based on their spending – is only the beginning of a more personalised experience.

Starbucks has also invested in taking cues from newer digital channels, including testing a ChatGPT integration that lets customers order a drink that fits their mood.

– ADWEEK

GlobeTrotting

SoftBank Weighs $18 Billion Acquisition of Allied Universal

SoftBank Group is considering an acquisition of Allied Universal in a deal that could value the US security services provider at about $18 billion, a source said.

Allied Universal provides security staffing for businesses, venues, and major events, and has a growing presence in the data centre industry, supporting development and operation of facilities.

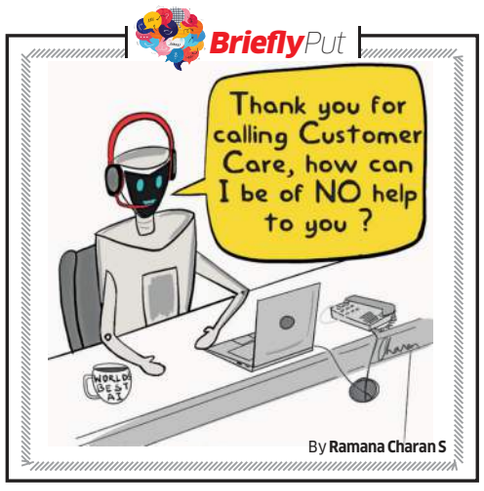
With Allied, SoftBank would look to eventually replace some staff with robots for certain security tasks, though the deployment of humanoid security workers is likely to take longer.

Deliberations are preliminary and no final decisions have been made, including on the price.

SoftBank is known for making technology investments through its Vision Fund. It was an early investor in Alibaba, owns a majority stake in Arm, and was a major backer of the office-sharing startup WeWork.

The deal builds on SoftBank's push into robotics and automation, following its agreement last year to acquire Swiss engineering group ABB's robotics business for $5.4 billion. **–Reuters**

BrieflyPut



By **Ramana Charan S**

Regn.No.MAHENG/2002/6711 Volume 25 Issue No. 42. This newspaper is published by R. Krishnamurthy from The Times of India Building, Dr D N Road, Mumbai 400 001 on behalf of Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd., edited by Sonali Krishna and printed by (1) Upendra Nayak at The Times of India Suburban Press, Akurli Road, Western Express Highway, Kandivili (E), Mumbai 400 101. Tel. No. (022) 28872324, 28872930, Fax- (022) 28874230 (2) Indrajit Sen The Times of India Print City, Plot No. 4, T.T.C. Industrial Area, Thane Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708 and (3) Manish Sinha at The Times of India Press, 13 & 15/1, Site IV, Industrial Area, Sahibabad, UP. (4) Sekar S at Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., The Times of India Press, No. 9/10/11-A, 4th Main, KIADB Bommasandra Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bengaluru - 560 099. Responsible for selection of news under PRB Act ©
All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission of Publisher is prohibited.

Hero

VIDA

Hero

WOMEN'S

INDIAN OPEN 2026

114 CONTENDERS.
32 COUNTRIES.
ONE EPIC TOURNAMENT.
ONE CHAMPION.

HERO WOMEN'S INDIAN OPEN 2026

The world's finest golfers are set to converge at the iconic
DLF Golf & Country Club for four days of elite competition, fierce rivalries,
and unforgettable sporting moments.

THE STAGE IS SET.
THE STAKES ARE HIGH.
THE BATTLE FOR GLORY AWAITS.

COME WITNESS THE ACTION LIVE!

DLF Golf & Country Club | 22–25 October 2026

Saatchi & Saatchi

ET Indo Global Leaders

Circulated with The Economic Times, Delhi | Powered by ETPanache | Wednesday, 21 October, 2026

An Advertorial and Lifestyle Promotional Feature
An Optimal Media Solutions Initiative, A division of Times Internet Limited

GLOBAL BUSINESS LEADERS AND VISIONARIES HONOURED AT ET INDO GLOBAL LEADERS 2026 IN DUBAI

The prestigious Ajman Free Zone presents ET Indo Global Leaders 2026, powered by Dalcore Projects Pvt. Ltd., brought together an influential gathering of entrepreneurs, business leaders, investors and policymakers at Al Habtoor Palace, Dubai, on 20 September. An initiative of Optimal Media Solutions, a division of Times Internet Limited, the event celebrated excellence, innovation and the strengthening economic ties between India and the UAE.

The event commenced with a networking session, followed by a welcome address from Musabeh Al Musafri, Director of Customer Experience and Service Delivery, Ajman Free Zone, who highlighted the UAE's continued commitment to fostering entrepreneurship, investment and global business growth.

The first panel discussion, "India's Global Decade: The New Growth Story," explored India's rising influence in international trade and investment. Industry leaders including Sidharth Chowdhry (Dalcore), Mark Thompson (Gulf News), Dhanush Srinivas (Nandhini Deluxe), CA Bidhu Bhusan Nayak, and Dattatreya Nagireddy (Jey Group) shared perspectives on India's growing role in the global economy and the opportunities emerging through stronger international partnerships. Dattatreya said International investors are increasingly recognising the potential of India's Tier-2 and Tier-3 markets and emerging digital ecosystems. PM initiatives, including GIFT City, have played an exceptional role in strengthening investor confidence and attracting global capital. Sidharth Chowdhry said India stands at the threshold of a defining global decade, with its growing influence in international trade and investment creating new opportunities across sectors. The rise of branded residences reflects this evolution. Developments such as The Falcon by Dalcore represent how the sector is evolving to meet these aspirations.

A fireside chat with Zubair Ul Islam, Director of Sales, Ajman Free Zone, highlighted how free zones are enabling businesses to expand seamlessly into regional and global markets.

Musabeh Al Musafri, Director of Customers Experience and Service Delivery, Ajman Free Zone

The second panel discussion, "The Scale-Up Playbook: Capital, Technology & Strategy for India's Growth Companies," focused on the key drivers of sustainable business expansion. Speakers including Zubair Ul Islam, Vikas Kumar Mathur (Infinity Engineering's), and Imtiyaz Kalsekar (Rasasi) discussed innovation, technology adoption, access to capital and strategies for scaling businesses in competitive global markets.

Adding further insight, Sharat Kumar Sahu, CMD, Stalwart Projects Pvt. Ltd., shared perspectives on infrastructure-led growth and business transformation.

The final panel discussion, "Startup to Global Business: Building the Next Generation of Global Enterprises," featured Sudhir Syal, Ashutosh Upadhayay, Manu Midha (Arnifi), Karan Rai (Credibila), and Abhinav Gupta (Cars24). The panel explored entrepreneurship, fundraising, international expansion and the evolving startup ecosystem driving the next wave of global enterprises.

The evening concluded with the ET Indo Global Leaders Felicitation Ceremony, honouring outstanding entrepreneurs, business leaders and organisations for their contributions to innovation, leadership and global business excellence.

As India continues to strengthen its position on the world stage, ET Indo Global Leaders 2026 reaffirmed its role as a platform that celebrates achievement, fosters collaboration and connects leaders shaping the future of business across borders.

Event Partners: Presenting partner: Ajman Free Zone, Powered by: Dalcore Projects Pvt Ltd, Chic Events & Entertainment, Womennovator, Women Board of Directors, Gulf News, PRP Group Pvt Ltd, Kavix Media & Conscient-JB Groupo

Rajeev Khandewal

Sharat Kumar Sahu

Dhanush Srinivas, CA Bidhu Bhusan Nayak, Dattatreya Nagireddy, Sidharth Chowdhry, Poonam Chawla and Mark Thompson Bottom

Tripti Somani, Sudhir Sayal, Ashutosh Upadhayay, Manu Midha, Karan Rai, Abhinav Gupta

Dipti Singh with Zubair Ul Islam

Vikas Kumar Mathur, Zubair Ul Islam, and Imtiyaz Kalsekar

Harry Sachdeva and Arshdeep Singh Brar

DALCORE SHOWCASES THE FALCON IN DUBAI, PITCHES TO GLOBAL LUXURY HOMEBUYERS

Dalcore, the ultra-luxury real estate developer, has showcased 'The Falcon', its landmark luxury branded residential development in Gurugram RERA Reg. No: RC/REP/HARERA GGM/913/645/2025/16, at the ET Indo Global Leaders 2026 held at Al Habtoor Palace, Dubai. Presented by Ajman Free Zone, in association with The Economic Times, and powered by Dalcore, the esteemed gathering brought together entrepreneurs, business leaders, investors and policymakers from India, the UAE and other international markets to discuss business, investment and the growing economic relations between India and the UAE.

Sidharth Chowdhry, Managing Director, Dalcore Projects, participated in the panel discussion, "India's Global Decade: The New Growth Story," which explored India's growing role in international trade and investment. During the event, Chowdhry met with senior officials and business leaders, including Musabeh Al Musafri, Director of Customer Experience and Service Delivery, and Zubair Ul Islam, Director of Sales, at Ajman Free Zone. He was also honoured with the "Visionary Leadership in Branded Residential Development" award at the event, recognising his contribution to the branded residential segment.

Sidharth Chowdhry, MD, Dalcore Projects Pvt Ltd. being felicitated at ET Indo Global Leaders

Sharing his views, Chowdhry said: "International conversations give us a useful perspective on how people outside India look at luxury homes here. What stood out for us in Dubai was the interest in the quality of design, privacy and the overall experience, rather than simply the size of a residence. It also reinforces our belief that Indian luxury developments can have a wider global appeal when they are thoughtfully designed and clearly differentiated."

Sidharth Chowdhry with Musabeh Al Musafri

Dalcore presents its luxury residences- The Falcon, at the ET Indo Global Leaders 2026

The project received strong interest from audiences and potential buyers at the event, with enquiries coming not only from Dubai and the wider Middle East, but also from Singapore and other international markets. The response reflected growing interest among global buyers in distinctive, design-led luxury homes in India.

The event also provided Dalcore with an opportunity to present The Falcon to an international audience. Located on Golf Course Road in Sector 53, Gurugram, it is spread across two acres and comprises 96 residences. The Falcon marks Dalcore's entry into the branded residences segment and has been developed in partnership with YOO Inspired by Starck, with UHA London leading the architectural planning.

GOA: THE NEW LUXURY SECOND-HOME DESTINATION

Harry Sachdeva shares insights on Goa's emergence as a luxury second-home destination

The event featured an insightful discussion on the evolving landscape of premium real estate, with a special focus on Goa's emergence as a luxury holiday destination and an increasingly sought after second-home market. Harry Sachdeva, Founder & CEO, JES & BEN GROUPO Pvt. Ltd., and Asif Haider Zaidi, Sr. VP Sales & Marketing, Conscient Infrastructure Pvt. Ltd., shared their perspectives on how changing consumer aspirations are reshaping the premium second-home segment. The conversation explored how Goa is evolving beyond a holiday destination into a compelling address for discerning buyers seeking lifestyle, exclusivity and long-term value. With wellness, sophisticated living and wealth creation gaining prominence, second homes are increasingly being viewed as both lifestyle assets and investment opportunities. The session also highlighted evolving expectations among luxury buyers and the role of premium developments in creating elevated living experiences in one of India's most coveted leisure destinations. give a headline to this article.

Felicitating leaders at ET Indo Global Leaders 2026

Research Methodology

The ET Indo Global Leaders 2026 research followed a structured, evidence-based methodology to identify and recognise leaders across relevant categories. The assessment considered professional achievements, leadership capabilities, innovation, industry contribution, business impact and broader social and global contribution.

Some caveats/assumptions:

- Desk Research: Extensive research across business publications, newspapers, company reports, industry associations, public databases, digital platforms, awards and credible media sources.
- Candidate Identification: Potential nominees were identified and shortlisted across relevant categories based on defined parameters.
- Factual Survey: Shortlisted nominees provided information on their professional journey, achievements, leadership initiatives, business performance, innovation and impact.
- Data Validation: Submitted information was cross-checked with publicly available information, supporting documents, professional profiles and industry references.
- Evaluation: Validated information was assessed through a predefined evaluation framework to ensure consistency.
- Finalisation: All findings were consolidated and analysed category-wise, considering professional achievements, leadership contribution, industry and global impact, innovation and social value creation

About People To Announce Inc.

People To Announce Inc. - Advancing Innovation & Growth- is a new age strategic research and consulting firm founded by Industry experts from diverse academic and Industry background. PTA Inc. leverages advanced technologies to provide actionable insights to power client's businesses in real-time. PTA Inc. has an ecosystem where clients' interests are aligned with the best-in-class tailored made solutions.

Note: Present survey has been exclusively conducted by an independent Research Agency named using stated methodology for arriving at given results. The publication house and its affiliates/ employees/ authorized representatives/ group companies are not responsible/ liable for the said results.. Readers are advised to take an informed decision before acting upon the survey results.

LIST OF AWARDEES

Abhinav Gupta – CEO, Cars24 Arabia
Abhishek Bhatnagar – Managing Partner, Abhishek Bhatnagar & Associates Legal Consultants LLP
Aby Abraham – Founder & Executive Director, PromptTech Insurance
Amol Kadam – Founder
Gurpawan Singh – President, IIRIS
Praveen Singhal – CEO, Lexus New Delhi.
Anuj Somani – Founder, Capitall
Asif Zaidi - Sr. VP Sales & Marketing, Conscient Infrastructure Pvt. Ltd.
Atem of Alexandria – Dmitry Soshnikov, MCHDA / SIBr, Int
Bhoovan Dev Singh, Group Head - HR, Park Group of Hospital
CA Bidhu Bhusan Nayak – Director Finance, Sparsh Healthcare Group
Dhanush Srinivas – Managing Director, Nandhini Deluxe
DineshKumar Guruswamy – Founder & Chairman, Aetram Trades Private Limited
Mirza Kifayat Maqsood Beigh – Registrar, Critical Care Medicine, NMC Royal Hospital
Praveen Gupta – Chairman, Marengo Asia Hospital Gurugram
Dattatreya Nagireddy – Chairman & CEO, Jey Group Holdings & Investments
Dr. G.S. Murthy – Founder & Chairman, ATDXT Group
Shantanu Jaradi – Founder & CEO, Dentzz Dental
Faheem ul Haq
Divya Sharma - Founder , Crazy Owl Advertising & Marketing
Harry Sachdeva – Founder & CEO, Jes & Ben Groupo Pvt. Ltd.
Hitesh Bang – Owner, Parampara – Flavours of India
Imtiyaz Kalsekar Founder I'm Rasasi
Kanika Chadha – CEO & Founder, Done & Dusted Realty LLC
Khaja Yousufuddin – Owner, Spice 6 The Arab Villagio
Konark Jain – Managing Director, JHS Media Group
Manish Sharma, Group Head-Branding and Marketing, Park Group of Hospital
Manisha Nischal Latad – Singer & Entrepreneur, Manisha Nischal's Mahek Concerts & Events
Manoj K. Attri – Founder, Sportzon (Citiskape Group)
Moksha Yadav – Managing Director, The Moksh International School
Neha Arora – CEO, Amorvet
Nilesh Dalvi – Director, Quantity Kitchens
Nitin Dheer – Partner, Inqubex People Solutions
Pinky Vaswani – Co-Founder, The Pamper House Co.
Poonam Chawla – Chief Visionary Officer, Women Board of Directors
Rajesh Keshwani – Chairman, TLM Logistics
Ramzan Hasnani – Co-Founder & Director, Taxplan Advisors Pvt. Ltd.
Sankey Prasad – Chairman, Sterling Ark Holdings
Mohammed Irfan – Owner, Shah Ghouse Cafe and Restaurant
Sharat Kumar Sahu – Chief Managing Director, Stalwart Projects Pvt. Ltd.
Shweta Roy – Director, SR Queens Events Pvt. Ltd.
Sidharth Chowdhry – Managing Director, Dalcore Projects Pvt. Ltd.
Subir Arora – Co-Founder, White Bul Spirits Pvt. Ltd.
Sunny Katyal – Director, White Bul Spirits Pvt. Ltd.
Vijaya Mohan Reddy & Ashok Kumar V.B. – Founder & Co-Founder, Biriyani Zone
Vikas Kumar Mathur – Managing Director, Infinity Engineerings
Virtual Galaxy Infotech Limited – Virtual Galaxy Infotech Limited
Vivek Arora – Managing Director, Optiva Ivest LLC FZ, Dubai, UAE
Y. Srimukh & Y. Srikesh – Managing Directors, Madhura Jihva
Sunil Jagetiya & Avinash Jagetiya – Founder & Chairman, and Managing Director, Sun Management Consultants

"The relationship between India and the UAE was built by traders long before modern trade agreements existed. Today, we have an opportunity to take that legacy further. The real success of this partnership will be measured not just by trade figures, but by the factories established, jobs created, and generations of entrepreneurs empowered to succeed.

- Musabeh Al Musafri,Director of Customer Experience and Service Delivery, Ajman Free Zone

"The next chapter of India-UAE business relations will not be defined by how many companies enter new markets, but by how far they can grow once they get there. Indian entrepreneurs have the ambition and talent. What they need is the right ecosystem to scale. At Ajman Free Zone, we are focused on making that journey possible.

- Zubair Ul Islam, Director of Sales, Ajman Free Zone

"Dubai serves as an important gateway to global investors and provides an exceptional platform for meaningful conversations around India's evolving role in the global economy. Our association with ET Indo Global Leaders 2026 reflects the importance of bringing together influential voices. The Falcon by Dalcore embodies this philosophy, bringing together thoughtful architecture, refined design and an elevated residential experience

- Sidharth Chowdhry Managing Director, Dalcore

"Womenovator has always been about giving women visibility and access to global opportunities. With the Global Alliance, we are creating a borderless community of women leaders - to share voices, build collaborations, and ensure women's representation becomes a global norm, not an exception

- Tripti Singhal Somani, Founder, Womennovator

Shweta Roy, Director

SR Queens Events Pvt Ltd

Excellence in Visionary Leadership & Women's Empowerment

Aby Abraham, Founder & Executive Director

PromptTech Insurance

Emerging Enterprise InsurTech Brand

Tripti Somani, receiving the award on behalf of Anuj Somani

Capitall

Excellence in Audit Technology & Innovation

Asif Zaidi , Sr. VP Sales & Marketing & Arshdeep Singh Brar, DGM, Sales

Conscient Infrastructure Pvt Ltd

Leading Real Estate Developer of the Year

Atem of Alexandria, Dmitry Soshnikov

MCHDA / SIBr, Int

Global Excellence in Emerging Travel Technology Solutions 2026

Vikas Kumar Mathur, Managing Director

Infinity Engineerings

Global leaders in Fire & Saftey equipments

CA Bidhu Bhusan Nayak, Director Finance

Sparsh Healthcare Group

National Financial Craftsman & Economic Visionary Laureate

Dhanush Srinivas, Managing Director

Nandhini Deluxe

Excellence and Legacy in Andhra Cuisine and Biryani

Dinesh Kumar Guruswamy, Founder and Chairman

Aetram Trades Private Limited

Excellence in Financial Technology & Trading Solutions

Dr. Mirza Kifayat Maqsood Beigh

Excellence in Medical & Critical Care

Praveen Gupta, Chairman

Marengo Aisa Hospital Gurugram

Excellence in Healthcare

Dattatreya Nagireddy, Chairman & CEO

Jey Group Holdings & Investments

Excellence in Global Investments Ports and Maritime Infrastructure

Dr. G.S. Murthy - Founder & Chairman

ATDXT Technologies LLC

Pioneering Excellence in AI & Digital Innovation

Shantanu Jaradi, Founder & CEO, Dentzz Dental

Dentzz Dental

Dentzz Dental - Global Leader in Dental Tourism

Faheem ul Haq

Digital Game Changer & Trailblazer - Real Estate

Harry Sachdeva, Founder & CEO

Jes & Ben Groupo Pvt Ltd

Visionary Leadership in Real Estate Sector

Hitesh Bang, Owner

Parampara - Flavours of India

Trailblazing Entrepreneur in Dining

Imtiyaz Kalsekar, Founder

I'm Rasasi

Excellence in Business & Entrepreneurship

Kanika Chadha, CEO & founder

Done & Dusted Realty LLC

Global Woman Leader in Real Estate Entrepreneurship

Khaja Yousufuddin, Owner

Spice 6 The Arab Villagio

Visionary Restaurateur Arabic & Mediterranean Cuisine

Konark Jain, Managing Director

JHS Media Group

Best Podcaster

Manish Sharma, Group Head- Branding & Marketing

Park Group of Hospital

Outstanding Contribution to Healthcare Brand Building

Manisha Nischal Latad, Singer & Entrepreneur

Manisha Nischal's Mahek Concerts & Events

Excellence in Singing

Manoj K Attri, Founder

Sportzon (Citiskape Group)

Excellence in Sports Technology & Innovation

Moksha Yadav, Managing Director
The Moksh International School
Excellence in Academic Leadership

Neha Arora, CEO
Amorvet
Excellence in Animal Health & Care

Nilesh Dalvi, Director
Quantity Kitchens
Excellence in Vegetarian Online Catering

Nitin Dheer, Partner
Inqubex People Solutions
Excellence in Organizational Design

Pinky Vaswani, Co-founder
The Pamper House Co.
Excellence in Luxury Wellness & Recovery Experiences

Poonam Chawla, Chief Visionary Officer
Women Board of Directors
Excellence in Leadership Empowerment

Praveen Singhal, CEO
Lexus New Delhi
Leadership Excellence in Luxury Automotive Retail

Gurpawan Singh, President
IIRIS
Excellence in Corporate Security & Risk Consulting

Sunil Jagetiya & Avinash Jagetiya
Founder & Chairman - Managing Director
Sun Management Consultant
Excellence in Professional Service

Abhishek Bhatnagar, Managing Partner
Abhishek Bhatnagar & Assoicates Legal Consultants LLP
Distinguished Lawyer – Litigation & Cyber Law

Mohammed Irfan and Mohammed Rabbani, Owners
Shah Ghouse Cafe and Restaurant
Outstanding Contribution to Hyderabadi Biryani

Sharat Kumar Sahu, Chief Managing Director
Stalwart Projects Pvt Ltd
Visionary Leader in India's Urban Transformation

Abhinav Gupta, CEO
Cars24 Arabia
Automotive Marketplace Transformation Award

Sidharth Chowdhry, Managing Director
Dalcore Projects Pvt Ltd
Visionary Leadership in Branded Residential Development

Subir Arora, Co-Founder
White Bul Spirits Pvt Ltd
Visionary Leader in the Global Spirits & Beverage Industry

Divya Sharma, Founder
Crazy Owl
Leading Adverstising and Marketing Agency

Vijaya Mohan Reddy, Ashok Kumar V B, Founder and Co-Founder
Biriyani Zone
Excellence in Hyderabadi Cuisine and Biryani

Amol Kadam, Founder
Visionary Entrepreneurship Across Experience, Technology and Mobility

Virtual Galaxy Infotech limited
Virtual Galaxy Infotech limited
Best Software Solution for Development Finance Institutions

Vivek Arora, Managing Director
Optiva Ivest LLC FZ Dubai UAE
Excellence in Real Estate & Capital Investment

Y. Srimukh & Y. Srikesh, Managing Directors
Madhura Jihva
Iconic Brand for Corporate Catering in Veg Dining

Sunny Katyal, Director
White Bul Spirits Pvt Ltd
Visionary Leader in the Global Spirits & Beverage Industry

Bhoovan Dev Singh, HR Head
Park Group of Hospital
Leadership in Strategic HR Management

Sankey Prasad, Chairman
Sterling Ark Holdings
Excellence in Real Estate Development & Investment

Rajesh Keshwani, Chairman
TLM Logistics
Logistics Innovator of the year

Ramzan Hasnani Co-founder & Director Taxplan Advisors Pvt Ltd.
Taxplan Advisors Pvt Ltd.
Excellence in Technology-Driven Tax Consulting

For any further details about, ET Indo Global Leaders contact: info.oms@timesofindia.com

DISCLAIMER: THE VIEWS/CONTENTS EXPRESSED/PRESENTED HEREIN, WITHIN THIS ADVERTORIAL, LIFESTYLE PROMOTIONAL FEATURE, ARE THE SOLE AND EXCLUSIVE RESPONSIBILITY OF INDIVIDUAL CLIENTS/EXPERTS/THEIR AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVES, TO WHICH EFFECT, PUBLICATION HOUSE/ ITS REPRESENTATIVES/AFFILIATES ARE NOT RESPONSIBLE/LIABLE WHATSOEVER.

ET

INDUSTRY CHANGEMAKERS North 2026

Circulated with The Economic Times, Delhi | Powered by ETPanache | Wednesday, 21 October, 2026 | An Advertorial, Lifestyle Promotional Feature
An Optimal Media Solutions Initiative, A division of Times Internet Limited

ET INDUSTRY CHANGEMAKERS AWARDS NORTH 2026:
CELEBRATING VISIONARIES WHO ARE SHAPING TOMORROW

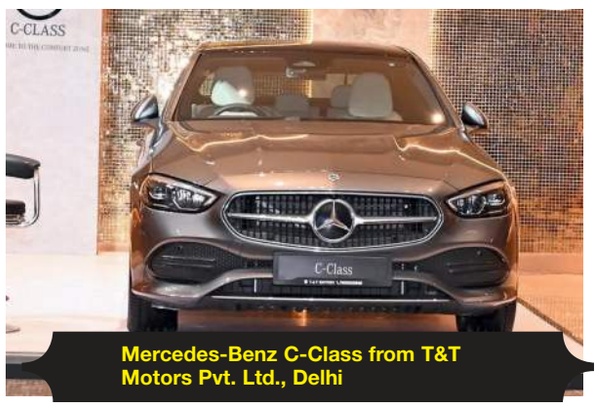
The ET Industry Changemakers Awards North 2026, an initiative of Optimal Media Solutions a division of Times Internet Limited, The Times of India, Powered by PayMe and TRS Tamara, brought together an inspiring gathering of business leaders, entrepreneurs, innovators and industry pioneers at the Radisson Hotel, MG Road, New Delhi. The ET Industry Changemakers Awards North 2026 event recognised achievements and celebrated individuals and organisations making a meaningful impact across industries. The prestigious event honoured those whose vision, leadership and commitment are helping shape the future of India's business landscape.

The evening was graced by celebrated Bollywood actor Randeep Hooda as the Chief Guest, who felicitated the awardees for their outstanding contributions and achievements. His presence added star power to the occasion, making the celebration a memorable confluence of business excellence, ambition and inspiration. As the awardees took centre stage, the event recognised not just professional accomplishments but also the determination, innovative thinking and leadership that drive progress and create lasting value.

The event also provided a distinguished platform for networking and meaningful engagement, bringing together influential voices from diverse sectors under one roof. Associate partners such as Diwan Saheb(Luxury Men's Wear Partner), Mercedes-Benz T&T Motors, Delhi (Luxury Auto Partner), Rock & Storm(Celebrations Partner), Mega Cabs(Mobility Partner) and Medusa(Pouring Partner) further strengthened the occasion, adding to a celebration dedicated to recognising quality and achievement.

Through this initiative, Optimal Media Solutions a division of Times Internet Limited, Times of India, reaffirmed its commitment to celebrating the individuals and organisations contributing to India's economic and entrepreneurial growth. The felicitation served as a tribute to those who go beyond conventional boundaries, inspire others through their work and create opportunities for progress within their respective fields.

Swati, Emcee



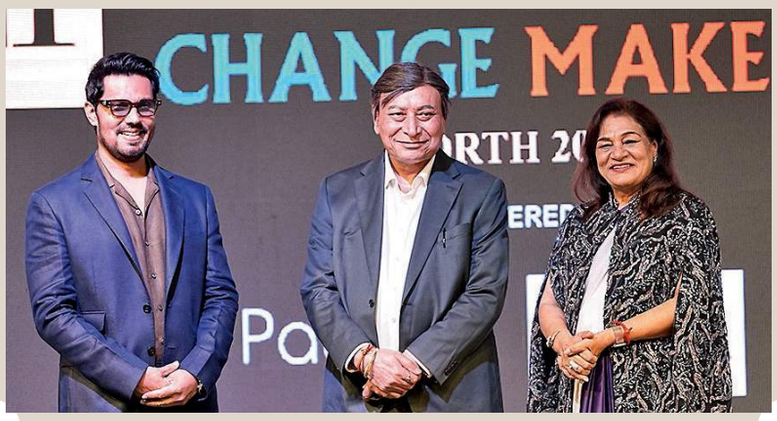
Mercedes-Benz C-Class from T&T Motors Pvt. Ltd., Delhi

Randeep Hooda with Ritika Agrawal from PayMe and Rajiv Kumar Sawhney from TRS Tamara

TRS Tamara by TR Sawhney Group - Co Powered by Partner

"With TRS Tamara, we are marking a defining milestone for the TR Sawhney Group. Located at Kaushambi, near Delhi, this project reflects our vision of redefining luxury living for today's discerning achlevers. TRS Tamara brings together contemporary architecture, expansive residences, and thoughtfully curated amenities in a location that offers unmatched connectivity and convenience. More than a real estate development, it represents our commitment to innovation, quality, and future-ready urban living. This is not just the launch of a project, but the beginning of a new chapter-where aspiration finds its address and leadership shapes lifestyle.

- Rajiv Kumar Sawhney, Chairman, TRS Tamara by TR Sawhney Group



PayMe - Co Powered by Partner

"We are delighted to associate with ET Industry Changemakers as the Co-Powered By Partner, a prestigious platform that celebrates and recognises visionary leaders, innovators and organisations that are shaping the future of Indian industry. Founded in 2016, PayMe has emerged as one of India's fastest-growing fintech brands, redefining digital lending through innovation, trust, and technology. Starting as a Lending Service Provider (LSP), the brand expanded its capabilities with an RBI-registered NBFC in 2018 - now operating as Scale Up Financial Services Pvt. Ltd. The entire technology backbone, proprietary software, and AI-driven innovations powering the PayMe ecosystem are developed by Huey Tech Limited. Together, PayMe (Brand), ScaleUp (NBFC), and Huey Tech (Technology) form an integrated fintech ecosystem built to make financial services smarter, faster, and more accessible for millions of Indians.

- Mahesh Shukla, Founder & CEO, PayMe

Kalra Hospitals Delhi - Healthy Heart Partner

"As a leading healthcare institution with a strong focus on cardiac and cardiovascular care, Kalra Hospital's association reinforces the importance of maintaining a healthy heart while celebrating the leaders and changemakers who are driving India's growth.

- Dr R N Kalra CEO and Medical Director

Rock & Storm Distilleries Pvt Ltd - Celebration Partner

"Innovation creates possibilities, leadership turns them into progress, and collaboration creates lasting impact. Rock and Storm is proud to join ET Industry Change Makers North 2026 as a Celebration Partner and celebrate the forces transforming business and industry.

- Tanmay Ojha General Manager-Marketing and HORECA, Rock & Storm Distilleries Pvt Ltd

T&T Motors, Mercedes-Benz - Luxury Automobile Partner

"We are delighted to associate with the ET Industry Changemakers as the Luxury Auto Partner. The event celebrates visionary leaders who are shaping industries and driving meaningful transformation. At T&T Motors, Mercedes-Benz, we share this spirit of quality, innovation and leadership, and are proud to support a platform that recognises changemakers.

– Himanshu Jaisinghani, Group CEO, T&T Motors Pvt. Ltd.

Diwan Saheb - Luxury Mens Wear Partner

"Diwan Saheb is a luxury menswear brand where timeless craftsmanship meets contemporary elegance. With a legacy woven into every detail, the brand creates refined occasion wear, ceremonial couture and impeccably tailored ensembles for the modern man. Balancing traditional artistry with modern silhouettes, every Diwan Saheb creation reflects thoughtful design, fine craftsmanship and understated luxury. Diwan Saheb is present across Delhi, Gurugram, Jaipur, Ludhiana and Hyderabad.

- Sudhir Diwan and Aviraj Diwan, Directors, Diwan Saheb

Mega Cabs - Mobility Partner

"We were proud to serve as the Official Mobility Partner for ET Industry Changemakers 2026. It was a privilege to be part of an evening celebrating the leaders shaping tomorrow's industries.

- Vikram Anand, Director, Mega Cabs

Medusa Beverages Pvt Ltd - Pouring Partner

"Medusa believes in building a brand that connects with the next gen through innovation, entrepreneurship and meaningful experiences. Partnering with ET Changemakers is enabling us to celebrate leaders while strengthening our connection with India's evolving youth and business community."

– Avneet Singh, Founder & CEO, Medusa Beverages Pvt. Ltd.

Research Methodology

The objective of this research was to conduct a survey, assess and evaluate the probable nominations and recommend the final list of recipients for the coveted ET - Industry Changemaker -2026.

The survey had these modules, i.e. Desk Secondary Research, Approach for sharing fact file, and a Factual survey (Participatory Survey) to arrive at the analysis & identify the results of business entities /personalities and Performers and Individuals in different categories.

A comprehensive list of business entities /brand leaders, personalities and Performers and Individuals was generated with the help of the internet, social media, print -magazines, and other publications.

The kind of work done by the nominees with focus on innovation and value propositions, contribute to the business world, society, and nation at large, Vision for the further addition of value to business world, society, and nation in future.

In addition, feedback of each nominee was assessed through multiple tools such as social media profile scan and customers/ colleagues or public feedback.

All data was objectively analyzed to assess the eligibility and suitability of the nominee for the award.

The study was conducted and started from the 2nd week of August 2026.

Some caveats/assumptions:

- Best efforts were made to reach the maximum business entities /brand leaders, personalities and Performers and Individuals in different categories.
- If the nomination for any specific category was not received, those categories were dropped and categories with single nominations were given unanimously.
- Only those business entities /brand leaders, personalities and Performers and Individuals were considered who have submitted their participatory factual sheet

About Avance Insights Pvt Ltd (Avance Insights)

Avance is a new age strategic research and consulting firm founded by Industry experts from diverse academic and Industry background. Avance leverages advanced technologies to provide actionable insights to power client's businesses in real-time. Avance has an ecosystem where clients' interests are aligned with the best-in-class tailored made solutions.

Avance Insights is a corporate member of MRSI and follows the MRSI code of conduct while conducting all its research projects. For more information about the company please visit www.avanceinsights.in Contact us on manoj@avanceinsights.in

Note: Present survey has been exclusively conducted by an independent Research Agency named Avance Insights Pvt Ltd using stated methodology for arriving at given results. The publication house and its affiliates/ employees/ authorized representatives/ group companies are not responsible/ liable for the said results.. Readers are advised to take an informed decision before acting upon the survey results.

Abhishek Goel, Director

Venkateshwar International School, Dwarka Sector 10, New Delhi

Excellence in Holistic Education

Amit Mamgain, Founder & Executive Director

Yugen Infra Pvt Ltd

Excellence in Luxury Real Estate

Ashraye Lalani, Director

GroupMega

Emerging Business Leader

Avis India Mobility Pvt Ltd

Excellence in Premium Mobility Services

Bal Bhavan Public School, Mayur Vihar - 2

Excellence in Experiential Learning

Amit Saxena, CEO

Sparsh Universe

Excellence in the Field of Education

Manisha Khanna, Director Principal

St. Andrews World School, sector 85, Gurugram

Excellence in the Field of Education

Aakarsh N. Saxena, Director

Rusan Pharma Ltd

Outstanding Innovative Pharma Company

Adarsh Toshniwal, Dipak Rakhde

Garagetech Plus Private Limited, Garagewalle

One of the Best AI-Powered Two-Wheeler Service Booking Platform & Franchise Network

Jasmine Kaur Basu, Co-Founder

Mirasa Ayurveda

Changemaker in Holistic Healthcare - Ayurveda

Jasvinder Singh, Managing Director

Supermac Industries (India) ltd

Excellence in Extrusion Machinery and Innovation

Karan Khurana, Founder & CEO

ReBAT - A Sage Group Venture

Outsanding Contributution in Critical Minerals & Circular Economy

Mool Chand Aggarwal, CMD

Madhusudan (Bareilly Dairies Limited)

Promising Dairy Brand of the Year

Mamta Modern Sr. Sec. School

Excellence in Academic Excellence

Manu Bhatia, Director

Aryan Exporters Pvt. Ltd.

Excellence in Air spring Manufacturing & Innovation

Mukund Mohan Raj, Founder

Meragi Events

Leadership & Excellence in the Wedding & Events Industry

National Victor Public School, I.P. Extension

Progressive School of the Year

Appinventiv

Digital Bharat Excellence Award

Prashant Narula, Principal

Shiv Vani Model Senior Secondary School

Excellence in Educational Leadership

Puran Dawar, Founder

Dawar Group

Excellence in Sustainable Manufacturing

Rahul Attuluri, Co- Founder & CEO

NxtWave

Excellence in Future Ready Tech Education

Sachin Garg, Director

Sam India Infrastructure

Iconic Infrastructure Company

Vipul Garg, Director

Sam India Housing

Innovative Real Estate Developer

Holy Child Public School, Faridabad

Excellence in the Field of Education

Shubham Gupta

Excellence in AI Innovation

St. Andrews Scots Sr. Sec. School, Patparganj

Promising School for overall Development

Susan Kaur, Director of Academics

Homerton Grammar School Faridabad

Excellence in the Field of Education

Co - Powered by

TRS TAMARA KAUSHAMBI, GHAZIABAD

PayMe

Luxury Auto Partner

T&T MOTORS Delhi-NCR | Rajasthan | Odisha | Uttar Pradesh

Pouring Partner

Medusa

Mobility Partner

Mega

Celebrations Partner

BLUE EYES

COMMANDER N CHIEF CARIBBEAN GOLD XXX RUM

BARENTS PREMIUM

Luxury Menswear Partner

Diwan Saheb

Healthy Heart Partner

KALRA HOSPITAL SRCNC

Celebrating the Brands Evolving India's Wedding Industry

The ET Wedding Industry Game Changers North 2026, was hosted as a special segment of the prestigious ET Industry Changemakers North 2026, celebrating the vision, creativity and remarkable contributions of individuals who are redefining India's vibrant wedding industry. The initiative recognised professionals whose passion, innovation and commitment continue to transform weddings into memorable and extraordinary experiences.

From wedding planners, designers and decorators to photographers, hospitality experts, jewellery creators and fashion professionals, the wedding industry brings together diverse talents to create celebrations that reflect individual stories, traditions and aspirations. The platform felicitated these achievers, acknowledging their entrepreneurial spirit, creative exposure and ability to set new benchmarks in the sector.

By bringing the wedding sector under the larger ET Industry Changemakers platform, the initiative provided a distinguished stage to recognise achievers, celebrate their professional journeys and showcase their contributions to the industry. The event highlighted the people behind some of the most memorable wedding celebrations, honouring their achievements and inspiring emerging professionals to push the boundaries of creativity and excellence in India's ever-evolving wedding landscape.

Randeep Hooda felicitates Shikha Palta, Founder

Aula Banquet

Legendary Venue for Grand Wedding Celebrations - Faridabad

Satvik Handa, General Manager- Sales

EHV Catering

Excellence in Luxury Wedding Catering

Randeep Hooda felicitates Pranay Bahl, Director

Embassy Catering

Iconic Wedding & Large Scale Event Catering

Randeep Hooda felicitates Harpreet Vohra, GM

Radisson Blu Hotel, Faridabad

Excellence in Luxury Wedding Experiences

Randeep Hooda felicitates Anuj Soin, GM, Rajiv Chopra & Varun Mangla

Radisson Blu New Delhi Paschim Vihar

Iconic Wedding Destination – West Delhi

Randeep Hooda felicitates Digvijay Singh, Founder

Saratoga

Bespoke Boutique Venue for Intimate Celebrations & Premium Shoots

Randeep Hooda felicitates Meena Bhatia, Vice President & General Manager, Mohini Dewalla & Simran Kaur

The Great Delhi Dreams By Le Meridien New Delhi

Iconic Excellence in End-to End Wedding Experience

Randeep Hooda felicitates Karan Gupta , Founder & CEO

Vega Star Events

Excellence in Wedding Planner

Research Methodology

The objective of this research was to conduct a survey, assess and evaluate the probable nominations and recommend the final list of recipients for the coveted ET - Wedding Industry Game Changers 2026.

The survey had these modules, i.e. Desk Secondary Research, Approach for sharing fact files, and a Factual survey (Participatory Survey) to arrive at the analysis & identify the excellent performers and contributors in different fields.

The kind of work done by the nominees with focus on innovation and value propositions, contribute to the business world, society, and nation at large, Vision for the further addition of value to business world, society, and nation in future,

In addition, feedback of each nominee was assessed through multiple tools such as social media profile scan and customers/ colleagues or public feedback.

The study was conducted in North and started from the 2nd week of June 2026.

Some caveats/assumptions:

- Best efforts were made to reach the maximum Eentities, brand leader and certain affiliates who are assocaited with wedding and its service in the respective categories
- If the nomination for any specific category was not received, those categories were dropped and categories with single nominations were given unanimously.
- Only those entities were considered who have submitted their participatory factual sheet

About Avance Insights Pvt Ltd (Avance Insights)

Avance is a new age strategic research and consulting firm founded by Industry experts from diverse academic and Industry background.

Avance Insights is a corporate member of MRSI and follows the MRSI code of conduct while conducting all its research projects. For more information about the company please visit www.avanceinsights.in and Contact us on manoj@avanceinsights.in

Note: Present survey has been exclusively conducted by an independent Research Agency named Avance Insights Pvt Ltd using stated methodology for arriving at given results. The publication house and its affiliates/ employees/ authorized representatives/ group companies are not responsible/ liable for the said results.. Readers are advised to take an informed decision before acting upon the survey results.

Aula Banquet

Aula Banquet Faridabad, has added another accomplishment to its journey by winning the ET Wedding Industry Game Changers Award – "Legendary Venue for Grand Wedding Celebrations - Faridabad" The recognition celebrates Aula's commitment to redefining hospitality through exceptional cuisine, elegant ambience and professional service.

EHV Catering

EHV Catering brings culinary experiences to weddings, corporate events, private celebrations, and grand occasions. Renowned for its diverse global cuisines, interactive live counters, and remarkable hospitality, EHV creates memorable gatherings with personalized service, and seamless event execution tailored to every client's vision.

Embassy Catering

Since the 1960s, Embassy Catering has brought its culinary legacy to weddings, corporate gatherings, house parties and large-scale events, known for live counters, global cuisines and impeccable hospitality.

Radisson Blu Hotel, Faridabad

Radisson Blu Hotel, Faridabad offers an exceptional setting for grand weddings, combining elegant venues, curated menus, personalised décor and refined hospitality. Recognised as the " Excellence in Luxury Wedding Experiences" at ET Wedding Industry Game Changers – North

Radisson Blu Hotel, New Delhi, Paschim Vihar

"A wedding event is one of life's most meaningful milestones, and it is our honour to create celebrations filled with exceptional hospitality, personalised service and memories that last a lifetime." - Anuj Soin, General Manager

Saratoga

Located in Noida, Saratoga is a bespoke boutique venue brand for intimate celebrations, curated stays and creative shoots. Catering to gatherings of up to 150 guests, it combines thoughtful design, landscaped open spaces and personalised hospitality. Its accessible, secure urban locations offer a convenient alternative to remote farmhouses, with a focus on aesthetics, privacy and memorable experiences.

The Great Delhi Dreams By Le Meridien New Delhi

At Le Méridien New Delhi, The Great Delhi Dreams transforms weddings into unforgettable multi-day celebrations where every detail tells a story. From bespoke décor and curated menus to personalised Wedding Ambassadors and indulgent salon rituals, every moment reflects warmth, elegance, and heartfelt hospitality. More than a wedding, it's a lifelong relationship—one that continues through honeymoons, future stays, and memories cherished forever.

Vega Star Events

Established in 2016 by Karan Gupta, Founder & CEO, Vega Star Events celebrates a decade of excellence in wedding and corporate event planning. it is renowned for creative concepts, bespoke experiences, meticulous planning, and seamless execution, earning industry recognition and lasting client trust through professionalism and integrity.

For any further details about, ET Industry Changemakers and Et wedding Industry Changemakers contact: info.oms@timesofindia.com

DISCLAIMER: THE VIEWS/CONTENTS EXPRESSED/PRESENTED HEREIN, WITHIN THIS ADVERTORIAL, LIFESTYLE PROMOTIONAL FEATURE, ARE THE SOLE AND EXCLUSIVE RESPONSIBILITY OF INDIVIDUAL CLIENTS/EXPERT/THEIR AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVES, TO WHICH EFFECT, PUBLICATION HOUSE/ ITS REPRESENTATIVES/AFFILIATES ARE NOT RESPONSIBLE/LIABLE WHATSOEVER.

Lifetime Free Newspapers Access

FREE • LIFETIME ACCESS • ALL CHANNELS

EDITORIALS PDF

- **English Editorials PDF**
  with International Newspapers Editorials [35–40 pages]
- **Hindi Editorials PDF**
- **Daily Vocabulary PDF**

MAGAZINE CHANNEL

National & International
[General & Exam related]

INTERNATIONAL NEWSPAPERS

Newspapers around the world.
Asian, European & American

INDIAN NEWSPAPERS CHANNEL

1. The Indian Express
2. The Hindu
3. Business Line
4. Financial Express
5. Times of India
6. Hindustan Times
7. Economic Times
8. Live Mint
9. Business Standard

HINDI NEWSPAPERS

1. दैनिक जागरण
2. जनसत्ता
3. हरिभूमि
4. हिंदुस्तान
5. लोकमत
6. लोकसत्ता
7. दैनिक भास्कर

CLICK HERE ▼

Tap the button above to get free access